FRIDAY
October 2, 2026

CHENNAI
CITY EDITION
26 Pages ₹ 5.00

THE HINDU

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Inauguration by

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Thiru. C. JOSEPH VIJAY

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Venue: Puratchi Thalaivar Dr.M.G.R. Bus Terminus, Koyambedu, Chennai

DIPR / 858 / DISPLAY / 2026

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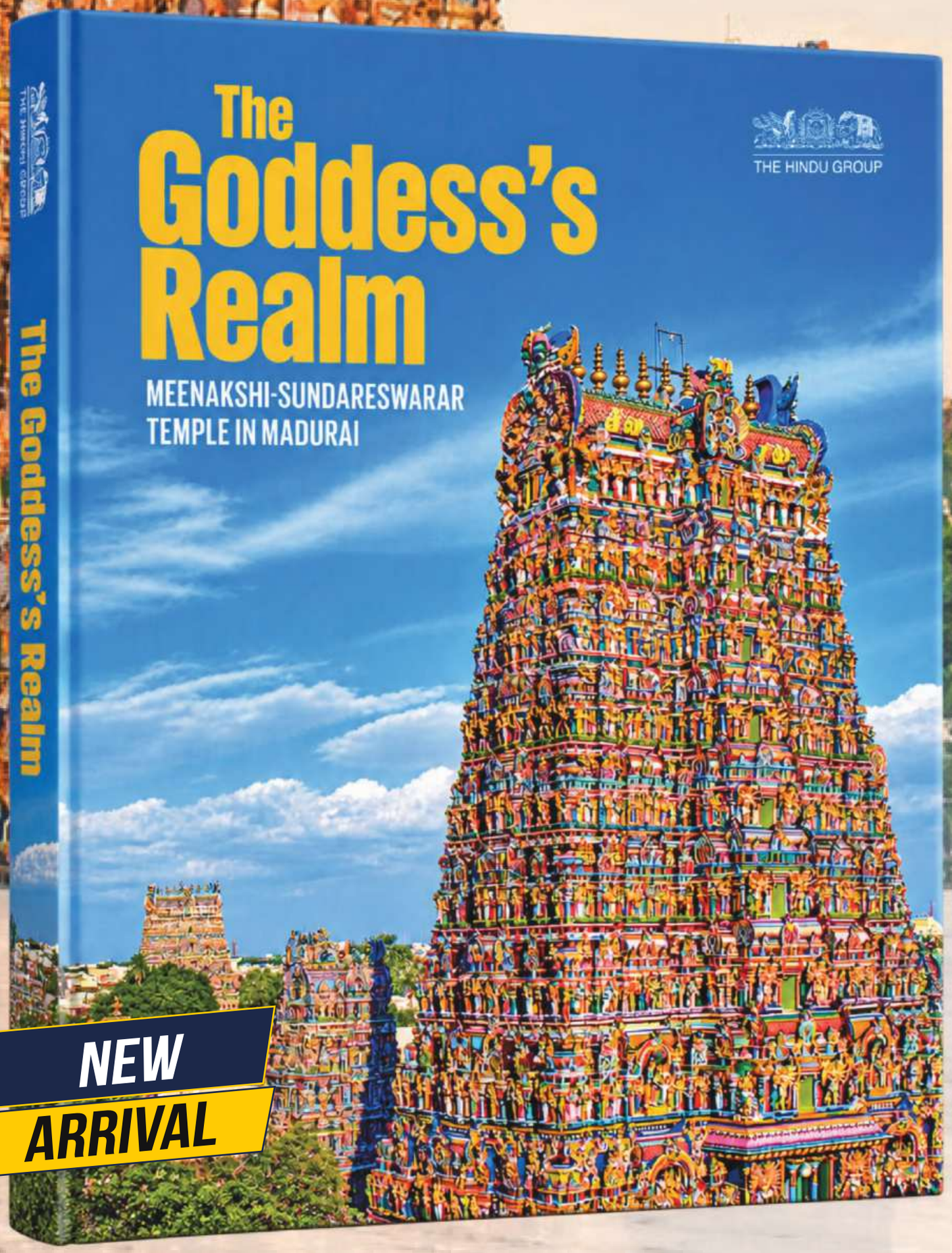

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PICNIC TRAGEDY

8 students drown in sea in Maharashtra

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HISTORIC MEDAL

Nitesh wins silver in 97kg Greco-Roman wrestling

SPORT » PAGE 17

SEPTEMBER COLLECTION

GST revenue rises to ₹2.03 lakh crore

BUSINESS » PAGE 15

MEMORY OF THE MAHATMA

Remembering Gandhiji

Compilation of articles offering insights into his ideas and legacy

EDITORIAL AND OPINION PAGES

IRANI CUP

J&K bowlers keep RoI batters in check

SPORT » PAGE 16

NEARBY

HC clears decks for byelection to Ambasamudram

CHENNAI
The Madras High Court has cleared the decks for the conduct of bypoll in Ambasamudram constituency by striking off a plea to declare the runner-up as the returned candidate. » PAGE 6

DMK man held in Tiruchi temple land fraud case

TIRUCHI
The Tiruchi City Crime Branch arrested N. Ramkumar, a DMK functionary, in connection with a case of alleged fraud involving a land belonging to Sri Ranganathaswamy Temple in Srirangam. » PAGE 6

FRIDAY REVIEW » 6 PAGES

UAE probes 'terror' link to flight incident

Netanyahu says attacker had undergone 'Islamist radical indoctrination'; he credits passengers of flight and Indian pilot for averting catastrophe

Agence France-Presse
DUBAI

Warm welcome: Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu with Yaniv Hayun, a passenger on the flight, on Thursday. REUTERS

The UAE announced on Thursday it was probing a possible "terrorist" link to an apparent attack by a pilot on board a flight from Dubai to Tel Aviv that saw passengers reroute the plane to stop it from crashing.

The dramatic events on Wednesday ended with passengers being given a hero's welcome by Israel Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu as they arrived from Saudi Arabia, where the plane made an emergency landing earlier.

Mr. Netanyahu credited the flydubai pilot, Indian national Smit Machchhar, as well as passengers with averting catastrophe, after a co-pilot allegedly stabbed him and tried to crash the plane. Passengers described rushing to the cockpit after the plane suddenly plummeted, losing around 17,000 feet of altitude in the span of a minute, according to the Flightradar24 website.

Israeli officials have called the incident "an attempted terrorist attack". Mr. Netanyahu said that the co-pilot had undergone "Islamist radical indoctrination... The attacker, he calls out to the aircrew, 'Kill me, kill me,' making it "clear he was suicidal".

U.S. President Donald Trump said there might be an "Iran link" to the co-pilot.

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RELATED REPORTS ON » PAGE 12

Govt. hikes commercial LPG cylinder price by ₹65

Saptaparno Ghosh
NEW DELHI

The price of commercial LPG cylinders was increased by around ₹65 on Thursday. The hike, for the second consecutive month, has come just ahead of the festive season.

Cumulatively, the price of the 19-kg cylinder has been increased by about ₹75 per refill since September across two tranches.

The price of the 5-kg free-trade LPG cylinder refills was hiked by ₹15 per cylinder on Thursday even as the price of domestic LPG remained unchanged. The price of aviation turbine fuel was increased by about ₹16 to ₹137 per litre.

The latest increase in the price of commercial LPG cylinders follows the price cuts in July and August.

CONTINUED ON » PAGE 12

Shivakumar protests; EC orders probe into Form 7 fraud charge

Rishita Khanna
BENGALURU

The Election Commission (EC) on Thursday ordered a probe into the filing of Form 7s in bulk seeking deletions of names from final electoral rolls following a five-hour protest by Karnataka Chief Minister D. K. Shivakumar and his Cabinet colleagues.

Chief Electoral Officer, Karnataka, V. Anbu Kumar, directed all Electoral Registration Officers (EROs) to take action against applicants who "knowingly" make false statements or declarations while filing claims or objections in Forms 6, 6A, 7, and 8.

Mr. Shivakumar withdrew the protest after the announcement.

Earlier in the day, he alleged that "pre-filled" Form 7s were filed in bulk across the State by the Opposition BJP and Janata Dal (Secular) workers, targeting Muslims, and members of the Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes, and Other Backward Classes, claiming they had either "shifted" or were "absent".

D.K. Shivakumar staging a protest outside the CEO's office in Bengaluru. J. ALLEN EGENUSE

He said many Form 7s were either false or forged.

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PARLEY » PAGE 11
RELATED REPORTS ON » PAGES 8 AND 13

Veeramani, two associates booked under Goondas Act

R. Sivaraman
CHENNAI

Greater Chennai Police Commissioner A. Amalraj has ordered the detention of Gem Granites founder R. Veeramani, 84, and his associates, Shanthi, 60, and her husband Mahendra Simhan, 63, under the Goondas Act for allegedly engaging in repeated criminal activities and disturbing public order.

The Immoral Trafficking Prevention Unit arrested Veeramani on August 29, on charges of sexually assaulting minor girls, and the other two accused for abetting him. They were remanded in judicial custody and lodged at the Central Prison in Puzhal. Subsequently, the police registered two more cases against Veeramani for driving minor girls to suicide.

CONTINUED ON » PAGE 6

Redeployment plan could reduce doctor posts in government hospitals: association

The Service Doctors and Post Graduates Association raises concern over the implementation of Govt. Order 113

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A move to redeploy doctors across government hospitals under the Directorate of Medical and Rural Health Services (DMS) could reduce the sanctioned posts of doctors in many government hospitals, particularly district headquarters and taluk hospitals, and hospitals with Comprehensive Emergency Obstetric and Newborn Care (CEmONC) centres, a section of doctors said.

The Service Doctors and Post Graduates Association (SDPGA) had expressed concerns over the implementation of Government Order (G.O.) 113, which was issued in March and reportedly kept in abeyance following their request.

The G.O. looks at rationalising 3,619 doctors posts at non-taluk, taluk and government headquarters hospitals to ensure the availability of specialist care in all secondary care institutions, citing the bunching of specialists in several institutions.

However, the association said that despite upgrading 16 taluk hospitals as district headquarters hospitals, there has been no increase in the posts of doctors. The government has adopted a redeployment model without sanctioning new posts. In fact, the number of sanctioned posts has been reduced in nearly 70% of GHs, it said.

The SDPGA said the G.O. followed a flawed methodology. Post sanctioning is based on the sanctioned bed strength and whether a hospital was designated as a CEmONC centre, while the actual workload of GHs was not considered. Moreover, medico-legal and clinical workload were not considered. A 24-hour casualty duty doctor has to manage medicolegal cases, including Accident Register entries, and post-mortems, while also providing emergency and non-emergency outpatient services round-the-clock, it said.

The patient load has multiplied manifold in GHs since 2000, with no proportionate increase in the sanctioned posts of doctors and healthcare workers, it added. The SDPGA requested the Chief Minister and Health Minister to review G.O. 113 and rectify the shortfalls before implementation, and postpone the transfer and promotion counselling for Chief Civil Surgeons and Senior Civil Surgeons until then.

Varsity officials raise concern over plan to build memorial on University Union Grounds

Officials urge Higher Education Secretary to hold consultations before taking a decision; they demand that the ground be primarily used for sports and physical education activities

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A day after the government's proposal to build a memorial complex at the University Union Grounds was brought to light, officials of the University of Madras (UoM) met the Higher Education Secretary on Thursday to place on record concerns raised by Physical Education Directors (PEDs) and sportspersons.

Rita John, Registrar, UoM, told *The Hindu* that she met Higher Education Secretary Dheeraj Kumar to present the matter, and he assured her that he would take up the issue with the authorities concerned.

The State government plans to build the memorial complex for Queen Velu Nachiyar, Periyar E.V. Ramasamy, B.R. Ambedkar, K. Kamaraj, and Anjalai Ammal on a portion of University Union Grounds in Chetpet, Chennai.

"No decision has been taken as yet regarding the transfer of land," sources at the Department said.

University sources pointed out that among the demands put forth before the government was the need to hold wider consultations with the University authorities, PEDs of affiliated colleges, the University's Sports Department, its players, and other stakeholders before taking a decision.

The University requested the government to examine other appropriate locations so that the existing area of the University Union Grounds is left untouched. It demanded that the ground be primarily used for sports and physical education activities, and urged the government to examine the feasibility of the long-pending proposals for a swimming pool, tennis courts, a men's hostel, and a master plan for the development of the ground as a modern multi-sport facility.

The government plans to build a memorial complex for Queen Velu Nachiyar, Periyar E.V. Ramasamy, B.R. Ambedkar, K. Kamaraj, and Anjalai Ammal on a portion of the land in Chetpet. B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

Signed petition

Earlier, PEDs of affiliated colleges and players of the Madras University submitted a signed petition to the Registrar. Twenty-five PEDs and 100 players signed the petition, which highlighted the loss of trees and birds during the construction of the statues, which, they said, would endanger the natural vegetation.

They also flagged security concerns, stating that the presence of public statues could result in unregulated footfall and casual trespassing, creating safety issues for all students, particularly women athletes.

They also pointed to major parking issues and said the proposal could hinder the training regimen of sportspersons.

NGO alleges fraud in affiliation process of private teacher education colleges

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Arappor Iyakkam, an NGO working on transparency in governance, has filed a complaint with the State government, alleging serious discrepancies in affiliation inspection records of private teacher education colleges affiliated to the Tamil Nadu Teachers Education University (TNTEU) for the academic years 2023-24 and 2024-25.

Referring to records obtained under the Right to Information Act, 2005, the organisation said that at least 15 inspection committee conveners conducted in-person inspections in two to five colleges on the same day - March 29, 2023.

The complaint said one of the conveners conducted in-person inspections at five colleges on the same day. What was baffling was the fact that the total distance between these colleges stood at over 500 km, said M. Radhakrishnan of Arappor Iyakkam.

Similarly, at least 22 members of inspection committees were found to have conducted in-person inspections in two colleges on the same day. Some of the colleges were too far from each other to be covered within a day.

Moreover, five professors have been recorded as principals of two colleges during the same period, the organisation said in a release. It also found that the names of 37 faculty members, with the same names or initials, appeared across 222 college entries. One of the names (including initial), interestingly, appears in 11 college entries, while at least four other names appear in eight college entries each.

While not a proof of wrongdoing *per se*, these discrepancies raise serious questions that should be verified against original records, it said, and urged the government to conduct an independent inquiry into inspection reports, videos, attendance registers, travel and expense records, and faculty appointment and salary records.

It also demanded a probe into the managements of 74 colleges that received affiliation during 2023-24 and 2024-25.

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Bharatanatyam exponent Padma Subrahmanyam releasing the book at a function in Chennai on Thursday. R. RAGU

Book on Ramayana, Yogasutras launched

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The book titled *Tale of Two Realities: Exploring the Mind Through Patanjali's Yogasutras with Episodes from the Valmiki Ramayana*, written by renowned author Lakshmi Devnath and published by Krishnamacharya Yoga Mandiram (KYM), was launched on Thursday by Bharatanatyam exponent Padma Subrahmanyam.

Respects were paid to Sanskrit scholar Mahamahopadhyaya R. Krishnamurthi Shastri who passed away recently.

Ms. Subrahmanyam said Ms. Devnath was a prolific writer and erudite scholar. The book revealed her mastery over the Ramayana and the Yogasutras.

Yogacharya S. Sridharan, who offered his respects to R. Krishnamurthi Shastri, said the scholar was the first member of the KYM's board of studies and that he had left an indelible mark in the hearts of everyone who knew him.

Mr. Sridharan said the book was the product of over eight years of hard work and had overcome several hurdles. What started off as a Ph.D. thesis became a book. It was brought out as a series in the official magazine of Sri Ramakrishna Mission, *Vedanta Kesari*, in 2022.

Oncologist S.G. Ramanan, who received one of the first copies of the book, said the author and her husband Devnath made regular contributions to Cancare. KYM CEO Swaminathan also spoke.

Ms. Devnath said she had written several chapters during hospital stays and that, in the battle between the bed and the book, it was always the book that won.

Timings
CHENNAI

FRIDAY, OCT. 02			
RISE	05:59	SET	17:59
RISE	22:49	SET	11:15
SATURDAY, OCT. 03			
RISE	05:59	SET	17:58
RISE	23:53	SET	12:17
SUNDAY, OCT. 04			
RISE	05:59	SET	17:57
RISE	00:00	SET	13:15

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PERSONAL

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I, ALAMELU Manga .V D/o. K.Venugopal, DOB: 04/04/1992, Residing at No.7, Velayutham Street, Periyar Nagar, Avadi, Chennai-600 071, have changed my Name as Ammulu for All future purposes - Alamelu Manga .V

I Kamepalli Sivanjini Kumari W/O, T.k.purushothaman R/o 709, Gulmohar, alliance Orchid Springs, korattur, Chennai have changed my name to Sivanjini Kumari T.p..

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Tomorrow, Saturday, 3rd Oct, 6.00 PM at Vani Mahal A/c. "SALAAM E ISHQ" - An evening of melody, nostalgia and timeless spectacular musical celebration dedicated to the legendary Star of the Millennium, Amitabh Bachchan. Ftg. the powerful vocals of AAROH SHANKAR & DHARNA PAWA (Mumbai), SHIFA AFTAB (Indore), JOSYULA SHEKAR & ANUSHA KARTHICK (Chennai) with Grand Orchestration with the dynamic percussion of SHALOMI, creating a rich, energetic live-concert experience. One Star. Countless Memories. Timeless Music. Come, relive the magic and raise a musical Salaam to the legend! Tkts @ bookmyshow.com. Ct: 9710633633.

ABBAS / NT Fans
TODAY 6.00 PM @ Vani Mahal A/c. Celebrating 60 Years of Nadigar Thilagam Sivaji Ganesan's SARASWATI SABHATHAM & MOTOR SUNDARAM PILLAI - Two Classics, One Legend. Two unforgettable stories. But one extraordinary actor whose screen presence, voice, emotion and versatility made both films timeless. The evening will be presented by actor and raconteur Y.GEE. MAHENDRA, who will take audiences behind the scenes with fascinating anecdotes, memories and lesser-known stories surrounding these landmark films. Through carefully selected clippings of iconic scenes, memorable dialogues and live renditions of the evergreen songs by Kanakadhara Band the audience will revisit the grandeur, humour, emotion and music of an unforgettable era of Tamil cinema. Nadigar Thilagam Sivaji Ganesan - Forever on Screen, Forever in Our Hearts! Tkts @ bookmyshow.com. Ct: 8248871089.

Narada Gana Sabha
Ph: 24993201
Today Mini Hall (Swami Haridhos Giri Hall) Dr.S.Ramanathan Endowment Tamil Programme of Karuna Sagari - Bharathanatyam scheduled today is postponed due to unavoidable circumstances.

NADA SUDHA (Regd)
at Sri Ganapathy Sachchidananda Ashram Hall, Baby Nagar, Velachery.
Ph: 9176309996/9884949597
Today 02.10.2026 | 6:30 PM
"Sambar Vaali Sambu" - A play by Kathadi Ramamurthy- All are Welcome
In Association with: Nalli

Pushkaram Trust, 9884091618
4pm Prajna Adiga, Haritha Narayanan, Rohith A. 6.15pm Vivek Sadasivam, Bombay Madhavan, Arjun Ganesh, Dr. S. Karthick. Today at Ragasudha Hall.

The Indian Fine Arts Society, Ethiraja Kalyana Nilayam, 87 TTK Road, Alwarpet, Chennai 600 018 (Mobile 7845755481)
Today - Celebrating the composers - Sri G N B Kritis - 2.00 p.m. Shakthi Muralidharan - Subasri Sivaramakrishna - Aravindh Srikanth: 4.00 p.m. Sri Swathi Thirunal Kritis: G.Pranathi-Gayathri Vibhavari - Madurai T.Karthick: 6.00 p.m. Sri Papanasam Sivan Kritis" Jayalakshmi Sekhar (Veena)- Sherthalai R.Anantha Krishnan-Madiapakkam A.Murali: All are welcome: Venue Sponsors: Narayana Guruviah Chetty's Estate and Charities: Programme Sponsors: G N B Trust, H H Marthanda Varma Elayaraja of Travancore Trust.

MISCELLANEOUS

Sringeri Bharathi Vidyashram, T. Nagar. Ph: 24348964
Tomorrow 37th Aradhanai of H.H.Jagadguru Sri Sri Sri Abhinava Vidhyatirtha Mahaswamigal, 10 a.m Paduka Pooja, Aradhanai, 12 noon Mahadeeparadhanai, Pushpanjali to Paduka, Mahaprasadam. All are welcome.

The Madras Sanskrit College
TODAY 6.30pm Brahma Shree Angarai Ramanathan Iyer Endowment lecture in Tamil by Smt. Dr. S. Annapurna, on Sowbhagya Bhaskaram. A Commentary of Lalitasahasranamam at Sanskrit College Premises, Mylapore. All are welcome.

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Two held in ₹1,417-cr. investment fraud case

Unique Exports and associated entities mobilised funds from 35,759 investors on promise of high returns from agricultural exports, says ED

R. Sivaraman
CHENNAI

The Enforcement Directorate (ED) has arrested two men in connection with an alleged ₹1,417.86-crore investment fraud involving Unique Exports and its associated entities, which reportedly mobilised funds from 35,759 investors.

S. Naveen Kumar, 38, of Erode, and S. Muthuselvam, an ex-serviceman from Ramanathapuram, were arrested on September 29 under Section 19 of the Prevention of Money Laundering Act.

The ED launched the probe based on an FIR registered by District Crime Branch, Erode, under various provisions of the IPC and the Tamil Nadu Protection of Interests of Depositors (in Financial Establishments) Act. According to the ED, Kumar started Unique Exports and East Valley Agro Farms in 2017 and allegedly masterminded investment schemes operated under the names UNI, FNP, FAP, and UNR.

Banking analysis showed ₹390 crore as salary payments, despite only four persons being employed by the concern.

Investors were allegedly promised high returns from exports of agricultural commodities, though the firms did not undertake substantial exports.

The investigation found that about ₹719 crore was deposited in bank accounts linked to Unique Exports and its associates. Investor funds were allegedly routed through over 100 accounts held by the firms, family members, and associates.

Banking analysis showed that ₹390.90 crore was recorded as salary payments, despite only four persons being employed by the concern. Another ₹79.56 crore was recorded as payments for onion and commodity purchases, though the ED found no corresponding purchase of agricultural goods. The transactions were allegedly used to layer and conceal investor funds, it said.

The ED said Muthuselvam played a key role in mobilising investors and routing funds. Against an investment of about ₹42.10 lakh, he allegedly received around ₹12.72 crore as returns, commissions, and referral benefits. The funds were also routed through his personal accounts and entities linked to him, including Dhanyasree Enterprises and Universe369 Infra Private Limited.

Mortuaries in 10 govt. hospitals in T.N. to be upgraded at ₹8 crore

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Tamil Nadu government has given the nod for the construction and upgradation of mortuaries in 10 government hospitals and government medical college hospitals across the State. Funds to the tune of ₹8.85 crore were sanctioned for the works.

According to an order issued recently, the Government of India had approved ₹16.2 crore, under the National Health Mission (NHM) Record of Proceedings 2024-2026, for strengthening mortuaries in government hospitals in the State.

Based on this, the Mission Director, NHM-Tamil Nadu, sent proposals to strengthen the mortuaries at the following institutions – Government Headquarters Hospital, Pennagaram, Dharmapuri; Government Headquarters Hospital, Gudalur, the Nilgiris; Government Hospital, Arakkonam, Vellore; Government Erode Medical College and Hospital; Government Medical College and Hospital, Villupuram; Government Medical College Hospital, Thoothukudi; Government Medical College Hospital, Tirunelveli; Government Raja Mirasdar Hospital, Government Medical College, Thanjavur; Mahatma Gandhi Memorial Government Hospital, Tiruchi; and Government Hospital, Srivaikundam in Thoothukudi.

Accordingly, ₹65 lakh to ₹70 lakh each was allotted for government hospitals and headquarters hospitals and ₹90 lakh to ₹1.50 crore each was allotted for government medical college hospitals.

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Chennai Weather	max	min
Tiruvallur	36	23
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Chennai Airport Today
37°C The weather will be very warm and uneasy. Night will be comfortable. Spell of light rain and thundershower may occur.

Chennai Airport Tomorrow
36°C The weather will be very warm. Night will be comfortable. Chances of light to moderate rain and thundershower.

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REMEMBERING
Arutchelvar Dr. N. Mahalingam
21 March 1923 - 02 October 2014
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When the human resources are properly harnessed, India can emerge as a powerful economic power in the world.
Arutchelvar Dr. N. Mahalingam

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ISSN 0971 - 751X

INBRIEF

Traffic police hold helmet awareness rally in city

The Greater Chennai Traffic Police conducted a helmet awareness rally at Sivananda Salai on Thursday. The rally was launched by Deputy Commissioner of Police, Traffic East District, S. Megalina Eden. Students from three colleges, traffic wardens, and traffic police personnel participated. Ms. Eden said road accidents had declined compared with last year, mainly due to awareness programmes led by the police, greater compliance with helmet rules, strict enforcement based on automatic number plate recognition camera footage. "We are taking measures to ease traffic congestion on OMR and ECR by deploying additional personnel at key points and regulating traffic flow," she said.

SRMIST signs MoU with South Korean university

The SRM Institute of Science and Technology (SRMIST) has signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with South Korea's Jeonbuk National University (JBNU). The agreement provides for exchange of students, faculty, joint research and publications, and sharing of short-term academic programmes. The MoU was signed by S. Ponnusamy, Registrar, SRMIST, and Oh Byung-Taek, Dean, College of Environmental and Bioresource Sciences, JBNU. The MoU is expected to help students and faculty to engage with research environments in India and South Korea in areas including life sciences, environmental research and advanced materials.

THE HINDU
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Traffic violations by vehicles with missing number plates on rise

Commuters say traffic police do not check violations daily; officers say riders offer excuses, and many violators are students and youngsters

R. Srikanth
Sangeetha Kandavel
CHENNAI

Reckless act: Many riders on such vehicles are seen flouting several traffic rules, including wrong side driving. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Chennai's roads are increasingly witnessing two-wheelers, cars and even autos zipping around without the most basic identifier: a number plate. In some cases, political party names or symbols are painted on the vehicles.

Many riders, especially youngsters, on such vehicles are flouting the rules by driving on the wrong side of the road and entering one-way streets and roads in the wrong direction.

Commuters in Vandalur, T. Nagar, Nungambakkam, Anna Nagar, and Mogappair, with whom *The Hindu* spoke, said that vehicle checks are infrequent and that traffic police do not monitor violations daily.

"The traffic police should take strict action against such violations. Routine checks should be conducted not only during peak hours but throughout the day and night. If someone commits a crime and escapes in a vehicle without a proper registration number, how can the Crime Branch or investigating officers trace that vehicle?" asked Sudarshan, who commutes through Vandalur regularly.

A traffic police officer in T. Nagar said the police regularly check vehicles and fine those found without proper registration numbers. However, when caught, motorists often offer excuses that the vehicle is new and that they will get the registration number affixed soon. Some claim that the vehicle was old and that they were taking it to fix the number plates. "Most of them are college students and young boys," he said.

Another traffic police officer pointed out that such vehicles often manage to evade checks during peak hours and late evenings when traffic is heavy. Deploying more police personnel at crucial locations could help curb the practice, he suggested.

A senior official of the City Traffic police said fines are imposed regularly if complaints are received through social media of overspeeding, executing stunts, unauthorised parking of vehicles, and driving vehicles without number plates.

"Already in several places, based on complaints about wrong-side driving, teams of traffic enforcement officials conducted surprise road checks at several important junctions across the city and penalised nearly two lakh violators in the first week of September," the police officer said.

Govt. to set up 1,000 more automatic rain gauges; State to get 4 more weather radars

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Additional Chief Secretary B. Chandramohan speaking at the event in the city on Thursday. Mrutyunjay Mohapatra, Director General of Meteorology, IMD, is also present. J. JOHAN SATHYADAS

The State government has proposed adding 1,000 more automatic rain gauges (ARGs) across the State this year.

The Tamil Nadu Disaster Risk Reduction Agency (TNDRRA) has identified about 2,000 flood vulnerable locations across the State and chalked out location-specific plans for flood response during the ensuing Northeast monsoon, B. Chandramohan, Additional Chief Secretary and Commissioner of Revenue Administration and Disaster Management, said.

At the inauguration of the "Northeast Monsoon Seasonal Outlook Forum 2026," hosted jointly by the India Meteorological Department (IMD) and TNDRRA for the first time in the city on Thursday, he elaborated on flood mitigation and response plans.

The granular forecast provided by IMD at the village level has been useful for disaster management. Moreover, street-level forecasts that predict flooding three days prior, would also be done through the Integrated Flood Management Centre for Chennai Metropolitan Area with data obtained about various agencies, he said.

While TNDRRA has a network of 1,400 ARGs and 100 automatic weather stations, it plans to add 1,000 more ARGs in the State to reach the goal of covering every village panchayat with an ARG, he said, and called upon the National Institute of Ocean Technology to work with TNDRRA to finetune their forecast models.

Weather radars

Mrutyunjay Mohapatra, Director General of Meteorology, IMD, said the agency would establish new radars at Tiruchi, Kanniyakumari, Yercaud, and Ramanathapuram in the next few years to strengthen the observation network. Similarly, automatic rain gauges and automatic weather stations are being installed with IMD technical support, and the data generated would help assess hazards at the village level accurately. The forecast accuracy would further improve by 10% in the next three years, he said.

Noting that the forecast accuracy of weather events has increased since 2021, Mr. Mohapatra said that IMD was now providing spatial probability forecast, indicating areas likely to get above or below average rainfall. He said that Northeast monsoon is likely to set in between October 15 and October 21. Southern parts of Tamil Nadu and Kerala are likely to experience normal to above normal rainfall. Most areas of the remaining districts may receive below normal rainfall.

The prevailing El Nino is likely to become stronger till November 2026 and may lose strength later. However, El Nino conditions would persist till March 2027, he said. Strong El Nino conditions were associated with good rainfall before 2000, but had weakened over the last two decades. Overall, the State is expected to get normal monsoon rainfall this year.

During El Nino years, cyclones tend to have lower frequency and intensity, and a shorter track, he said. Experts also discussed the impact of El Nino on monsoon.

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
HIGHER EDUCATION DEPARTMENT
Lokseva Bhawan, Sachivalaya Marg, Bhubaneswar-751001
PT2-HE-SCH-POLICY-0001-2022/52861 /HE., Bhubaneswar, Dated:01/10/2026
Corrigendum-I
NOTICE INVITING RFP FOR SELECTION OF A CONSULTING FIRM/ ENTITY FOR ESTABLISHMENT OF STATE TECHNICAL SUPPORT GROUP (STSG) FOR SUPPORTING IMPLEMENTATION OF PRADHAN MANTRI UCHCHATAR SHIKSHA ABHIYAN (PM-USHA) IN HIGHER EDUCATION DEPARTMENT, GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
RFP No. PM-USHA:05/2026 Date: 17.09.2026

Sl. No.	RFP Cl. No.	Page No.	Description as per RFP	Now Modified Provisions
1	DATA SHEET (Sl. No.8 & 9)	4	Last Date & Time for receiving of Bid - 05/10/2026 At 5:30 PM	Last Date & Time for receiving of Bid - 15/10/2026 till 5:30 PM (Registered Post & Speed Post only)
2		4	Date & Time of Opening of Technical Bid - 06/10/2026 at 3:30 PM	Date & Time for Opening of Technical Bid -16/10/2026 at 3:30 PM

All other terms and conditions of the RFP remain unchanged.
11001/352/2627
Joint Secretary to Govt. & SPD, RUSA / PM-USHA
OIPR-11001/11001/1/26-27/0065

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TENDER NOTICE
Tender for rate contract and supply of Drugs for different healthcare facilities of state of Bihar
Notice Inviting Tender Ref No.: -BMSIC/DRUGS/26-12
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Tender Schedule

Tender Reference No.	BMSIC/DRUGS/26-12
Date of Pre-Bid meeting	07th October 2026 at 02:30 P.M. at BMSICL Conference Hall, 3rd Floor, Swasthya Bhawan, Behind IGIMS, Sheikhpura, Adjacent to State Health Society, Bihar, Patna - 800014
Last date and time of submission of online bids	28th October 2026 by 05:00 P.M.
Last date and time for submission of EMD and Tender Fees	30th October 2026 by 05:00 P.M.
Date, Time and Place of opening of Technical Bid	30th October 2026 (at 03:00 P.M.) on the website of www.eproc2.bihar.gov. in in the office of BMSICL
Date and time of opening of Financial Bids	To be announced later on www.bmsicl.gov.in and www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
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3. निविदा कागजात डाउनलोड एवं अपलोड करने की तिथि एवं समय : दिनांक : 10.10.2026 10:30 बजे पूर्वाहन से दिनांक : 14.10.2026 के 3:00 बजे अपराहन तक की अवधि (सिर्फ बेबसाईट http://eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)
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5. तकनीकी बिड खोलने की तिथि एवं समय : दिनांक :–16.10.2026 समय 03:30 बजे अपराहन। (सिर्फ बेबसाईट http://eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)
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7. निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय : सिर्फ बेबसाईट http://eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर
8. निविदा की वैधता अवधि (निविदा प्राप्ति की अंतिम तिथि से) : 120 दिन
9. विशेष जानकारी प्राप्त करने हेतु बेबसाईट http://eproc2.bihar.gov.in एवं बेबसाईटhttp://wrd.bihar.gov.in पर देखा जा सकता है।

(सुजीत कुमार)
कार्यपालक अभियंता
त्रिवेणी नहर प्रमंडल रक्सौल
PR- 012948 (WRD) 2026-27
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बिहार सरकार
जल संसाधन विभाग
कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
घोड़ासहन नहर प्रमण्डल, रक्सौल
पत्रांक :1317 / रक्सौल
Email-ID :eegcdraxaul@gmail.com Mob- 7463889660
अल्पकालीन निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना सं0–02 / SBD / 2026–27
राष्ट्रीय स्पर्द्धा निविदा आमंत्रण
(केवल ई–टेन्डर पद्धति के अनुसार बेबसाईट https://eproc2bihar.gov.inपर)
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1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
1.	रक्सौल विधानसभा क्षेत्र के अंतर्गत घोड़ासहन शाखा नहर के कि0मी0 24.38 से कि0मी0 49.35 तक नहर एवं इससे निःसृत बहादुरपुर उपवितरणी में गाद सफाई एवं संरचना मरम्मति कार्य ।	2290.41	32,91,000.00	10,000.00	11800.00	पूर्वी चम्पारण	चार माह

1. विज्ञापन दाता का नाम कार्यपालक अभियंता, घोड़ासहन नहर प्रमंडल, रक्सौल
2. निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना निर्गत करने की तिथि :– 29.09.2026
3. निविदा कागजात डाउनलोड एवं अपलोड करने की तिथि एवं समय : दिनांक : 10.10.2026 10:30 बजे पूर्वाहन से दिनांक : 14.10.2026 के 3:00 बजे अपराहन तक की अवधि (सिर्फ बेबसाईट http://eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)
4. प्री–बीड मिटिंग की तिथि एवं समय दिनांक– 12.09.2026 को अपराहन 03:00 बजे मुख्य अभियंता, सिंचाई सृजन, जल संसाधन विभाग, मोतिहारी के कार्यालय कक्ष में
5. तकनीकी बिड खोलने की तिथि एवं समय : दिनांक :–16.10.2026 समय 03:30 बजे अपराहन। (सिर्फ बेबसाईट http://eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)
6. वित्तीय बिड खोलने की तिथि एवं समय : सक्षम पदाधिकारी द्वारा बाद में घोषित की जायेगी (सिर्फ बेबसाईट http://eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)
7. निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय : सिर्फ बेबसाईट http://eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर
8. निविदा की वैधता अवधि (निविदा प्राप्ति की अंतिम तिथि से) : 90 दिन

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कार्यपालक अभियंता
घोड़ासहन नहर प्रमंडल
PR- 012945 (WRD) 2026-27
नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार।

बिहार सरकार
जल संसाधन विभाग
कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
सिंचाई प्रमण्डल, लक्ष्मीपुर
अल्पकालीन निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या – 03/2026–27
(केवल ई–टेन्डर पद्धति के अनुसार वेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)
1.कार्य का विवरणी: –

ग्रुप सं.	कार्य का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि (लाख रू0 में)	अग्रधन की राशि (रू0 में) (ऑन लाईन अथवा बैंक गरंटी में भुगतेय)	परिमाण – विपत्र का मूल्य (अप्रत्यपर्णीय) (केवल ऑन लाईन मोड में भुगतेय) रू0 मे	बेलट्रॉन को देय बिड प्रोसेसिंग फी (अप्रत्यपर्णीय) (केवल ऑन लाईन मोड में भुगतेय) रू0 में	कार्य समाप्ति का समय
01	02	03	04	05	06	07
01	सिंचाई प्रमंडल, लक्ष्मीपुर अंतर्गत बाजन वीयर योजना एवं आंजन जलाशय योजना का पुनर्स्थापन कार्य।	37.899	75800/-	5000/-	1180/-	6 Month

2. निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना निर्गत करने की तिथि : दिनांक – 29.09.2026
3. निविदा कागजात डाउनलोड एवं अपलोड करने की अवधि : दिनांक 23.10.2026 से दिनांक 27.10.2026 के 3.00 बजे अपराहन तक (सिर्फ वेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)
4. प्री–बिड मीटिंग का समय, स्थान एवं तिथि: दिनांक 26.10.2026 समय 3:00 बजे अपराहन अधीक्षण अभियंता सिंचाई अंचल खड़गपुर के कार्यालय कक्ष में।
5. तकनीकी बिड खोलने की तिथि एवं समय : दिनांक 29.10.2026 समय 3.30 बजे अपराहन में। (सिर्फ वेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)
6. वित्तीय बिड खोलने की तिथि एवं समय : सक्षम पदाधिकारी द्वारा बाद में घोषित की जायेगी (सिर्फ वेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)
7. निविदा खोलने का स्थान : www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर
8. निविदा की वैधता अवधि : 120 दिन
9. विज्ञापनदाता का पदनाम एवं पता : कार्यपालक अभियंता, सिंचाई प्रमण्डल, लक्ष्मीपुर ।
10. विशेष जानकारी प्राप्त करने हेतु वेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in , एवं state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar पर देखा जा सकता है ।

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सिंचाई प्रमण्डल, लक्ष्मीपुर,जमुई
मो0 – 7463889333
PR- 012905 (W R D) 2026-27
नशे की मार, बर्बाद करे सुखी परिवार।

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35-year-old man held for killing his wife

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A 35-year-old man was arrested by the Mangadu police on Wednesday night for killing his wife at their house in Pattur. The accused, B. Mujaideen, a butcher, stabbed his wife M. Sofiya, 24, in the neck following an argument on Tuesday night, the police said. The police said the couple frequently quarrelled, as Mujaideen allegedly suspected Sofiya's fidelity.

A police team nabbed Mujaideen on Wednesday night. He was subsequently arrested, produced before a court, and remanded in judicial custody.

Man held for duping nine people with fake govt. job orders

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

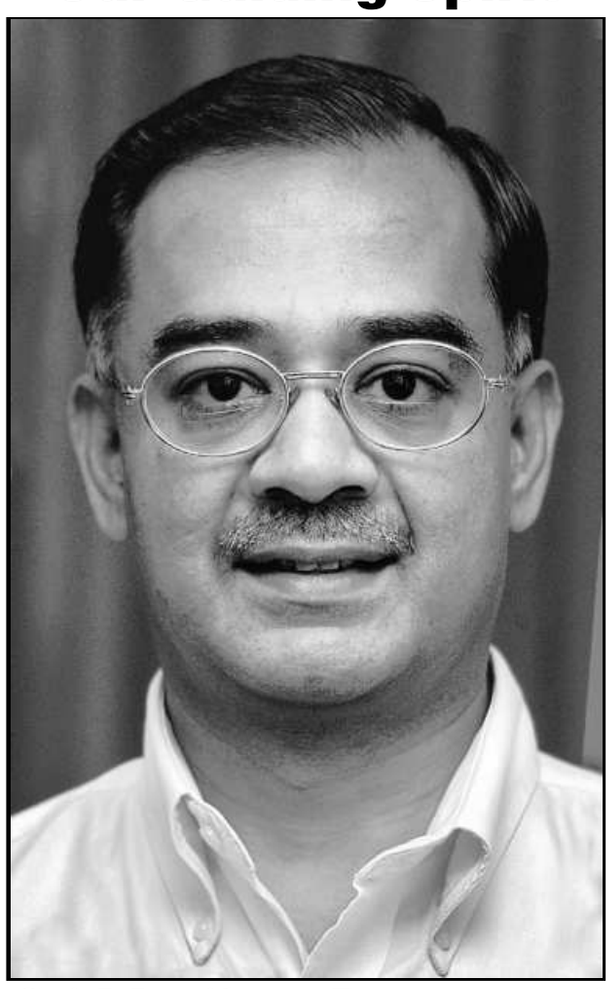
A 28-year-old man has been arrested by the Avadi Central Crime Branch for issuing fake government job orders to nine people.

According to the police, the accused, M. Deepak, 28, of Thiruverkadu, claimed that he was working as a secretary at the Secretariat. He promised to secure government jobs, including Village Administrative Officer (VAO), Revenue Inspector (RI), Deputy Tahsildar, and Tahsildar posts, for the complainant and her son, brother, nephew, and other relatives.

The police said Deepak collected up to ₹2 lakh from each person and received a total of ₹25,87,475. He allegedly handed them fake appointment orders, claiming that the jobs had been secured. Deepak was arrested in a case registered on September 29 based on complaints received from the nine people.

The police have appealed to anyone who may have paid Deepak money to approach the Avadi Central Crime Branch.

Our Guiding Spirit



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From Page One

Veeramani and his two accomplices detained under Goondas Act

A press release from the Commissioner's office said the action was taken as part of efforts to curb the activities of habitual offenders.

Meanwhile, the police released an update on further action in the child sexual abuse case involving Veeramani. They said they were probing the financial transactions made by the businessman.

The police said four cases had been registered so far under various provisions of the law, based on complaints, including those lodged by the girls and their relatives. The cases were under investigation, the police said, adding that they continued to receive complaints against Veeramani and the other accused.

A WhatsApp number, 9345319676, had been introduced for sharing information about the affected girls. So far, five useful pieces of information had been received through the number, and these were being verified, the police said.

Other detentions

Separately, the Commissioner invoked provisions of the Goondas Act to detain 11 others, including Sathish Kumar, 26, Manikandan, 20, Hariharan, 20, Paranitharan, 20, and Rakesh, 20, who were arrested in connection with the murder of a man named Kannan in Vannanthurai on September 5.

The police said all 14 accused had been arrested in their respective cases and remanded in judicial custody before the detention orders were issued.

The detention orders were issued by the Commissioner against those allegedly involved in offences such as murder, attempt to murder, narcotics offences and sexual offences, which posed a threat to public order.

(Assistance for overcoming suicidal thoughts is available on the State's health helpline 104 and Sneha's suicide prevention helpline 044-2464 0050)

INBRIEF

TNCC chief flays Centre for rise in commercial LPG prices

Tamil Nadu Congress Committee (TNCC) president and MP Manickam Tagore on Thursday criticised the Centre over the rise in commercial LPG cylinder prices ahead of Navaratri and Ayudha Puja. He said the price of a 19-kg commercial LPG cylinder in Chennai had increased from ₹1,726.50 in June 2014 to ₹2,983 in October 2026 – a 72.78% hike – during the Narendra Modi-led regime at the Centre. He said the price rise was placing a heavy burden on small businesses, including restaurants and tea shops, particularly during festive seasons. He also criticised the Centre over the proposed MDR charges on UPI transactions, saying the measure would affect small traders.

HC clears decks for conduct of bypoll in Ambasamudram

Justice P.B. Balaji refuses to reject election petition filed against the victory of Esakki Subaya, but strikes off petitioner's plea to declare runner-up V.P. Durai of Congress as the returned candidate

Mohamed Imranullah S.
CHENNAI

The Madras High Court has cleared the decks for the conduct of byelections to two more constituencies by rejecting an election petition with respect to the Perundurai constituency and striking off a plea to declare the runner-up in the Ambasamudram constituency as the returned candidate.

Justice P.B. Balaji on Thursday refused to reject an election petition filed by a voter challenging the victory of Esakki Subaya from the Ambasamudram Assembly constituency, but struck off the relief sought by the election petitioner to declare the runner-up, V.P. Durai of the Congress, as the winner.

The judge dismissed an application filed by Mr. Subaya – who had won as an AIADMK candidate, but later resigned from his post and joined the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam – to reject the election petition preferred by S. Kanthimathinathan.

He, however, allowed another application filed by Mr. Subaya to strike off the relief sought by the election petitioner under Section 84 of the Representation of the People Act, 1951, to declare Mr. Durai as the returned candidate.

The judge agreed with senior counsel Satish Parasaran, appearing for Mr. Subaya, that when there were more than two candidates who had contested in an election, the runner-up could not automatically be declared as the elected candidate if the election petitions are allowed, and that the only course of action available would be to order fresh elections.

"In the present case, I am conscious of the fact that despite being the returned candidate, the first respondent (Mr. Subaya) has resigned from his MLA post and the electorate remains unrepresented as on date. But, for the prayer sought for invoking Section 84 of the R.P. Act, read with Section 101 of R.P. Act, the Election Commission would be clearly well within its right to conduct a fresh election," Justice Balaji said.

The judge, however, said the election petition that had challenged the victory of Mr. Subaya for having allegedly indulged in electoral corrupt practices must go to trial.

> Despite being the returned candidate, the first respondent (Mr. Subaya) has resigned from his MLA post and the electorate remains unrepresented
>
> **JUSTICE P.B. BALAJI**
> Madras High Court

Justice Balaji's order striking off the relief sought under Section 84 of the R.P. Act assumes significance in light of the fact that Ambasamudram was one of the five constituencies where byelections had been stalled by the first Division Bench of the High Court on the ground that conduct of bypolls pending the plea under Section 84 might end up in an anomalous situation of those constituencies being represented by two individuals.

Stalled bypolls

The Bench, comprising Chief Justice Sushrut Arvind Dharmadhikari and Justice G. Arul Murugan, had on July 10 restrained the Election Commission of India (EC) from notifying bypolls to Tiruchi East, Perundurai, Ambasamudram, Viralimalai, and Karur, while passing interim orders on a PIL petition filed by K. Venkatachalapathy of Tirunelveli.

After the grant of the interim order, the EC filed a counter-affidavit before the Division Bench, stating that it, too, did not intend to conduct bypolls to the five constituencies.

However, after the filing of the counter-affidavit, Justice D. Bharatha Chakravarthy of the High Court on September 8 rejected the election petition against the victory of S. Jayakumar, who had won from Perundurai as an AIADMK candidate but resigned as an MLA before joining TVK.

Hence, in the written submissions filed before the first Division Bench during the final hearing on the PIL petition, the EC urged the Bench to exempt Perundurai alone from its interim stay order.

The EC told the court that a byelection could be conducted in Perundurai if the Supreme Court does not grant any stay, and if the Division Bench excludes it from the constituencies where bypolls had been stalled.

During the hearing of the PIL petition on Thursday, senior counsel G. Masilamani, representing Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay, brought Justice Balaji's order to the notice of the Division Bench and said the EC would now have to conduct bypolls to both Perundurai and Ambasamudram. After hearing all arguments, the Division Bench reserved its judgment on the PIL petition filed through advocate V.R. Shanmuganathan.

ED takes up ₹100-cr. cheating case against former DMK Minister

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Anbil Mahesh Poyyamozhi

The Enforcement Directorate (ED) has launched a probe into an alleged ₹100-crore cheating case against former School Education Minister Anbil Mahesh Poyyamozhi, B.T. Arasakumar and others.

The agency had registered a case based on the FIR filed by the Central Crime Branch (CCB), and had begun tracing the money trail, sources said.

The CCB arrested Mr. Arasakumar, who claimed to be the founder-president of the Tamil Nadu Private Schools Association, an unregistered body, in June. He and the other accused allegedly collected more than ₹100 crore from several private school managements by claiming that he had contacts in the government, and could secure permissions and approvals for establishing and upgrading schools and obtain other necessary orders.

Subsequently, Sections 7 and 12 of the Prevention of Corruption Act, 1988, were added to the FIR. According to the FIR, Mr. Arasakumar induced private school administrators to pay him money by promising to secure government approvals and other official orders. The FIR also refers to a previous case of a similar nature registered against him in Crime No. 8 of 2013 by the District Crime Branch, Pudukottai.

Based on the evidence gathered during the investigation, the CCB had initiated action against Mr. Anbil Mahesh under the provisions of the Prevention of Corruption Act.

Searches by CCB

On September 16, the CCB conducted searches at nine locations, including four premises linked to Mr. Anbil Mahesh in Chennai and Tiruchi, as well as those linked to his aides Valadi Karthik, Arun Prakash and Prakash. Property documents, bank details, cheques and electronic devices were seized. Mr. Anbil Mahesh was also questioned in connection with the case.

The ED subsequently obtained the case records from the CCB and launched its investigation to trace the alleged proceeds of the offence and the money trail.

Mr. Arasakumar was granted 'default bail' by a special court last Tuesday after the investigating agency failed to file its final report within the mandatory 90-day period.

High Court takes up *suo motu* PIL petition for removal of caste appellations from names of streets, roads, localities

Mohamed Imranullah S.
CHENNAI

The court directed the government to submit a status report within four weeks, listing the references removed and those that were yet to be removed

The Madras High Court on Thursday took up a *suo motu* public interest litigation (PIL) petition to enforce a series of directions it had passed over the years to ensure the removal of caste appellations from the names of streets, roads, and localities across Tamil Nadu.

The first Division Bench of Chief Justice Sushrut Arvind Dharmadhikari and Justice G. Arul Murugan directed the State government to submit a status report within four weeks, listing the references that had been removed so far and those that were yet to be removed.

The *suo motu* PIL petition was taken up on the basis of the latest order passed by Justice N. Ramesh on August 11 – his first order after being elevated as a judge of the High Court. In his order, the single judge had lamented the existence of such appellations.

After coming across a first information report (FIR) in which the Sendhamangalam police in Namakkal district had referred to a place as 'Pallar Street', the judge had wondered how such appellations continued to exist despite a series of judicial directions and government orders (G.O.s) passed since 1978.

The judge had told State Public Prosecutor R. John Sathyan that a G.O. issued in 1978 had insisted that all local bodies identify caste appellations in the names of streets and roads and remove them. Thereafter, the High Court, too, had issued a series of directions since 2018.

'Serious consequences'

Justice Ramesh had said the naming of a street or a road after a caste had serious consequences, as the residents of those places get identified by their caste, and those names get reflected in every other official document, such as ration card, Aadhaar card, driving licence, and so on.

Highlighting the constitutional imperative to create a casteless society, the judge had said it was in that direction that Justice D. Bharatha Chakravarthy of the High Court had ordered the removal of caste appellations from the names of all schools and colleges in Tamil Nadu.

Referring to the Tamil Nadu government renaming the Adi Dravidar Welfare Department as the Social Justice Department in order to avoid reference to a caste, Justice Ramesh had said the exercise would remain incomplete unless all caste appellations were removed from the names of streets and roads.

Since he had come across the FIR during the hearing of a bail petition, the judge had directed the High Court Registry to register a *suo motu* case with respect to the deletion of caste appellations from the names of streets and roads, and place it before the Chief Justice for appropriate orders.

Vijay urges people to buy khadi, village products

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

On the occasion of Gandhi Jayanti on October 2, Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay has appealed to the people of Tamil Nadu to purchase khadi clothes and products made in villages to help improve the livelihoods of spinners, weavers, and artisans.

In a statement, Mr. Vijay said Mahatma Gandhi, who wielded non-violence as a weapon, taught every Indian the importance of economic freedom and self-reliance through the spinning wheel. "When we purchase a khadi garment, it is a recognition of a weaver's skill. When we purchase a village product, it is a mark of respect for an artisan's labour. When we use a locally manufactured product, it encourages the productive capacity of our land," he said.

DMK man arrested in Srirangam temple land fraud case

The Hindu Bureau
TIRUCHI

The Tiruchi City Crime Branch (CCB) on Thursday arrested N. Ramkumar, a DMK functionary, in connection with a case of alleged cheating and fraud involving a piece of land belonging to Sri Ranganathaswamy Temple in Srirangam during 2022-23.

The arrest comes after the CCB registered a case against Ramkumar and five others, including the then Sub-Registrar of Srirangam, on September 13 under various provisions of the Indian Penal Code, acting on a complaint lodged by the temple's Joint Commissioner/Executive Officer S. Sivaramkumar.

Ramkumar and the other accused allegedly entered into a criminal conspiracy to commit the crime, which led to the temple land being registered illegally in the name of Ramkumar, who is the DMK's Srirangam area secretary, using forged documents.

Valued at ₹50 crore

The extent of the land – said to be valued at over ₹50 crore – illegally registered in the name of Ramkumar was over 7,000 sq. ft. in Srirangam. Four private individuals, who claimed to own the land, had registered it illegally in the name of Ramkumar using forged documents. The amount received in the alleged land transfer was over ₹2 crore.

Police sources said the CCB team, headed by an Inspector, arrested Ramkumar on Thursday in connection with the case. Further investigation is under way.

HC grants Sri Lankan woman 60 days to regularise relationship with Indian man

B. Tilak Chandar
MADURAI

The Madurai Bench of the Madras High Court has granted 60 days to a woman from Sri Lanka, professing the Hindu faith, and her husband, an Indian citizen following the Christian faith, to regularise their relationship by solemnising a valid marriage under any of the applicable statutory forms.

The court was hearing a petition filed by the woman. The petitioner and her husband got married in the presence of the latter's family members in Tiruchi district in June. She had arrived in India in May on a one-month tourist visa. She was entitled to stay in the country from May 14 to June 13. The petitioner is now pregnant, and the expected date of delivery is in March 2027.

The woman sought a direction to the authorities concerned to register the marriage and grant her a visa extension/regularisation application on the basis of the marriage solemnised/registered.

Complex situation: The court says several complications have arisen on account of the petitioner having breached the conditions of the tourist visa granted to her for a limited period.

Justice C. Saravanan said several complications had arisen on account of the petitioner having breached the conditions of the tourist visa granted to her for a limited period.

Section 15(a) of the Special Marriage Act, 1954, deals with the registration of marriages celebrated in other forms. Under the provision, a marriage ceremony must have been performed between the parties, followed by their having lived together as husband and wife ever since, the court said.

Marriage recognition

The ceremony undergone by the couple does not, strictly speaking, answer to any recognised form of marriage ceremony. The factum of the petitioner's pregnancy has now presented a *fait accompli*, the court said.

"The court is not inclined to disrupt the relationship arising out of the ceremony undergone by the couple. However, the court is inclined to grant them 60 days to regularise their relationship by solemnising a valid marriage under any of the applicable statutory forms, namely the Hindu Marriage Act, 1955, or the Indian Christian Marriage Act, 1872, or the Special Marriage Act, 1954," the court said.

For the aforesaid period, the court directed that the petitioner shall not be deported. In the event of the marriage being solemnised and registered within the said period, the petitioner shall be permitted to continue to remain in the country, subject to the applicable law, the court said.

Protect jobs linked to rural transformation project: EPS

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

AIADMK general secretary Edappadi K. Palaniswami on Thursday urged the TVK-led government to protect the employment of workers attached to the Tamil Nadu Rural Transformation Project, also known as the Vaazhndhu Kattuvom Project, whose services were reportedly discontinued with effect from September 23.

Mr. Palaniswami also urged the State government to clear the pending two-month salary dues of the workers. Highlighting the hardship faced by them in finding employment elsewhere, as they had spent most of their employable years on this project, he urged the State government to utilise their services for the Vaazhndhu Kattuvom Project 3.0 as well.

THE HINDU
Air Surcharge as applicable:
New Delhi - Rs. 15/-;
Port Blair - Rs. 20/-

COMPREHENSIVE ANNUAL MAINTENANCE CONTRACT

E-Tender Notice No. KIR-N-2026-K-35 Dated: 29-09-2026. Works tenders through "E" Tendering system for and on behalf of the President of India are invited for the works as detailed below:- **Name of work:** Comprehensive Annual Maintenance Contract of CEL make MSDAC system at Kumedpur station of Katihar Division. **Tender Value:** ₹57,25,728/-. **Earnest Money:** ₹1,14,500/-. **Date & time of closing of tender:** At **15.00** hrs. **& opening at 15.30 hrs. on 21-10-2026.** The complete information with tender documents of above e-tender will be available upto **15.00** hrs. on **21-10-2026** in the website **www.ireps.gov.in**

DRM (S&T)/Katihar
NORTHEAST FRONTIER RAILWAY
Serving Customers With A Smile

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY

256 Sig/28/2026-27 Dated: 29/09/2026
E-TENDER NOTICE
NO:- S N T-JU-28-2026-27

Open E-tender is invited by DRM(S&T), Jodhpur for and on behalf of the President of India for S&T work. Details as below: **Name of Work:** Comprehensive Annual maintenance contract of IPS of Amara Raja make installed at various stations over Jodhpur Division of NW Railway. **Estimated cost of the work:** ₹ 1,41,23,462/- (R/O), **Address of the NIT Issuing office:** Sr. DSTE/JU NWR, DRM Office Harish Joshi Marg Jodhpur. **Bid security to be deposited:** ₹ 282500/-, **Last Date & time for submission of E-tender and opening of tender:** 23/10/2026 Up to 15:00 Hrs through E-tendering online submission on IREPS, Tender will be opened at 15:00 Hrs. **Website particulars, where complete details of tender can be seen and participated: www.ireps.gov.in** Note: This is a E-Tender, so tenderer can participate through e-tendering process only on mentioned website. **1406-PH/26**

Follow us on /NWRailways NWRailways_

PROVISION OF ASPIRATION TYPE SMOKE DETECTOR SYSTEM AT ALL LC GATE

Tender Notice No.: RN-ST-22-2026-27, **Date**: 28-09-2026. E-Tender are invited by the undersigned for the following work; **Tender No.:** RN-ST-22-2026-27; **Name of Work :** Provision of Aspiration type Smoke Detector System at all engineering interlocked LC gates as per RDSO's TAN vide No. STS/E/AFD&SS Vol.-V dt: 17/02/2025 in Rangiya Division. **Tender Value:** ₹4,70,75,503.05/-; **Earnest Money:** ₹9,41,500/-; Date & time of **closing** of tender at **15:00** hrs. and **opening** at **15:30** hrs. on **30-10-2026**. Complete information alongwith tender document of above e-tender are available in the website **www.ireps.gov.in**

DRM (S&T), Rangiya
NORTHEAST FRONTIER RAILWAY
Serving Customers With A Smile

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER

For and on behalf of the President of India, the Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer (G) S.E. Railway, Kharagpur -721301 invites e-tenders for the following work before 12:00 hrs. on the date mentioned against items : **Sl. No.; Tender Notice No.; Description of work; Tender Value & Bid Security/E.M.D. respectively : (1) 114-ELC-G-KGP-26-27-27;** Electrical work for facade lighting arrangement for 10 Nos. Station (Kharagpur, Medinipur, Ghatsila, Jhargram, Mecheda, Panskura, Bagnan, Jaleswar, Andul & Uluberia Stations) under Amrit Station development work; ₹ 2,76,34,289.29; ₹ 5,52,700.00; **(2); 114-ELC-G-KGP-26-27-28;** Supply, Installation, Testing & Commissioning of 16 Nos. Divyang Lifts for SG2 and SG3 category of Station under Kharagpur Division along with 10 years Comprehensive Annual Maintenance Contract; ₹ 6,59,10,240.00; ₹ 13,18,200.00; **Cost of Tender Document :** NIL (for Sl. No. 1 & 2); **Completion Period :** 12 months for both Sl. No. (1) & (2) from the date of issue of Letter of Acceptance. **Date of Submission:** up to 12:00 hrs. of 22/10/2026 (for Sl. No. 1 & 2); **Date of Opening :** 22/10/2026 (for Sl. No. 1 & 2); Interested Tenderers may visit website **www.ireps.gov.in** for full details, description and specification of the tender and submit their bids online. In no case manual tender for this work will be accepted. **Note:** Prospective bidders may regularly visit **www.irens.gov.in** to participate in all tenders. **(PR-837)**

WEST CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE
DATE - 29/09/2026

E-tender is invited from reputed and experienced contractor by the undersigned for and on behalf of the president of India, for the following:- **Tender No.** ELECT-GEN -BPL-T -33-2026, **Name of work :** Part(A):BINA-Construction of New Running Room (G+2) having 60 Rooms with 2 bed each at east side of station, Site Area 3701.76 sqm. Part(B): Itarsi Construction of New Running Room (G+1) having 30 Rooms with 2 bed each at Old ADEN office, Itarsi (GF & FF area-989.24sqm X 2 =1978.48sqm). Part(C): ET Capacity Augmentation of New Guard Running Room at Itarsi, 6 Rooms with 2 bed each, kitchen and dining at Itarsi. Part(D): Bhopal -Construction of New Running Room (G+1) having 35 Room with 2 bed each near BPL lobby at BPL (GF and FF 47.72m X 12.55m X 2 = 1197.76 sqm). **Completion Period :** 06 Months, **Estimated cost in Rs.:** 20041167.71, **Earnest money in Rs.:** 400800.00, **Date and Time for closing of tender:** 19/10/2026 11:00 Hrs, The details of complete tender documents and its related information may be seen at https://www.ireps.gov.in and notice board of this office. Manual offer, for above said tender is not acceptable and if any manual offer submitted, will not be considered. Corrigendum / Updating, if required, will be uploaded on website, it may be seen at above said URL and notice board of this office, till the date of closing of tender. The Contractor must read the all tender documents as uploaded on IREPS along with all conditions carefully to know the eligibility for participation in tender and documents etc. to be submitted along with offer. Only documents uploaded on IREPS along with offer by the contractor will be considered for finalization of tender.

For Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer (General) West Central Railway, Jabalpur

स्वच्छ भारत अभियान
एक कदम स्वच्छता की ओर

PUNJAB STATE TRANSMISSION CORPORATION LIMITED

CORPORATE IDENTITY NUMBER: U40109PB2010SGC033814 www.pstcl.org

Office of: CE / P&M, PSTCL, Ludhiana-141001.
Tel No. 0161-2456704 & Mob-9646118208 email: srxen-proc-ldh@pstcl.org

Sr. No.	Description of Tender
1	**Tender Reference No. 185 /2026-27** **(Open Tender)** The department of Punjab State Transmission Corporation Limited invites online bids for **"Supply & Commissioning of Twenty (20) nos. 15 kV Insulation Testers for 400/220/132 kV Substation under P&M organization in PSTCL"** **Closing date and Time: 02.11.2026 11:00 AM** **Opening date and Time: 04.11.2026 11:00 AM**

Note: It is informed that in case tender process is not completed due to any reason, no corrigendum will be published in newspapers. Details regarding corrigendum may be seen on official PSTCL website www.pstcl.org. Terms and conditions may be downloaded from PSTCL's web site https://eproc.punjab.gov.in

Sr. Xen. / W&A,
1078/12/2026-27/15810 **O/o CE/P&M PSTCL, Ludhiana**

गणितीय विज्ञान संस्थान, चेन्नई
THE INSTITUTE OF MATHEMATICAL SCIENCES, CHENNAI
(Department of Atomic Energy, Govt. of India)

अक्टूबर / October 01, 2026

विज्ञापन संख्या / Advt No.04-R/IMSc/2026

गविसं द्वारा नियमित संकाय पदों **(7 वें सीपीसी के तहत वेतन मैट्रिक्स में स्तर-12 एवं स्तर-13)** पर सीधी भर्ती हेतु ऑनलाइन आवेदन आमंत्रित किए जाते हैं। विस्तृत जानकारी के लिए, कृपया हमारी वेबसाइट देखें: https://www.imsc.res.in/facultyrecruitment

IMSc invites online applications for Direct Recruitment for filling up regular **Faculty positions (Level - 12 and Level - 13 in Pay Matrix under 7th CPC).** For more details, please visit website: **https://www.imsc.res.in/facultyrecruitment.**

Sd/-
कुलसचिव / REGISTRAR

DELHI TRANSCO LIMITED

Expression of Interest (EOI)

DTL intends to invite following Expression Of Interest (EOI):

Inviting stakeholder inputs and feedback to validate and strengthen the bidding process for establishing public EV charging and battery swapping infrastructure under the Delhi EV Policy, 2026.

For complete details of EOI please visit website:- https://dtl.gov.in.

Inputs may be submitted within **07 days** of this publishing through:
https://docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLSdWs_QD5i3Kh3fUL4idBISyNy4Yo3j9-eNIIWusz2ZIQJjFpg/viewform?pli=1&pli=1.

Any stakeholder / individuals willing to offer land parcels, parking areas or premises for the establishment of EV charging or battery swapping stations may furnish site details via:
https://docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLSddpitB62KBFaJh8jZpY9fOx8sBepLCH8Y7euKB DiP4rFAw/viewform?usp=preview.

NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY

CORRIGENDUM
website: www.ner.indianrailways.gov.in Date: 01.10.2026

Under noted amendment is hereby made against tender No. 29265364 due on 05.10.2026 Tender Notice No. 10 dt. 02.09.2026 (Item No. 08). **Item No.:** 8; **Item Description:** Tender Opening date-with time; **Existing Entry:** 05.10.2026 at 11:30 am.; **Amended as:** 12.10.2026 at 11:30 am. **Description may be viewed at IREPS website.** All other terms and condition will be remained unchanged. **Note:** Above information may be seen on N.E. Railway website **www.ner.indianrailways.gov.in** & Govt. of India's website **www.tenders.gov.in.**

Principal Chief Material Manager,
CPRO/S-69 **Gorakhpur**

DO NOT SMOKE BIDI/CIGARETTE IN TRAINS

PROVISION OF DIGITAL 25W-VHF SETS

E-Tender Notice No. N-2026-27-TSK-NIT-04; Dated: 28-09-2026. E-tenders are invited by the undersigned for the following works: **SN. 1**; **E-Tender No.:** N-2026-27-TSK-T-04. **Brief Description of Item:** Provision of digital 25W-VHF sets with voice recording at all stations in Tinsukia division. Tender Value: ₹3,37,05,803.70; Earnest Money: ₹6,74,100.00; E-tender will be **closed** at 15:00 hrs. on 26-10-2026 and **Opened** after 15:30 hrs. on 26-10-2026. The complete information with the tender document of above e-tender will be available in website **www.ireps.gov.in.**

DRM (S&T), Tinsukia
NORTHEAST FRONTIER RAILWAY
"Serving Customers with a smile"

MAHARASHTRA METRO RAIL CORPORATION LTD.

Maha Metro, Block No. A3, Food Grain Godown, Near Civil Court, Next to Kamgar Putala Vasahat, Shivajinagar, Pune - 411005
e-mail: tenders.pmrp@mahametro.org
Website: www.punemetrorail.org
E tender portal: https://mahatenders.gov.in
Telephone: 020-26051074

NOTICE INVITING TENDER (NIT)

Tender Notice No. P1-0&M-25/2026 **Date: 02.10.2026**

Name of Work: Annual Rolling Shutter Maintenance of 30 Nos of Elevated & Underground Stations and 2 Depots of Pune Metro Project for a period of One Year

Tender available from **16:00 Hrs. on 09/10/2026 to 16:00 Hrs. of 22/10/2026.**

For all above Tenders Interested bidders may visit Pune Metro Rail website **www.punemetrorail.org** or Download the Tender documents and obtain further details regarding the Tender from e-tender portal of Govt. of Maharashtra **https://mahatenders.gov.in**.

AGM (Procurement & Contracts)
Maharashtra Metro Rail Corporation Limited.
Maha Metro, Greenest Metro

ರಾಜೀವ್ ಗಾಂಧಿ ಆರೋಗ್ಯ ವಿಜ್ಞಾನಗಳ ವಿಶ್ವವಿದ್ಯಾಲಯ, ಕರ್ನಾಟಕ
Rajiv Gandhi University of Health Sciences, Karnataka

4th T Block, Jayanagar, Bengaluru-560041
E-mail : registrar@rguhs.ac.in Tel : +91-80-29601928

PUBLIC NOTICE – 2026
ADVISORY TO STUDENTS, PARENTS AND CAREER ASPIRANTS

It has come to the notice of the University that certain individuals and institutions, including those operating outside Karnataka, are falsely claiming affiliation with Rajiv Gandhi University of Health Sciences (RGUHS) and are using such claims to solicit admissions from students.

RGUHS was established under an Act of the Karnataka State Legislature, and its jurisdiction is limited to the State of Karnataka. The University has not affiliated any college, institution or course operating outside Karnataka.

The University therefore advises students, parents and career aspirants to exercise utmost caution and rely only on information published through the official RGUHS website and verified social media platforms.

Students and parents are advised to note:

- RGUHS has not affiliated any college or institution outside Karnataka.
- RGUHS does not offer any course through correspondence, distance learning or online mode.
- The list of affiliated colleges, approved courses and sanctioned intake must be verified only through official RGUHS platforms.
- Do not rely on information circulated through unofficial websites, social media accounts, individuals or other unauthorized sources.
- RGUHS does not authorize any agent, broker, consultant or middleman to secure admission to its affiliated institutions.
- Admissions to health sciences courses are conducted through KEA or MCC, as applicable, and students should follow only the official admission procedures.
- Any institution or individual falsely claiming RGUHS affiliation should be reported to the University and the appropriate government authorities.

Students and parents are strongly advised not to pay money or share personal documents with unauthorized individuals or institutions claiming to facilitate RGUHS admissions.

RGUHS issues this advisory in the public interest to protect students and parents from misleading claims and fraudulent admission practices.

For authentic information regarding admissions, affiliated institutions, courses, sanctioned intake and other academic matters, please refer only to the official RGUHS website and verified social media platforms.

Sd/-
Registrar

DIPR/CP/3030/AKAR/2026-27

GOVERNMENT OF MEGHALAYA
EDUCATION DEPARTMENT

No.EDN.124/2026/29 Dated Shillong, the 30th September, 2026

PUBLIC NOTICE

Conduct of examinations and academic progression of existing enrolled students of CMJ University, Meghalaya

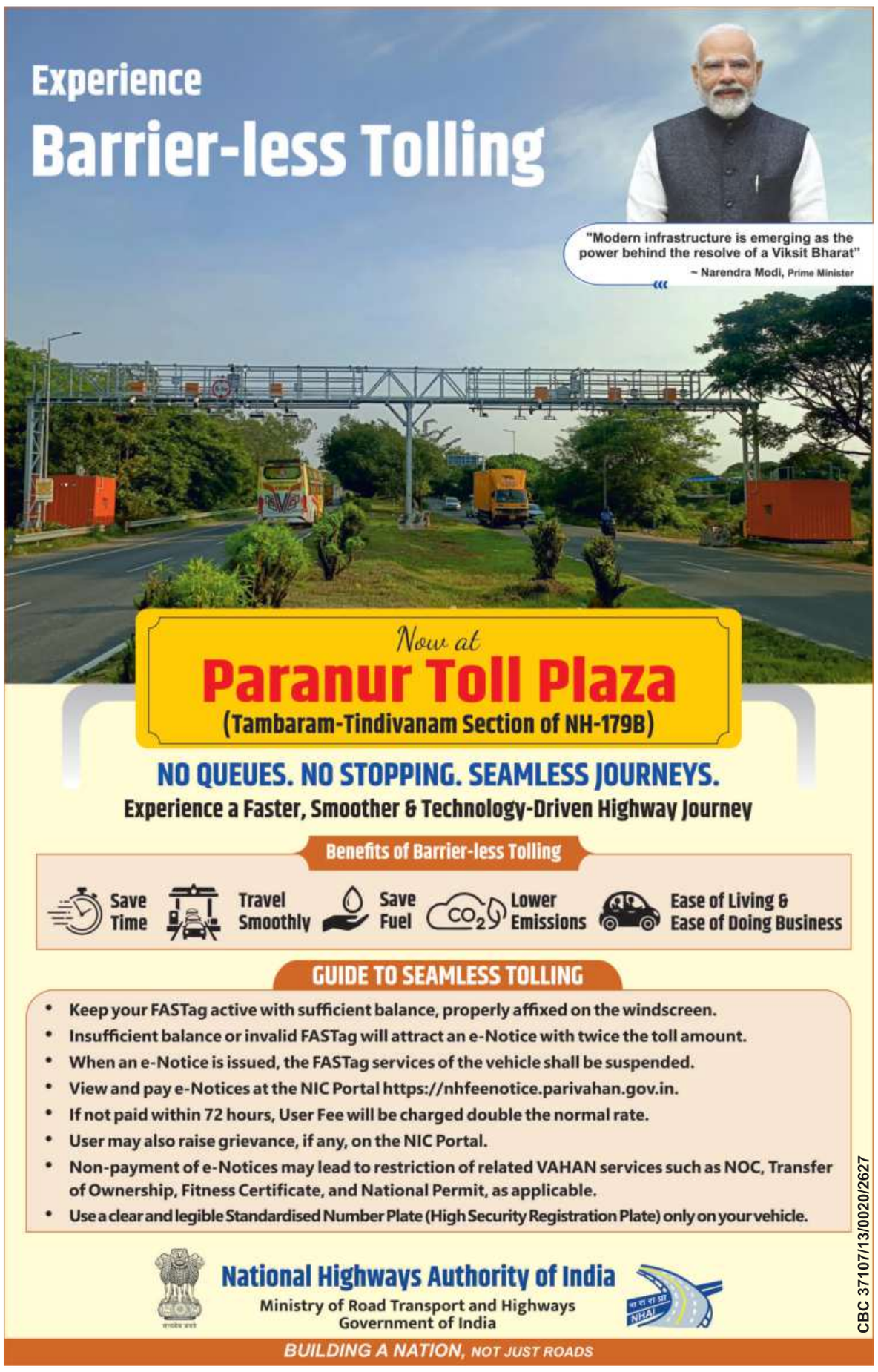
With reference to the UGC letter D.O.No.8-21/2010(CPP-I/PU)/78587, dated 02-09-2026, the office of the Administrator, under the Government of Meghalaya, is directed to inform all students of CMJ University as follows:-"All students presently studying Diploma, Undergraduate and Postgraduate programmes at the University may be allowed to appear in examinations conducted under the supervision of an external agency/ third party, under the overall responsibility of the State Education Department."

Therefore, students are required to complete the form to submit their personal details for the examination using the QR code provided. Failure to submit the details will hinder the examination process, as these details are needed to arrange examinations with third-party institutions. The form link will remain active to accept responses until 01-11-2026.

Link - https://forms.gle/3aMvMVWX2DxnNSzv5

Sd/-
Administrator of CMJ University, Meghalaya
& Joint Secretary to the Govt. of Meghalaya
Education Department

MIPR No. : 1769
Dated : 30-09-2026



Not informed of key decisions of Keralam govt.: UDF convener

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

The tensions simmering within Keralam's ruling United Democratic Front (UDF) exploded on Thursday, with its convener Adoor Prakash coming out openly against Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan and stating that he was being "kept in the dark about important government decisions."

Expressing his displeasure at a press conference in Thiruvananthapuram, Mr. Prakash indicated that the Chief Minister, in his capacity as UDF chairman, had not taken the initiative to convene a meeting of the UDF. Mr. Prakash added that he had become aware of several decisions taken by Mr. Satheesan's government "through the media".

According to him, he was not informed about Wednesday's Cabinet decision to appoint IUML leader M.K. Muneer chairman of the State Administrative Reforms Commission and Forward Bloc leader G. Devarajan as the State government's representative in New Delhi.

Mr. Prakash said his remarks should not be misunderstood as an attempt to blame the Chief Minister. "Anyhow, I was not aware of these decisions as the UDF convener. They were taken without my knowledge," he said.

Mr. Prakash added that it was "unfortunate" if the UDF convener should become aware of decisions through the media.

A.P. HC strikes down 34% BC quota in local body elections

Court says the reservation exceeds the 50% threshold laid down by the Supreme Court; it further directs State government and State Election Commission to begin poll process within six weeks

V. Raghavendra
VIJAYAWADA

A Division Bench of the Andhra Pradesh High Court, comprising Chief Justice Lisa Gill and Justice Challa Gunaranjan, on Thursday set aside Government Orders 105 and 1065 through which the government provided 34% reservation to the Backward Classes (BCs) in Panchayat Raj Institutions (PRIs) and 33.33% quota in the Urban Local Bodies (ULBs).

The court said that they exceeded the 50% threshold laid down by the Supreme Court.

While striking down the impugned G.O.s, the court

The High Court gives liberty to the State to revisit the issue and determine the percentage of reservation for BCs. FILE PHOTO

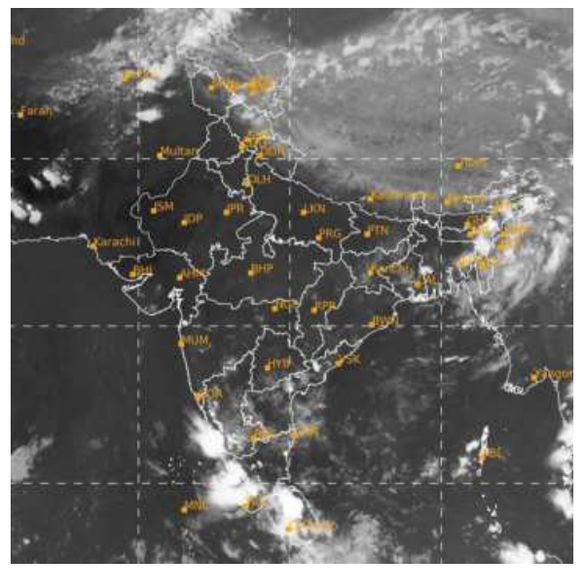
gave liberty to the government to revisit the issue and determine the percentage of reservation for BCs keeping in view the apex court judgment in *Janhit Abhiyan vs Union of India* after completing the exercise of data collection in compliance with the judgment in *Vikas Kishanrao Gawali vs State of Maharashtra*. The judges have expressed the opinion that the empirical data collected by the State through unified family survey cannot form the basis of declaration for reservation for the BCs. In the same vein, the court directed the State government and the State Election Commission (SEC) to expeditiously commence the process of holding elections to the PRI and ULBs preferably not later than six weeks from October 1.

Continued operation of electoral rolls in existence on the qualifying date cannot be affected by the special intensive revision (SIR) and it cannot be the reason for postponement of the elections, the judges said.

On delimitation of Municipalities and Municipal Corporations, they said the Census Act of 1948 or Census Rules, 1990 do not prohibit the State from undertaking the process.

WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday



TEMPERATURE DATA: IMD, POLLUTION DATA: CPCB, MAP: INSAT/IMD (TAKEN AT 18.15 HRS)

Forecast for Friday: Heavy rainfall likely at isolated places over Arunachal Pradesh. Thunderstorm with lightning/gusty winds likely at isolated places over Assam, Meghalaya, Nagaland, Manipur, Mizoram, Tripura, Sikkim, West Bengal, Odisha, Andhra Pradesh, Tamil Nadu, Puducherry, Karaikal, Keralam, Mahe and Lakshadweep

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN
Agartala	—	35.2	26.0	Kurnool	—	37.6	26.2
Ahmedabad	—	36.0	23.3	Lucknow	—	33.0	23.1
Aizawl	41.6	26.6	20.0	Madurai	—	38.0	26.6
Bengaluru	6.3	30.3	19.9	Mangaluru	—	32.6	25.0
Bhopal	—	34.8	19.6	Mumbai	4	34.0	25.0
Bhubaneswar	—	35.6	25.5	Mysuru	12.5	30.4	21.0
Chandigarh	—	34.6	21.8	New Delhi	—	35.2	24.0
Chennai	—	36.2	27.2	Patna	—	33.0	25.9
Coimbatore	1.5	35.4	20.5	Port Blair	9	31.2	25.5
Dehradun	—	33.4	20.1	Prayagraj	—	34.4	24.4
Gangtok	—	24.5	17.6	Puducherry	—	33.8	24.6
Goa	—	32.6	25.8	Pune	—	34.5	22.4
Guwahati	—	33.5	26.0	Raipur	—	33.4	24.9
Hubballi	—	32.0	22.0	Ranchi	—	29.4	19.8
Hyderabad	—	34.0	22.9	Shillong	11	23.6	16.6
Imphal	12.8	27.2	21.0	Shimla	—	26.0	16.5
Jaipur	—	35.5	25.8	Srinagar	—	29.3	10.2
Kochi	—	31.8	27.4	Thiruvananthapuram	—	33.5	25.1
Kohima	13	20.1	17.6	Tiruchirappalli	11	35.1	24.4
Kolkata	—	33.6	27.6	Vijayawada	—	33.8	26.2
Kozhikode	—	36.5	27.2	Visakhapatnam	—	33.2	25.7

(Rainfall data in mm; temperature in Celsius)

Pollutants in the air you are breathing

CITIES	SO_2	NO_2	CO	PM2.5	PM10	CODE
Ahmedabad	.36	..22	39	... 103	...110	
Bengaluru	.15	..24	.—	 33	...154	
Chennai	...6	..13	53	 63	...126	
Delhi	.20	..48	52	... 190	...217	
Hyderabad	.10	..13	..7	... 117	...103	
Kolkata	...9	..65	42	... 156	...137	
Lucknow	..—	9	41	... 150	...104	
Mumbai	.12	..42	51	 97	...107	
Pune	.15	..75	62	 82	...158	
Visakhapatnam	...5	..62	15	... 100	...162	

Yesterday

In observation made at 4.00 p.m., Fatehpur Sikri, Uttar Pradesh recorded an overall air quality index (AQI) score of 324 indicating an unhealthy level of pollution. In contrast, Aizawl, Mizoram recorded a healthy AQI score of 26

Air Quality Code: Poor Moderate Good (Readings indicate average AQI)

SO_2: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.

NO_2: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.

CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.

PM2.5 & PM10: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

Keralam Minister's vehicle attacked; DYFI workers held

The Hindu Bureau
KANNUR

A protest by Democratic Youth Federation of India (DYFI) workers turned violent when the car of Minister for Sports and Youth Affairs O.J. Janeesh was attacked and damaged during a confrontation near the taluk hospital, in Taliparamba, Keralam, on Thursday.

Following the attack, the police arrested six DYFI workers.

As the Minister returned from a review meeting, DYFI workers waved black flags, raised slogans and struck his vehicle, allegedly damaging its rain guard and the flagpole on the vehicle. DYFI leaders Muhas and Prajeesh Babu were reportedly among those leading the protest.

The situation remained tense as protesters demanded the release of Mr. Muhas. They also demanded that workers who had been put into police vehicle at the scene be released. The situation escalated when protesters allegedly manhandled police personnel. Following the attack, the police arrested six workers.

DYFI workers attacking the car carrying Minister O.J. Janeesh at Taliparamba in Kannur on Thursday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Meanwhile, Home Minister Ramesh Chennithala in a statement alleged that incident was part of an attempt by the Communist Party of India (Marxist) and DYFI to create unrest in the State following the loss of power. He added that such attempts to attack Ministers would be dealt strongly.

Mr. Chennithala said there were grounds to suspect a conspiracy behind incidents involving Ministers being stopped and attacked on the road. He said a comprehensive investigation would be conducted and strict action would be taken against those found responsible.

Bulk filing of Form 7 against Muslims seen at Kodagu poll booth

Rishita Khanna
BENGALURU

In a similar trend seen across multiple Assembly constituencies in Karnataka, where pre-filled Form 7 applications were filed in bulk seeking deletion of Muslim voters' names, at least 50 applications were filed against Muslim names at a single polling station at the Government Higher Primary School at Bydagotta in Kodagu district on September 23 alone.

The objectors said the forms had been sent from the "party office".

All the applications cited "absent" as the reason for deletion. Data accessed by *The Hindu* shows that at least 50 Form 7 applications were filed by objectors named Rajni, B.N. Basavaraju, Lokesh, Savitha Malali, and A.C. Nagaraj. However, officials in Somwarpet where the polling station is, said they had not received any of these applications. When contacted by *The Hindu*, Mr. Basavaraju and Ms. Rajni said they had filed 10 applications each, claiming they had "doubts" that the voters had "duplicate" entries.

Asked why "absent" had been cited as the reason when they had claimed the voters had duplicate entries, the objectors said they did not know the details and had followed instructions from the party office in Somwarpet.

They further declined to name the party but added that five people were given 10 forms each.

However, it is to be noted that the forms were already printed with the voters' names and EPIC numbers.

Cong. seeks probe into deletion in Telangana

Swathi Vadlamudi
HYDERABAD

A complaint to Chief Electoral Officer C. Sudharshan Reddy by the Telangana Pradesh Congress Committee about pre-printed applications for bulk deletion of voter names in the Musheerabad constituency has opened a can of worms, adding to fears about a particular section of the electorate being targeted during the SIR.

The fresh allegations are about a booth-level agent of the BJP from Musheerabad submitting Form-7 applications seeking deletion of names of the Congress's BLA and over 30 members of his family. The names of all the family members along with the address were pre-printed on the forms, with only the name of the applicant hand-written.

Your feedback will keep us Cleaner, Sharper and Bolder

Call our toll-free number
1800 102 1878
Or write to us at
customercare@thehindu.co.in

Scan the QR code to register your feedback

THE HINDU | the hindu businessline | FRONTLINE | SPORTSTAR | The Hindu Young World | THE HINDU

INBRIEF

MRPL offers ₹1.2 cr. aid to kin of employee who died in fire

Mangalore Refinery and Petrochemicals Limited (MRPL) on Thursday announced compensation of ₹1.2 crore to the family of 30-year-old contract employee Manish Karkada, who died in a fire in the unit, while a group of contract employees carried out a protest in front of the company's gate demanding adequate compensation to the deceased and other injured persons. MRPL said it will give financial support of ₹90 lakh to the family. Besides, the family was eligible for about ₹10 lakh under Group Term Life Insurance and ₹20 lakh under Workmen Compensation Policy. A two-member committee visited the site of the accident on Thursday as part of the statutory inquiry.

Association of Malayalam film actors gets new office-bearers

Actors Asha Aravind and Sijoy Varghese have been elected as the vice-presidents of the Association of Malayalam Movie Artistes (AMMA) in a revamp after the actors' body plunged into organisational turmoil following the general body meeting in Kochi on June 21, 2026. An executive committee meeting of the association held here on Wednesday elected them to the posts of vice-president, which had remained vacant after the resignation of actors Lakshmipriya and Jayan Cherthala. Neena Kurup is the new treasurer and Sarayu Mohan is the new joint secretary.

Fake Form 7 applications: five FIRs registered across Karnataka

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU/BELAGAVI

A total of five FIRs were registered across Karnataka on Thursday, over the submission of Form 7 applications in bulk, seeking the deletion of names of voters predominantly from the minority and Dalit communities during the ongoing SIR. Three FIRs named BJP members as the accused. While two FIRs each were registered in Belagavi and Mysuru districts, another was registered in Bidar district. A similar complaint was filed in Vijayapura city, but no FIR was registered.

It is alleged that many of the Form 7 applications were made using fake documents and false information and many voters were portrayed as being of Bangladeshi, Pakistani, or Rohingya origin.

Government of Odisha
Information & Public Relations Department
Lok Sampark Bhawan, Bhubaneswar

File No. IPR-FP-IITF-0002-2026/ 15323 / IPR, Bhubaneswar, Dated 30/09/2026

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL

01. Director, I&PR Department, Government of Odisha (The Client) invites **Request For Proposal (RFP) from the eligible bidders to Conceptualize, Design and Fabricate the Odisha Pavilion at India International Trade Fair (IITF) - 2026, Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi.**
02. Key objectives, scope of work, eligibility requirement, layout plan, technical specifications and other details may be seen in and downloaded from https://inpr.odisha.gov.in/ or, https://odisha.gov.in.
03. Last date for receipt of sealed proposal is **14.10.2026 by 05:00 PM.**
04. RFP will be opened on **15.10.2026 at 11:30 AM** in the Conference Hall, Lok-Sampark Bhawan, Unit-V, Keshari Nagar, Bhubaneswar.
05. Pre-Bid consultation with intending bidders is scheduled to be held on **06.10.2026 at 11:30 AM** in the Conference Hall, Lok-Sampark Bhawan, Unit-V, Keshari Nagar, Bhubaneswar.
06. The I&PR Department have the right to accept or reject the Tender(s) without assigning any reason thereof.
07. Corrigendum, addendums, clarifications or cancellations if any shall only be published in the above-mentioned websites.

DIRECTOR, I&PR
15001/106/2627 OIPR-15001/15001/1/26-27/0106

Man executed in Saudi Arabia in drug case; kin say he was deceived

The Hindu Bureau
MALAPPURAM

Abootti Valliyil from Mahe was executed at Dammam prison in Saudi Arabia on September 27 after being arrested in a drug case.

His family said he was deceived into driving a vehicle across the Saudi Arabia-Oman border on December 2, 2023, unaware that 43 kg of methamphetamine was hidden inside the fuel tank.

The 41-year-old was working at a mobile shop in Oman when a customer from Kannur, who had offered to help him secure a job and a Saudi visa, asked him to drive the vehicle across the border.

Saudi authorities intercepted and arrested him.

Initially sentenced to 25 years in prison and fined one million Saudi riyals, he was later given the death sentence.

He is survived by his mother, wife, two children, and three sisters.

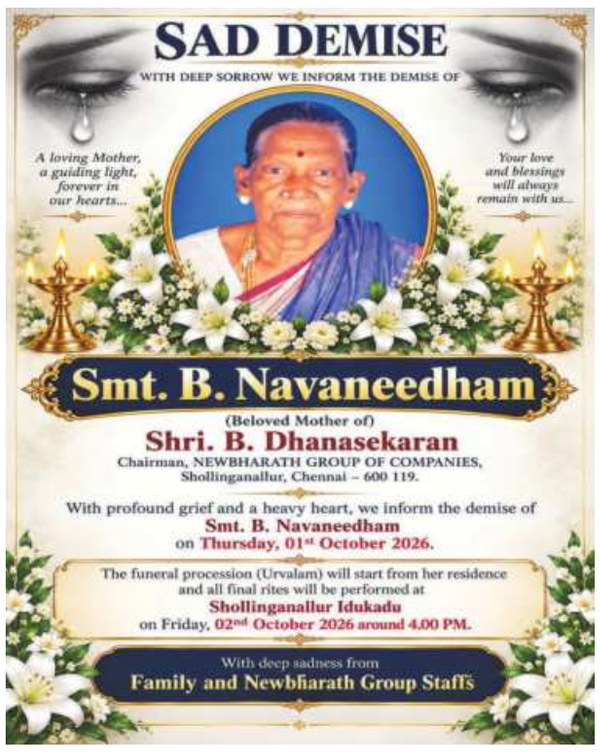
The family alleged that the Kannur man admitted to the deception and offered a financial settlement, but failed to secure Abootti's release.

His execution has renewed concern among expatriates regarding Indians facing drug-related cases in Gulf countries.

For Abootti's family, however, the immediate priority is justice. They want authorities to investigate the incident and take action against those responsible.

OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

DEATH

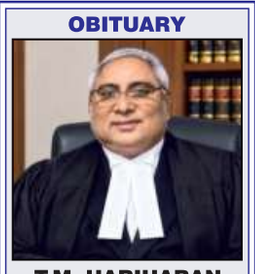


BIRTH CENTENARY

BIRTH CENTENARY REMEMBRANCE, S.Marimuthu, B.A., B.Com., Director of Local Fund Audit (Rtd.), in fond memory of family

DEATH

OBITUARY



T.M. HARIHARAN
Advocate, High Court
S/o. Late T.R. Mani
Senior Advocate

Date of Demise: 30.09.2026

A life defined by kindness, integrity and quiet strength. His warmth and guidance remain with us every day.

DEEPLY MOURNED BY

Family, Juniors and Staff
70101 33663
TSR Venkatramana (Uncle)
98401 28718
Mahesh Srinivasan
(Brother in law)

DEATH

Mrs. M. Shyamala
W/o. Dr. A. Mahali
Date of Birth : 03.07.1953
Date of Demise: 01.10.2026

Regret to inform that **Mrs. M. Shyamala** w/o **Dr. A. Mahali** passed away peacefully on **01.10.2026,** around **1:10 a.m.** The **last rites** will start on **02.10.2026, by 9.00 a.m.** at home, followed by cremation at **Velangadu - Gasfire Crematorium,** Anna Nagar East, Chennai by **11.00 a.m.**

Dr. A. Mahali & Family Members.
9840162080 | 9750970709 | 9840093256

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

In Loving Memory

MR. P. KANDAIAH
Retd. Chief General Manager, VSNL
D.O.B: 03.10.1933 - D.O.D: 02.10.2022

Remembering a life well-lived, filled with love and kindness. Though you're gone, you're forever in our hearts.
Family & Friends

GOVERNMENT OF TAMILNADU
DIRECTORATE OF MEDICAL EDUCATION AND RESEARCH,
SELECTION COMMITTEE, KILPAUK, CHENNAI -600010

NOTIFICATION

Admission to M.Sc Nursing course for 2026-2027 session

Online filled in applications are invited for admission to M.Sc Nursing courses for 2026-2027 session.

The details relating to the application fee, eligibility, etc., will be available in the prospectus published in the official website **www.tnmedicalselection.net** on 02.10.2026 @ 12.00 Noon.

➤ Date of Notification	02.10.2026
➤ Date of Commencement of online application	02.10.2026 @ 12.00 Noon
➤ Last date for online submission of application	07.10.2026 upto 11.55 P.M.

DIPR / 859 / DISPLAY / 2026 **DIRECTOR OF MEDICAL EDUCATION & RESEARCH (FAC)**

Uttar Pradesh State Institute of Forensic Science, Lucknow
Aurawan, Daroga Kheda, P.O. Banthra,
Lucknow -226401

(Expression of Interest)

UPSIFS, Lucknow (Established in 2021) functioning under the aegis of the Home Department, Govt. of U.P. & affiliated with the National Forensic Science University, Gandhinagar, Gujarat. UPSIFS, Lucknow is inviting Expression of Interest (EOI) for the operation of the Lunch, Dinner and High-Tea catering services during official events, conference and seminars for the academic session 2026-27. The details of EOI are available on institute website www.upsifs.ac.in. Last date for the participation is 08.10.2026.

RO NO: 257462 **Sd/-**
Ro date: 01-10-26 **AD/SP**
Website: www.up.gov.in **UPSIFS, Lucknow**

अखिल भारतीय आयुर्विज्ञान संस्थान, बीबीनगर
ALL INDIA INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES, BIBINAGAR
हैदराबाद मेट्रो पोलिटन क्षेत्र (एचएमआर), तेलंगाना – 508126, भारत
Hyderabad Metropolitan Region (HMR), Telangana-508126, India

संख्या/No. AIIMS/BBN/RECT/DEPUTATION/2026/1393 दिनांक / Date: 14.08.2026

RECRUITMENT NOTICE
RECRUITMENT OF VARIOUS NON-FACULTY POSTS
(ON DEPUTATION & CONTRACTUAL BASIS)
AT AIIMS BIBINAGAR

All India Institute of Medical Sciences, Bibinagar, an Autonomous Institute of National Importance under Ministry of Health & Family Welfare, Government of India, invites the applications from suitable candidates:-

For various non-faculty posts **on deputation basis** i.e., for the posts of Medical Superintendent (01), Superintending Engineer (01), Nursing Superintendent (02), Assistant Accounts Officer (02), Personal Assistant (01), Technicians (Laboratory) (05), Upper Division Clerk (03).

Applications are also invited for the post of **Consultant (Audit) (01) on contract Basis**.

Last date for the receipt of duly filled in offline application along with requisite documents through proper channel is **45 days from the publication of Notice in the Employment News/Rozgar Samachar**. For further details such as pay scales/remuneration, educational qualifications, age, experience, other eligibility criteria, etc., please visit institute's website i.e., https://aiimsbibinagar.edu.in.

Sd/-
उपनिदेशकप्रशासन/Deputy Director Administration
एम्स, बीबीनगर/AIIMS, Bibinagar

Government Engineering College, Samastipur
राजकीय अभियंत्रण महाविद्यालय, समस्तीपुर

SHORT TERM NOTICE

WALK-IN-INTERVIEW FOR GUEST ASSISTANT PROFESSOR/ GUEST INSTRUCTOR

Advt. No.- GEC/SAM/01/2026-2027

Government Engineering College, Samastipur is going to conduct a walk-in-interview for the empanelment of GUEST ASSISTANT PROFESSOR/ GUEST INSTRUCTOR in various departments/subjects as per the requirement on temporary basis. Interested and eligible candidates may appear for the walk-in-interview with all their original academic certificates, category Certificate, Residential Certificate, a hard copy of CV, 02 sets of photocopies of original documents/certificates, and 02 recent passport size photographs as per the following schedule.

Department/Subject	Name of Post	Date and Time of Interview	Eligibility
Computer Science & Engineering	Guest Assistant Professor	28/10/2026 (Wednesday)	As per AICTE & DSTTE, Patna norms
Electronics & Communication Engineering			
English			As per AICTE/UGC & DSTTE, Patna norms & The qualifications for recruitment of faculty in the disciplines of Basic Sciences, Social Science and Humanities shall be as per the UGC Notification no. F. l-2/2017 (EC/PS) Dated 18th July, 2018 and UGC guidelines issued from time to time.
Physics			
Electrical Engineering	Guest Instructor (Wireman/Electrician)		As per AICTE & DSTTE, Patna norms

Important Instruction

1. Essential qualifications are as per AICTE/UGC/DSTTE Norms.
2. Ph.D. and GATE qualified candidates will be preferred for Guest Assistant Professor.
3. Retired candidates will get preference.
4. This engagement will be purely temporary, need and remuneration-based alternative arrangement.
5. Remuneration for Guest Assistant Professor/ Guest instructor will be as per existing rules and directives of DSTTE, Government of Bihar.
6. The Institute reserves the right to withdraw the partial or full advertisement/notification w.r.t. walk-in-interview without assigning any reason.
7. The services of Guest Assistant Professor and Guest Technical Assistant/Instructor will be terminated without notice if found unsatisfactory. No claim will be entertained in this regard.
8. No TA/DA will be paid for attending the Interview.
9. Reservation as per existing state Government rules attach your updated cast certificate
10. Visit ours official website- https://www.gecsamastipur.org.in for any instruction & information or further updates.

For further details please visit : **www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar**

PR. No. 012884 (Sci. & Tech.) 2026-27

Principal In-charge,
G.E.C. Samastipur.

नशे की मार, बर्बाद करे सुखी परिवार।

South Bihar Power Distribution Co. Ltd, Patna Bihar
Registered Office: Vidyut Bhawan, Bailey Road, Patna-21
A Govt. of Bihar undertaking
CIN No. U40109BR2012SGC018890
(Department of Stores & Purchase)
Govt. of Bihar

SHORT TENDER NOTICE
NIT No. 85/PR/SBPDCL/2026
(Through e-procurement mode only - www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)

South Bihar Power Distribution Co. Ltd. (SBPDCL), a Government of Bihar Undertaking, invites online tender for procurement of 11 KV 3 element outdoor type oil immersed combined metering unit of CT & PT of 0.2s accuracy class for SBPDCL & NBPDCL in Two-tier (Techno-Commercial & Price) online bid from eligible and experienced Original Manufacturer as detailed below:-

Name of material	Quantity	Cost of tender Document including GST@18%, Rs	Total Estimated Cost including GST@18%,Rs	Earnest Money Deposit, Rs.
11 KV 3 element outdoor type oil immersed combined metering unit of CT & PT of 0.2s accuracy class	10/5A-700 nos. 25/5A-800 nos., 50/5A-200 nos., 100/5A-70 nos.	11,800/-	15,19,03,170/-	25,19,035/-

The Time line for the above tender is as follows:

Last Date of Online Submission of bid along with Tender Cost & processing fees:	13.10.2026, up to 18:00 Hrs
Last Date of submission of EMD and hard copy of receipt of BSEDCL processing fee &tender cost	14.10.2026, up to 15:00 Hrs
Date of opening of Techno-Commercial bid(Part-I)	14.10.2026, after 17:00 Hrs
Date of Pre Bid Meeting:	07.10.2026, at 15 :00 Hrs; Venue: SBPDCL, Vidyut Bhawan-3, Patna

BSEDCL(BELTRON) Processing fee & tender cost are mandatory to be paid through online mode i.e. Internet Payment gateway (credit / debit card), net banking, NEFT/RTGS. Bids along with necessary online payments must be submitted through e-payment portal www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in before the date and time specified in the NIT. EMD in prescribed format and hard copy of receipt of BSEDCL processing fee & tender cost must be submitted to Electrical Superintending Engineer (Purchase), SBPDCL within specified time failing which bid of the firm shall be summarily rejected. The department does not take any responsibility for the delay / Non submission of Tender / Non Reconciliation of online Payment caused due to Non- availability of Internet Connection, Network Traffic/ Holidays or any other reason.

Date of opening of price part: To be notified after Technical Bid Evaluation at www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in

e-tendering introduced in BSPHCL for tenders above Rs. 25 lacs.

For registration logon to www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in and Eproc2 Helpdesk Details: Toll Free Number: 1800 572 6571, Email Id: eproc2support@bihar.gov.in, Working Hours: 8AM to 7PM (All days in week except few selected state holidays).

While participating in e-tendering process, the contractor shall have to get them registered to get user ID, Passwords and digital signature. This will enable them to access the Website: www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in only

For complaints regarding corruption Vigilance Help Line No.- 9431821485, 0612-2504969.
Consumer can deposit electricity bills via Sahaz Vasudha Centre or http://bills.sbpdcl.in/

'' विवादों के निष्पादन के लिए लोक अदालत का लाभ उठावें '' ''परस्पर सहमति से न्यायिक निर्णय प्राप्त करें '' ''समय एवं खर्च की बचत करें।''

Note:- Subsequent information/notification/corrigendum will be available only on website of EPROC and/or SBPDCL i.e. www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in and/or www.sbpdcl.co.in.

PR. No. 012851 (B&C) 2026-27 **Electrical Superintending Engineer (Purchase)**

सुरक्षित जीवन अपनाओ, अपनी नियमित एच.आई.वी. जाँच कराओ।

South Bihar Power Distribution Co. Ltd, Patna Bihar
Registered Office: Vidyut Bhawan, Bailey Road, Patna-21
A Govt. of Bihar undertaking
CIN No. U40109BR2012SGC018890
(Department of Stores & Purchase)
Govt. of Bihar

Short Tender Notice
NIT No. 86 /PR/SBPDCL/2026
(Through e-procurement mode only - www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)

South Bihar Power Distribution Co. Ltd. (SBPDCL), a Government of Bihar Undertaking, invites online tender for procurement of 33 KV 3 element outdoor type oil immersed combined metering unit of CT & PT of 0.2s accuracy class for SBPDCL & NBPDCL in Two-tier (Techno-Commercial & Price) online bid from eligible and experienced Original Manufacturer as detailed below:-

Name of material	Quantity	Cost of tender Document including GST@18%, Rs	Total Estimated Cost including GST@18%,Rs	Earnest Money Deposit, Rs.
33 KV 3 element outdoor type oil immersed combined metering unit of CT & PT of 0.2s accuracy class	25/1A-70 nos. 50/1A-60 nos., 100/1A-40 nos., 200/1A-10 nos., 400/1A-05 nos., 600/1A-05 nos. Total-190 nos.	11,800/-	2,68,67,900/-	5,37,358/-

The Time line for the above tender is as follows:

Last Date of Online Submission of bid along with Tender Cost & processing fees:	13.10.2026, up to 18:00 Hrs
Last Date of submission of EMD and hard copy of receipt of BSEDCL processing fee &tender cost	14.10.2026, up to 15:00 Hrs
Date of opening of Techno-Commercial bid(Part-I)	14.10.2026, after 17:00 Hrs
Date of Pre Bid Meeting:	07.10.2026, at 15:00 Hrs; Venue: SBPDCL, Vidyut Bhawan-3, Patna

BSEDCL(BELTRON) Processing fee & tender cost are mandatory to be paid through online mode i.e. Internet Payment gateway (credit / debit card), net banking, NEFT/RTGS. Bids along with necessary online payments must be submitted through e-payment portal www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in before the date and time specified in the NIT. EMD in prescribed format and hard copy of receipt of BSEDCL processing fee & tender cost must be submitted to Electrical Superintending Engineer (Purchase), SBPDCL within specified time failing which bid of the firm shall be summarily rejected. The department does not take any responsibility for the delay / Non submission of Tender / Non Reconciliation of online Payment caused due to Non- availability of Internet Connection, Network Traffic/ Holidays or any other reason.

Date of opening of price part: To be notified after Technical Bid Evaluation at www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in

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'' विवादों के निष्पादन के लिए लोक अदालत का लाभ उठावें '' ''परस्पर सहमति से न्यायिक निर्णय प्राप्त करें '' ''समय एवं खर्च की बचत करें।''

Note:- Subsequent information/notification/corrigendum will be available only on website of EPROC and/or SBPDCL i.e. www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in and/or www.sbpdcl.co.in.

PR. No. 012850 (B&C) 2026-27 **Electrical Superintending Engineer (Purchase)**

This information is available on website **www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar** also

सुरक्षित जीवन अपनाओ, अपनी नियमित एच.आई.वी. जाँच कराओ।

GOVT. OF BIHAR
BIHAR COMBINED ENTRANCE COMPETITIVE EXAMINATION BOARD
I.A.S. Association Building, Near Patna Airport, Patna-14.
Website : bceceboard.bihar.gov.in / Helpdesk : helpdesk.bceceboard@bihar.gov.in

UNDER GRADUATE MEDICAL ADMISSION COUNSELLING

(UGMAC)-2026 for MBBS/ BDS/ B.V.Sc. & A.H./ B.F.Sc. in Govt. Medical / Dental / Veterinary Colleges / College of Fisheries and Private Medical / Dental Colleges of Bihar

Adv. No.- BCECEB(UGMAC)-2026/10 Dated 30.09.2026

Notice for Round-3 Online Application & Choice Filling

Online Registration & Submission of Application-cum-Choice filling after Round-2 are invited from such qualified, eligible & interested NEET(UG)-2026 candidates for appearing in the Round-3 Online Counselling of Under Graduate Medical Admission Counselling (UGMAC)-2026, who have not done the Registration and submission of Online Application or who has completed their registration process but did not duly submit Online Application with payment of requisite Counselling Fee & Security Deposit against Adv. No. BCECEB(UGMAC)-2026/01 & 2026/02 Dated 07.08.2026, 2026/05 Dated 11.09.2026, 2026/07 Dated 15.09.2026 and 2026/08 Dated 17.09.2026 and are not admitted in any Medical / Dental Colleges of India, for admission to the first year UG Medical / Dental Courses (MBBS / BDS) in Government / Private Medical / Dental Colleges and B.V.Sc. & A.H. / B.F.Sc. courses in Govt. Veterinary / Fisheries Colleges of Bihar state based on the Rank of UGMAC-2026 prepared on the basis of AIR of NEET(UG)-2026 on the basis of vacant seats available after admission on the basis of UGMAC-2026 Online Round-2 Counselling held from 27.09.2026 to 29.09.2026.

2. Updated Seat Matrix of vacancies after completion of Round-2 Counselling is available on Board's website: **bceceboard.bihar.gov.in** . If any further vacancies due to resignation etc. arise, the Updated Seat Matrix will be uploaded on the Board's website. The candidate must see it before Online Registration & Submission of Application-cum-Choice filling / submitting their Consent / editing of choices for Online Counselling.
3. The online Registration & submission of Application-cum-Choice Filling / Editing of Application Form data / Editing of Choices **will start from** 03.10.2026.
4. Eligibility criteria for counselling / admission Fee payment precedure, instructions and other details for filling up online applications form-cum-choice filling are available in the Prospectus of UGMAC-2026 and the **related Advertisement No.-BCECEB(UGMAC)-2026/09 dated 30.09.2026, which can be seen / downloaded from the Board's website: bceceboard.bihar.gov.in.**

Controller of Examination

GOVERNMENT OF INDIA
MINISTRY OF CULTURE

Notice of Cancellation of Advertisement

Reference is invited to the Advertisement No. 8/8/2018-M-II for filling up the post of Director General, National Research Laboratory for Conservation of Cultural Property (NRLC), Lucknow under Ministry of Culture on deputation (including short-term contract) or contract basis, published in the Employment News dated 8-14 October 2022 and in various newspapers on 08.10.2022.The aforementioned advertisement is hereby cancelled due to administrative reasons. Accordingly, no further action shall be taken in respect of the applications received, and the recruitment process for the said post is hereby cancelled.

CBC 09101/11/0019/2627

Jharkhand Education Project Council
JSCA, Stadium Road, Sector-3, Dhurwa, Ranchi – 834004
Phone : 0651-2444501, 2444502, Fax – 2444506,
e-mail: jepcranchi1@gmail.com

Letter. No.: JEPC/ QU/40/50/2026/3873 **Date: 01/10/2026**

GeM-Procurement Notice

Jharkhand Education Project Council invites proposal for Selection of Agency for Design, Development, Implementation and Monitoring of the Learning Enhancement Programme (LEP). The detail Bid document can be seen in the portal https://gem.gov.in/ with Bid Reference number – GEM/2026/B/8013279. Interested bidder can submit their bid through the portal www.gem.gov.in

Sd/-
(Shashi Ranjan)
State Project Director

PR 390971 Jharkhand Education Project Council (26-27) D"

GOVERNMENT OF JHARKHAND
DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH, MEDICAL EDUCATION & FAMILY WELFARE

ADVERTISEMENT FOR ENGAGEMENT OF NON-TEACHING SPECIALIST MEDICAL OFFICERS THROUGH BIDDING PROCESS

Advertisement No. HMFW /2026 (SMO BID)- 2755 (MD) **Date: 01.10.2026**

The Department of Health, Medical Education & Family Welfare, Government of Jharkhand invites online applications from eligible and willing medical professionals for engagement as Non-Teaching Specialist Medical Officers at the facilities indicated in Annexure-I. The engagement shall be purely contractual and shall be governed by the terms and conditions contained in this advertisement.

IMPORTANT DATES

Opening of Online Application	8/10/2026 at 11:59 PM
Last Date for Submission of Online Application	31/10/2026 at 11:59 PM
Cut-off Date for Age	31/10/2026

Only online applications submitted through the prescribed recruitment portal shall be accepted. Applications submitted through any other mode shall not be considered.

1. DETAILS OF THE POST

Sl. No.	Name of Post	Essential Qualification	No. of Positions	Age Limit	Place of Posting
1	Non-Teaching Specialist Medical Officer	MBBS degree with Post Graduate Degree/Diploma from an NMC-recognized institution in Anesthesia / Dermatology / ENT / Forensic Science / Obstetrics & Gynaecology / Ophthalmology / Orthopedics / Pediatrics / Pathology / Medicine / Psychiatry / Radiology / Surgery	200	23 to 64 years	As per Annexure-I

2. ELIGIBILITY
- The candidate must possess an MBBS degree along with the requisite Post Graduate Degree/Diploma in the concerned specialty from an NMC-recognized institution.
- The candidate must possess valid registration with the appropriate Medical Council, as required in the online application.
- Candidates must satisfy all eligibility requirements prescribed in this advertisement on the relevant cut-off date.

3. AGE LIMIT
- Minimum age: 23 years.
- Maximum age: 64 years.
- Age shall be calculated as on 31/10/2026.

IMPORTANT WEBSITES
Jharkhand Rural Health Mission Society:- www.jrhms.jharkhand.gov.in
Recruitment Portal:- www.recruitment.jharkhand.gov.in

PR 391003 (Health Med Edu and Family Welfare) 26-27 (D)

Mission Director
National Health Mission, Jharkhand

भारतीय समुद्री विश्वविद्यालय
INDIAN MARITIME UNIVERSITY
(A Central University under the Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways, Government of India)
Established by an Act of the Parliament in 2008

IMU-HQ/C/42/13/02/2026-11th Convocation Dated: 02.10.2026

NOTIFICATION OF ELEVENTH CONVOCATION

1. Please refer to the Notification dated 17.08.2026 hosted on the IMU website.
2. In this regard, it is informed that the Eleventh Convocation **will be held on Thursday, 15.10.2026 at 11:00 AM** at IMU-HQ, Chennai for the students who have successfully registered for receiving degrees **In-Person** until 13.09.2026. (before the due date)
3. The students who have registered to receive their degrees/ diplomas **In-Person** for the 11th Convocation until 13.09.2026 should be present at the registration counters on **Wednesday, 14.10.2026 from 10:00 AM to 04:00 PM** at IMU-HQ, Chennai without fail. The students who fail to register in person on 14.10.2026, will not be permitted to attend the convocation ceremony on 15.10.2026. The candidates must be seated in the auditorium by 09:30 AM on 15.10.2026.
4. It is further reiterated that candidates who have still not registered for the 11th Convocation have to mandatorily register in the student portal for receiving their Degree/Diploma in **In-Absentia** only. Without registration in the Convocation portal, Degree/Diploma certificate will not be dispatched.
5. Registration link for In-Absentia is as follows:
   https://exam.imu.edu.in/imu/student/student_login?cs=1

REGISTRAR

NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY

TENDER NOTICE NO-13 dt. 30.09.2026

Invitation of tenders through e- Procurement system

Principal Chief Material Manager., North Eastern Railway, Gorakhpur- 273012 and on behalf of The President of India, invites tenders through e-procurement system for the supply of the following items. Complete description of the item and other condition are available on **www.ireps.gov.in**

Item No	Tender Number	Due On	Brief Description of Stores	Qty.
1	22261077	05/11/2026	DV KE11PKSL with Pressure Convertor etc	81 Nos.
2	22262129A	03/11/2026	Knuckle for CBC to Frontier etc	100 Nos.
3	24261669A	02/11/2026	Kit for IOH schedule of E-70 brake etc.	08 sets.
4	33261088	26/10/2026	Jointless grooved copper contact wire etc.	110.89 MT
5	28260940A	22/10/2026	Fire Retardant Rubber based adhesive etc.	47380 Ltrs.
6	24261414	22/10/2026	AOH Service kit for ELGI etc.	329 sets.
7	24260293	22/10/2026	IOH Kit for RR20100 CG etc	89 sets.
8	22262048	21/10/2026	Air spring assembly capacity 160 KN etc.	800 Nos.
9	28262005	19/10/2026	Inj. Insulin degludec/Insulin Aspart etc.	4298 Nos.
10	26265170A	16/10/2026	DERAILING SWITCH: 1 in 8.5 OVER-RIDING etc.	120 sets.
11	24265023	15/10/2026	Supply of driver seat 360-degree etc.	170 Nos.
12	33261060A	15/10/2026	Un-insulated Cadmium Copper Catenary etc.	20 Mt.
13	35260962A	15/10/2026	LONG LIFE LOCO SIDE BUFFER ASSLY. Etc.	124 Nos.
14	26265154A	15/10/2026	FISHPLATES (JOGGLED) FOR USE ON DEFECTIVE etc	11907 sets.
15	26265198	07/10/2026	TWSEJ (ASSEMBLY) FOR THICK WEB SWITCH etc.	395 sets.

CPRO/S-68 **Principal Chief Material Manager, Gorakhpur**

Do Not Smoke Bidi/Cigarette in train

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमण्डल, चतरा।
ई–निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना।

डी0एम0एफ0टी0 मद से चतरा जिलान्तर्गत स्वीकृत निम्नांकित योजना के क्रियान्वयन हेतु ग्रामीण विकास विभाग (ग्रामीण कार्य मामले), झारखण्ड सरकार द्वारा समुचित श्रेणी के निबंधित संवेदको से द्वि (Two) लिफाफा पद्धति के अंतर्गत निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है।

ई–निविदा सूचना संख्या :–**RDD/SD/CHATRA/ 14/2026-27/RE_02**

1. कार्य की विस्तृत विवरणी :–

ग्रुप० सं०	प्रखण्ड	पंचायत	ग्राम	कार्य का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि	अग्रधन की राशि	परिमाण विपत्र का मूल्य	कार्यपूर्ण करने की अवधि	लिफाफापद्धति
1.	Tandwa	Dhangadda	Daridag	Construction of High Level RCC Girder Bridge Over Daridag Nala At Dhannagar Toli on Daridag Nala (Daridag to Simaria Tandwa Road).	27099153 .00	542000. 00	10000.00	18 माह	द्वि (Two)

2. वेबसाईट में निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि–05.10.2026
3. ई–निविदा प्राप्ति की तिथि एवं समय – दिनांक–05.10.2026 से दिनांक–15.10.2026 के अपराह्न 05:00 बजे तक।
4. ई–निविदा खोलने का स्थान–कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय, ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमण्डल, चतरा।
5. ई–निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय –17.10.2026 अपराह्न 02:00 बजे।
6. ई–निविदा आमंत्रित करने वाले पदाधिकारी का नाम एवं पता :– कार्यपालक अभियंता, ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, चतरा।
7. ई–निविदा प्रकोष्ठ का दूरभाष सं०–9431060939
8. परिमाण विपत्र की राशि घट–बढ़ सकती है, तदनुसार अग्रधन की राशि देय होगी।
9. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रधन की राशि केवल Online Mode द्वारा स्वीकार्य होगी।
10. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रधन की राशि का ई–भुगतान जिस खाता से किया जायेगा, उसी खाते में अग्रधन की राशि वापस होगी। अगर खाता को बन्द कर दिया जाता है तो उसकी सारी जवाब देही आपकी होगी।

विस्तृत जानकारी के लिये वेबसाईट www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in एवं कार्यालय की सूचना पट्ट पर देखा जा सकता है।

PR 390977 Rural Development(26-27)D

कार्यपालक अभियंता,
ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल,चतरा।

Other than outrage

Restrictions on women cannot be the answer to unsafe public spaces

There is a sickening sense of *déjà vu* in last month's headlines of sexual assaults against women and children. In the national capital alone, the gang-rape of a 17-year-old girl in Astha Kunj Park by three men posing as police personnel, the gang-rape and murder of a 16-year-old in Swaroop Nagar, and the gang-rape of another 17-year old on a sleeper bus travelling from Greater Noida to Delhi have each shocked the nation briefly before giving way to a numb outrage. Little seems to have changed in the 14 years since the candlelight marches and commissions after the Nirbhaya case unleashed a slew of new schemes, laws and funds that vowed to protect women and girls from sexual violence, especially in public spaces. The latest report of the National Crime Records Bureau shows an 80% surge in crimes against women since Nirbhaya, from 2.4 lakh in 2012 to 4.4 lakh in 2024. Some of this can be attributed to higher reporting of crimes, facilitated by those new laws and schemes, but that is not sufficient to account for the vast number of them. In 2024, more than 50 crimes against women were reported every hour, with the highest rate of such crimes seen in the metro cities of Jaipur, Indore, Lucknow, and Delhi.

The government has listed a slew of initiatives meant to deal with the problem, from the Safe City project to Mission Shakti, from a women's helpline and emergency response support system to one-stop centres for survivors of sexual violence and fast-track courts, many of which have been financed through the Nirbhaya Fund. The recent crimes, however, put a question mark on the implementation of such schemes. A safe city cannot be created simply by installing lighting and CCTV cameras, if they are not functional, monitored, and connected to a response system. Police patrols and emergency numbers matter only if they result in prompt intervention from trained and sensitised personnel. It is important to move from scheme-based policing to preventive, and outcome-based policing, with public audits of vulnerable locations with deadlines and accountability to rectify deficiencies. The justice system must address the enormous backlog of cases; the promise of speedy investigation loses meaning if survivors spend years awaiting trial. The authorities must also resist the temptation to convert women's safety into restrictions on women's freedom. The answer to unsafe public spaces cannot be that women should avoid parks after dark, return home earlier, travel only with companions, or otherwise organise their lives around the possibility of male violence. Most importantly, there is a need to challenge the culture of sexual violence and toxic masculinity, enabled by age-old patriarchal traditions.

Season's end

The IMD is conservative when it comes to projecting rainfall deficit

The India Meteorological Department (IMD) issues two forecasts – in April and May – before the monsoon. Both unambiguously pointed to a dry monsoon – confidence boosted by global unanimity that one of the strongest El Niño ever was in the offing – and the consequential question was, 'How bad?' It turns out that the IMD's forecast of 'below normal' rain (90% to 95% of average) was conservative. This was surprising, given that its models pointed to 'deficient' rains (below 90%). On September 30, when India's monsoon tally ended, the IMD announced 759 mm across the country, 87% of the normal 869 mm. El Niño years, when the Central Equatorial Pacific warms and suppresses monsoon rains, test a weather department's mettle because predicting the extent of the shortfall is challenging. It is perplexing why the agency opted for 'below normal' rainfall when it could have warned of a 'deficiency' and claimed accuracy. As of now the IMD can only claim technical victory because the final number sits within the 4%-5% error window. However, at a disaggregated level, the IMD's struggle with getting magnitude right is far more glaring. June got 65% of its normal, far drier than the 92% forecast. July, expected to be below 94%, ended up with 1% point more rain. August came in at 84% of the LPA, in line with the "below 94%" forecast. September at 92.4% finished a little above the forecast of 'below 91%.' The IMD expected a 'normal' monsoon in the northeast, which then recorded its driest since 1901, or 26% short. The south peninsula ran 23% short. central and north-west India – tipped to fall below normal – finished close to predictions, driven by ocean conditions and Western disturbances.

Climate change makes this more complicated. Western disturbances, extra-tropical rain-bearing systems, have been bringing more rain to India in the monsoon months, while southern India seems more vulnerable to El Niño-triggered volatility. This is reflected in *kharif* sowing. On July 10, *kharif* sowing trailed last year's by 16%; by early September the gap had narrowed to under 2%. Karnataka has declared drought in well over a 100 taluks and Maharashtra in 265 of 358, though the national deficit of about 12% is below the Centre's 20% threshold for an 'agricultural drought.' The IMD expects El Niño to strengthen and bring below normal rain over most of the country from October to December, threatening soil moisture and reservoir recharge. The Cabinet has lifted wheat's support price by ₹25 a quintal and mustard's by ₹413, nudging diversification. Given the consequences of IMD's forecasts, it should improve its sub-regional forecast systems and not shy from being the bearer of ill-news, if needed.

A compilation of articles, on the Editorial and Opinion pages, offering insights into the Mahatma's ideas and legacy

Gandhiji's many ways of understanding 'genius'

Gopalkrishna Gandhi

A teacher who has held administrative, diplomatic and constitutional positions

This column is not about Gandhi as a genius (which, with a laugh, he would say he certainly was not) or about the spectacularly original man I believe him to have been. It is about the place of the word 'genius' in Gandhi's thought and in his writings.

Why should that common word be picked up from Gandhi's teeming English vocabulary for special attention? Because his use of that valuational word tells us a great deal about his assessment of persons and situations – a matter of interest in itself. And also because we can apply (or not apply) his yardsticks for evaluating persons and happenings in our contemporary times.

There is another non-Gandhi reason as well. Most users of the word do not know that 'genius' is a Latin word. Not just a word of Latin origin but a Latin word in its totality – in the way it is spelt, pronounced and meant. English has borrowed 'genius' from the language of Virgil, Horace, Ovid without any change whatsoever, somewhat like how C.V. Raman describes the journey of the diamond from its womb under the earth to human hands '...absolutely fresh...perfect from nature's crucible.' And so, reflecting on the word, one might also ponder its travel from one language register to another, admitting some variations in its action.

Here are representative examples culled by Gandhi-researcher Murtaza Gandhi from *The Collected Works of Mahatma Gandhi* (*CWMG*).

Pronounced in both Latin and English identically, as Jee-nee-us, its meaning in classical Latin is 'divine inner power'. In modern English, when used as a noun, for example 'the genius S. Ramanujan...', it denotes a person with exceptional intellectual or creative ability. When used as an adjective, for example, 'the genius of India..., it refers to a singular or unique characteristic.

The first encounter

Gandhi uses the word in both senses. His first recorded use of it is as in a skill, a vision, an act of sheer dare. He talks about it as an achievement, not as the description of a person. The reference goes back to 1888, when he was 19 years old and when his English was unpolished. Travelling by the liner *S.S. Clyde* from Bombay to England to start his law studies, he was taken up by the sight of the Suez Canal. Cutting the slender isthmus of the Suez between Asia and Africa to save on journey time by several days, it was a marvel to behold.

He writes in what is now known as his London Diary: "The construction of the Suez Canal I am not able to understand. It is indeed marvellous. I cannot think of the genius of a man who invented it. I don't know how he would have done it." (*CWMG*, Vol.01, p.11). The 'man who invented it' is, of course, Ferdinand de Lesseps (1805-1894), a French diplomat and entrepreneur, who thought of and made the Canal with the help of two engineers – the Austrian Alois Negrelli and fellow Frenchman Linant de Bellefond.

The word 'genius' offers a window into the Mahatma's assessment of people and events

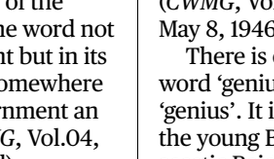
In this year, 2026, which marks the 70th anniversary of the 1956 Anglo-French-Israeli bombardment of Egypt which aimed to take over the Suez Canal – which Egypt's President Gamal Abdel Nasser had nationalised, – Israel is using more lethal bombs with prodigal abandon in Palestine and Gaza and, with the United States joining the fire-play over Iran, causing the death, among others, of the Supreme Leader of the Iranian state, no less. So, today, we can reflect on Gandhi's marvelling at the genius that went into the making of that oceanic passageway only with anxiety for the future of the area around that marvel.

The dark side

This brings one to a phrase which is twinned to 'genius': evil genius (or malignum genium). The earliest known use of that phrase as a concept is in French philosopher Rene Descartes' use of it in his 1641 opus *Meditations on First Philosophy*. He posits in it the existence of a power that is the very opposite of the divine power that actuates 'genius' – evil genius, a malignant God or evil power.

By 1893, Barrister M.K. Gandhi was in South Africa and soon became the spokesman and leader of the Indian community there in its strivings for the recognition of its rights and its dignity. Stung by the discriminations and humiliations that Indian South Africans were subjected to, particularly at the hands of the Asiatic Department, we see him use the word not just in its simple sense of a compliment but in its contrary avatar: "There seems to be somewhere in the Asiatic Department of the government an evil genius working through it." (*CWMG*, Vol.04, p.26, 23. The Bazaars in The Transvaal) .

'Evil genius' occurs in Gandhi's vocabulary again when he is back in India, where he uses it in the context of the Jallianwala Bagh massacre (April 13, 1919) but very pointedly for an individual: "General Dyer has been haltingly blamed, and his evil genius, Sir Michael O'Dwyer, entirely exonerated..." (*CWMG*, Vol.19, p.339). Just stopping short of using the phrase 'evil genius', he invokes the word witheringly with sarcasm, to describe the British Raj's policy of 'Divide and Rule': "But just now I am speaking of the genius of the Government. It has not hesitated to divide Hindus from Muslims in order to be able to retain its hold on us." (*CWMG*, Vol.19, p.398, Speech at Nankana Saheb – March 3, 1921).



As a term of praise

The earliest recorded reference by him of a person as a genius in a wholly complimentary sense, is for Lokamanya Bal Gangadhar Tilak who, in 1916, in the town of Belgaum, famously declared (in Marathi) "Swaraj is my birthright and I shall have it." The 'Father of Indian Unrest' had been dead four years but addressing the Indian National Congress' session in the same town of Belgaum in December 1924 as Congress President, Gandhi could not but refer to him and said (in English): He was the genius of swaraj (*CWMG*, Vol.25, p.508, Concluding Speech at Belgaum Congress, December 27, 1924). Gandhi is doing something very interesting here. He is terming Tilak as a genius of and in something very singular, very specific – swaraj. He is using the term very precisely, very contextually, like he would be if he were to describe Einstein as a genius of the Theory of Relativity.

The next most notable use by him of the word as a personal tribute is for Rabindranath Tagore. Speaking on him in 1931, Gandhi says: "In common with thousands of his countrymen I owe much to one who by his poetic genius and singular purity of life has raised India in the estimation of the world." (*CWMG*, Vol.45, p.125, Tribute to Rabindranath Tagore – January 26, 1931).

He was to use the word for him again but again, not as a direct adjective but with a value added: "His creative genius has also given us Santiniketan, Sriniketan and Visvabharati" (*CWMG*, Vol.84, p.124, Speech at Prayer Meeting, May 8, 1946).

There is one person for whom Gandhi uses the word 'genius' without any niche that encases 'genius'. It is for his friend and almost-preceptor, the young Bombay-based jeweller, poet, Jaina ascetic Rajchandra or Raychandbhai as Gandhi called him: "Kavi Rajchandra was born in a place called Vavania in Kathiawar... His schooling was quite elementary. But he was a genius. He knew Sanskrit, Magadhi and, I believe, Pali" (*CWMG*, Vol.43, p.98, A Great Seer – March 18, 1930).

Genius can do marvels and do evil. Remembering Gandhi's awareness of that truth is today not a matter of language alone but of life and death.

The Mahatma's unfinished work on the world stage

M. Kalyanaraman

Writing about Gandhiji's death on his birthday may not be an entirely odd thing, given how he died and how that conflicted with what he stood for. In popular perception, Gandhiji was a tired, old man whose life's work was over when he was assassinated.

In any case, the people he sought to train and transform into compassionate human beings had turned bigoted murderers or condoned bigotry and mass murder during Partition. The last eccentric, going-against-the-grain act they allowed him was fasting in favour of Pakistan. Revisionist history of today seeks to downgrade his role in India's freedom by counterposing Netaji.

But it can be argued that Gandhiji's best years were yet to come even if India had failed him then and now. At 78, Gandhiji was healthy enough to have gone on a village-to-village walk in Noakhali, fasted for three days in Calcutta to stop the rioting before the five-day Delhi fast, and talked about a fast-unto-death to stop the killing of Muslims in Bihar. His health may well have facilitated his shining on the world stage for several more years.

The emergence of a global image

Gandhiji had already ascended the world stage a few decades before in-part due to the rapid growth of print media in the first half 20th century that sought out new and novel stories. Among a non-violent campaign's advantages were that it was carried out in the public domain, transparently – far easier to cover than a clandestine plot. A report on the Dharasana beatings ran in some 1,300 papers worldwide. And photos of Gandhiji, with his dress, or the lack of it, quirks and eccentricities, looked great on newsprint.

Among the many influences Gandhiji had globally was the Black civil rights movement. In America, African-American newspapers were only eager to see parallels and seek inspiration. And it was not symbolic or philosophical but direct and tactical, too. A Harlem ashram and an Ohio ahimsa farm sprang up. Even the goat-milking transmuted to America.

Had the Mahatma lived, his message of non-violence might have travelled further and shaped global movements

Martin Luther King may have been the most famous of civil rights leaders' visits to India but there were many other organisers such as Bayard Rustin and James Lawson who had immersive sojourns in India. A report in *The Hindu* quotes Rustin – he was the organiser of the 1963 March on Washington, at which King delivered the "I Have a Dream" speech – as saying in 1948 that the "Indian non-violent revolution has much to teach us".

During the Montgomery Bus Boycott, described as the practical kick-off of the civil rights protests led by King, Rustin put his learnings to successful use. He insisted that Montgomery should only be one of many such sites. He ticked off King for having armed guards in his house, saying that Gandhiji would not do that. In a move that caught the attention of many, but which Rustin owed to Gandhiji's methods, he asked that the leaders should go and voluntarily surrender to the police, saying that, yes, they had broken the law, but that it was the right thing to do. Lawson set up a Satyagraha training school in Nashville.

Non-violence on a global scale

Gandhiji did become a global icon, posthumously. For sure, his methods drew from the past. A peaceful march organised by a priest in St. Petersburg was violently put down by the Tsar although it triggered the 1905 revolution. But what was new was that Gandhiji showed that they were duplicable on a mass scale in an organised manner. This was the novelty that caught the imagination of the world later.

Scholars have shown that in the latter half of 20th century, when asymmetries of power solidified, only non-violent campaigns could succeed and did so. East Timor was a sterling example.

Perhaps the best chance that the Palestinians had for Swaraj was in the initial stages of the Intifada. Though known more for the stone-throwing, the initial protests were largely non-violent but forceful in a Gandhian way. More than all the bombings, assassinations and the plane hijacks engineered by the Palestinians, it could be argued that Intifada 1 forced the Israeli leadership to negotiate and at least on paper commit to a two-state solution eventually though subsequent events upended all that.

It would seem that Gandhiji had planned on playing an active global role after India's Independence. A report in *The Hindu* on March 9, 1948, quotes Horace Alexander as saying that Gandhiji, in England in 1931, had told his friends that when India would be free, he would take part in a world movement for spreading the gospel of non-violence. Another report in August 1947 says that "discussions are now going on between Mahatma Gandhi and some of his American, Indian and European friends" for the world conference.

The conference was held in 1949, a year after his death. International participants discussed setting up an organisation. A.J. Muste wanted to set up a training institute in India. But, without the man himself, Gandhiji became only a soul force, not a physical presence, for non-violent activists across the world.

The Palestine test

If idle speculation could be allowed, a living Gandhiji would have electrified the world that had just gone through a monstrous war and the Holocaust. Instead of becoming just a memorial possibility and vague idealism, non-violence and compassion would have been far more rooted in global discourse.

The best test for Gandhiji would have been Palestine.

If he could make an Englishman ashamed of himself, could he not have made Israeli Jews ashamed of inflicting on Palestinians the suffering Jews had endured for centuries?

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LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

A balance

The new NCERT Class 9 Social Science curriculum significantly reduces the space given to modern European history, replacing chapters on the French and Russian Revolutions. At the same time, it places a much-needed emphasis on Indian history, exploring traditions of governance, sacred responsibility, and regional resistance and resilience. The inclusion of the *Sengol* provides an opportunity for students to learn about India's civilisational continuity and political traditions. Since the historical interpretation of the *Sengol* remains contested (Inside pages, October 1), it is vital that textbooks present competing accounts with adequate evidence. In an age shaped by global change, our education system must seamlessly combine cultural rootedness with rigorous historical inquiry and critical thinking.

Sathiyapriya Kumar,
Thirukkattupalli, Tamil Nadu

Numbers must work

In my experience, several official telephone numbers published on the Tamil Nadu government websites are either 'switched off, not reachable, or remain unanswered'. These numbers are provided specifically to enable citizens to contact the government offices concerned for information, clarification or assistance. The official CM Helpline information states that citizens should be able to access grievance services without having to visit a grievance centre and provides multiple channels, including telephone, online portal, mobile application and email to *Mudhalvarin Mugavari*. Therefore, there appears to be a clear disconnect between the citizen-friendly services announced by the government and the actual accessibility.

Balamarthandan D.,
Chennai

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address.

Should the EC take action against those filing forms for mass deletions?

Ashok Lavasa

Former Election Commissioner

Prasenjit Bose

Congress leader and petitioner in West Bengal SIR case in Supreme Court

PARLEY

As Phase 3 of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls unfolds, a surge in Form 7 applications, the mechanism for seeking deletion of names, in Karnataka has raised concerns. More than 4,000 such forms were filed in the State, with 1,363 in one place coming from just 10 electors, many reportedly targeting Muslim names. Uttarakhand has seen objections filed in an Electoral Registration Officer's (ERO) name without his knowledge, while in West Bengal, data shows that nearly 90% of Form 7 applications were accepted. Similar cases have been reported by *The Hindu* from Rajasthan and Gujarat as well. Should the Election Commission (EC) take action against those filing forms for mass deletions? Ashok Lavasa and Prasenjit Bose discuss the question in a conversation moderated by **Sreeparna Chakrabarty**. Edited excerpts:

What is the ERO legally required to do when a Form 7 arrives?

Ashok Lavasa: Under the Registration of Electors Rule 1960, all the steps that are required for registration, for deletion, and for amendment are listed. Form 7 applications are typically used to object to the entry of a person in the electoral roll. As soon as a Form 7 notice is received by the ERO, the Rules prescribe that first of all they should be put on the notice board for the public to know that objections have been received against such and such person. After this, a specific notice is to be given to the person against whom a complaint has been received. The Rules provide that in case an inquiry is demanded, the ERO or the officer designated cannot take a decision on his own without conducting a formal inquiry in which he can even summon the complainant and the person against whom the complaint has been received. He can ask the complainant to testify under oath that the particulars that he is presenting and the documents that he is giving are true. He is also informed that in case this is found incorrect, there is a penalty under Section 31 of the Representation of the People Act (RPA) for which he can be penalised with imprisonment for giving false information. This is the procedure. The spirit behind this is that no name should be deleted without giving adequate opportunity to the person against whom a complaint has been received.

How do these bulk forms emerge and is there a limit on how many objections one person can file? Also, can Section 31 of the RPA, which penalises false declarations, be invoked if somebody files bulk Form 7s?

AL: I think the EC has issued instructions from time to time; it is not given in the Rules as such. But instructions have been given that you should not receive more than, I think, five or six forms according to current norms. With respect to Section 31, I don't think it can be invoked. It is specifically to do with giving false information.

In Karnataka's Babaleshwar, 1,363 of Form 7 applications came from just 10 electors. Reports have said that many of the deletions targeted Muslim names.

AL: Clearly, this is a misuse of the procedure. The concerned authorities need to act against people who are misusing the system. You would recall that in Karnataka last year, when the Leader of Opposition had given some instances, the EC had itself clarified that out of some 2,000 odd applications that it received, only roughly 28 had been found to be correct. The question here is that we still do not know whether the EC has proceeded against somebody for making a false declaration. This penal provision, to the best of my knowledge, has hardly been used against anyone. And unless there is a deterrence, this provision will lose its efficacy.

West Bengal has seen one of the highest rates of acceptance of Form 7s. What is the petition against this in the SC about?

Prasenjit Bose: There are specific formats in which aggregated data on all Forms – 6, 7 and 8 – have to be recorded and disclosed at the end of any revision period by the EC. But that has not been followed in most States, especially in West Bengal. So, we had to request for the disclosure of that data because we found anomalies in the data that were disclosed during the claims and objections period.

Karnataka CM D.K. Shivakumar staged a sit-in protest demanding an inquiry into alleged voter list deletions through bulk Form 7 submissions, outside the office of the Chief Electoral Officer in Bengaluru, on Thursday. PTI

> There are specific formats in which aggregated data on all Forms – 6, 7 and 8 – have to be recorded and disclosed at the end of any revision period by the EC. But that has not been followed in most States, especially in West Bengal
> **PRASENJIT BOSE**

As per the facts revealed by the affidavit filed by the EC in response to the petition that we had filed, the total Form 6 applications for inclusion were 34 lakh, out of which 7,26,000 were rejected. As far as Form 7 is concerned, the total number received was 6,39,000, which by itself, if you compare with States of similar sizes such as Bihar or Tamil Nadu, is on the higher side. And out of the 6,39,000 Form 7 applications received, 5,72,000 were accepted. So, you have an almost 90% rate of acceptance of Form 7 and less than 21% for Form 6. This anomaly is quite glaring. The problem lies in the deterrence mechanism of Section 31 of the RPA.

In many cases, the person in whose name the forms were filed denied having knowledge of the same. Is there some central mechanism which can be used to file forms?

PB: I will give you the latest example from Uttarakhand. I have on record, the ERO of Haridwar Rural constituency confirming that he has not submitted any Form 7 filed in his name. In one constituency, 3,500 Form 7 applications were submitted just hours before the window of claims and objections were about to get over and all the objections were in the name of the ERO. It has been done in an automated manner.

A similar mechanism was used in West Bengal vis-a-vis the appellate tribunals where automated appeals for exclusion have been filed which one of the Election Commissioners had flagged. Judicial intervention is needed to stop this as these illegalities are depriving genuine electors from their right to vote.

AL: This is quite absurd and calls for a probe. Clearly, the ERO cannot file objections. Although in the Rules there is a provision that the ERO can make some corrections on his own, that does not amount to filing so many objections.

And it is the responsibility of the Chief Electoral Officer of the State and the EC to thoroughly investigate this matter. However, just because applications are filed, we should not condemn the system. I think we need to actually hold the system accountable.

As far as the centralisation of data or generating objections in a centralised fashion is concerned, I think we are speculating. There is no evidence of that. But, we do know that one of the Election Commissioners has actually red-flagged the issue saying that it creates the possibility of manipulation at the central level.

What can be done to deter this?

AL: I think there are some safeguards in place, but the point is whether they are being enforced. The EC generally after filing FIRs is not following them up systematically because it is presumed that now this is the responsibility of the concerned law enforcement machinery. This is where the EC needs to put in place a very strong monitoring mechanism. Earlier, I have suggested that the National Crime Records Bureau must have a separate data set on election-related crimes. And they should be reported separately so that all these figures are in the public domain. Once this data is in the public domain, people will analyse and flag these issues. The EC also has certain internal norms such as if in any polling booth, there are more than 2% additions or deletions, that particular booth is taken up for greater scrutiny.

In all these instances where we are saying that 2,000 or more applications were received, the point is whether the system is accepting them. Is it actually leading to unjustified removal or addition? And finally, whether the system is taking note of the possibility of misuse.

PB: My point is that if the institution itself which is supposed to uphold the law and administer it, if at least a section within that institution starts violating the law, then the entire system breaks down. I think that is what has happened.

In terms of reform, what has happened is that the electoral laws, RPA Act and especially these Forms were framed at a time in the 1950s and 60s. It was a non-digital era. Today we have digital databases and online submission of Forms. I think our laws have become out of sync with the way the process is being conducted today. There is a need for legal reforms.

AL: If people are committing fraud that obviously cannot be dealt with under the RPA. This is a weak link in the system; our law-and-order machinery is not taking these cases seriously. That is why I suggested there has to be a specific monitoring mechanism for electoral offences.

To listen to the full interview
Scan the code or go to the link
www.thehindu.com

A reflection on two songs and their nationalisms

Sanjay Hegde

Senior Advocate of the Supreme Court of India

While it is customary to garland Gandhiji on his birthday, this year, let us listen to him instead and to the song he lived by. At a time when the Republic has spent 10 months legislating about another song, the contrast will be a lesson in what nationalism is, and what it is not.

The song the Republic legislated about is *Vande Mataram*. In January 2026, the Union Home Ministry directed that all six stanzas of the National Song be performed at official functions, with everyone standing at attention. In July, a second order made the six-stanza text the "official version" and placed the Song before the Anthem.

Parliament amended the Prevention of Insults to National Honour Act, 1971, to bring the National Song within the ambit of criminal law for the first time. To intentionally prevent its singing, or to disturb an assembly engaged in singing it, now invites imprisonment of up to three years.

On September 22, the Supreme Court heard the Carnatic musician and author, T.M. Krishna's challenge to the law and the orders. It did not decide the case. It asked the Union government to reply. However, Justice Joymalya Bagchi said that while the state may decide whether the Song has two stanzas or six, *Bijoe Emmanuel* (the SC judgment which upholds the right to religious freedom, constitutional tolerance and silent objection) still governs. A conscientious objector, to one stanza or all, should face no criminal consequences if she/he respectfully stood but didn't sing. Justice Bagchi's view is not yet a judgment but one wishes it should be.

The same morning, the Solicitor General answered the plea for national consensus by stating that law-making cannot follow the ideas of Naxalites. This author, in court for another matter, rose to say that to think, is not to be a Naxalite.

The episode matters only because it sums up the two nationalisms discussed here: one answers an argument, the other renames the arguer.

Vande Mataram

Let us take a closer look at the six stanzas of the Song; Bankim Chandra Chatterjee wrote the first two around 1875, reportedly as a filler for his journal. They are a hymn to a landscape, richly watered, bountiful, and cool with southern breezes. Any Indian of any faith can sing these stanzas about her nation.

The later stanzas came with his novel *Anandamath*, and they name names. The motherland becomes Durga with her 10 weapons, Lakshmi, and Saraswati. It is two songs stitched together, and the divide has run through our politics since 1905, when the Partition of Bengal made its opening words the war cry of *Swadeshi*.

The freedom movement resolved the problem sharply. In October 1937, on a resolution moved by Rajendra Prasad and seconded by Vallabhbhai Patel, the Congress Working Committee acknowledged the validity of Muslim and others' objections to the later stanzas and adopted the first two alone for national gatherings.

Rabindranath Tagore, who had first set the song to music, blessed the change. He loved the opening stanzas and disowned the theology that followed.

On January 24, 1950, India's first President Rajendra Prasad announced that *Jana Gana Mana* would be the National Anthem and that *Vande Mataram* would be "honoured equally". Honour is not an obligation and for 55 years, the law protected the Flag, the Constitution and the Anthem, and deliberately left the Song outside the penal net. Love for the song was invited and obedience was never demanded.

Nor was the two-stanza settlement any insult to Bankim. The Bhagavad Gita is seven hundred verses from a Mahabharata of a hundred thousand. Our national anthem is the first of Tagore's five stanzas. Fitting a work to a public purpose is homage and not a denigration.

This settlement worked. In 1997, A.R. Rahman, born a Hindu and a convert to Islam, reimagined *Vande Mataram* as *Maa Tujhe Salaam*. Ask anyone under 40 to sing *Vande Mataram* and you will hear Rahman.

It is this settlement of 1937, of 1950, and of 1997 that the current orders and statutes have reopened, and that the Supreme Court has now, rightly, handed back to the state and to us.

The other song

Five centuries before Bankim, Narsinh Mehta of Junagadh was excommunicated by his own caste for singing among 'untouchables'.

He composed *Vaishnava jana to tene kahiye, je peed parai jaane re* (Call that one alone a man of God, who knows another's pain as his own). The song has no map, no enemy, no throne. It audits a human being: one who serves without pride, bows to all and disparages none, keeps word, deed and thought in one line, looks on all with an equal eye, tells no lie, touches no wealth that is not his, honours every woman, and has put away deceit, lust and anger.

Read that against the Constitution and you will find that Narsinh drafted a version of the Preamble early and set it to music.

Feeling another's pain is fraternity assuring the dignity of the individual. Bowing to all is Article 14. The equal eye is our secularism and the hand that refuses another's wealth is the law of probity. The tongue that will not lie is the informed citizen of Article 51A.

Gandhi carried it from Sabarmati to his last prayer meeting, beside the Koran and Christian hymns, and in a hundred years no one has felt excluded by it.

Vande Mataram tests your posture; *Vaishnava Janato* tests your conduct.

Here, then, are two songs and two nationalisms. One venerates the soil and asks the citizen to bow. The other civilises the soul and asks citizens to be worthy. One now comes with a sub-inspector attached. The other has never needed one.

A modest proposal

So, on Gandhi Jayanti, here's a proposal. We have a National Anthem, protected by law, and a National Song, honoured by usage. Let the Republic recognise *Vaishnava Janato* as our National Prayer through the gentle method used in 1950, and not the muscular method of 2026. No order, no penalty, no compulsory standing. Only recognition and no mandatory requirement. Let it be sung, by those who wish, where the National Song is sung.

Let schoolchildren learn its meaning in every language. A prayer compelled is no prayer at all. That is the point.

Bankim's third stanza counted "*sapta koti kantha*" – the seven crore throats from his motherland, an undivided Bengal. In 1905, Sarala Devi sang it as thirty crore, and the motherland became India. Today we are 140 crore, and every crore was added by inclusion; none by compulsion.

A choir of 1.4 billion cannot be conducted with a *lathi* (stick). In a symphony that size, the conductor's only instrument is the willingness of the singers, won by making everyone feel the song is theirs. Inclusion is not a concession to the fastidious. It is the better tune.

The Constitution does not demand that we all worship the same way. It demands that we remain, all 140 crore of us, equal citizens. We are better off not insisting that everyone sing our song, and instead praying that everyone becomes a *Vaishnava jana* in citizenship.

Standing at attention takes 90 seconds. Feeling *peed parai* (pain of others) takes a lifetime and it, not the standing, is what builds a nation.

> We have a National Anthem, protected by law, and a National Song, honoured by usage. Let the Republic recognise *Vaishnava Janato* as our National Prayer

FROM THE ARCHIVES
The Hindu.

FIFTY YEARS AGO OCTOBER 2, 1976

New watches with Swiss assistance

As there was no issue dated October 2, 1976 from the issue dated October 1, 1976

New Delhi, September 30: A Horological Institute is likely to be set up in India with Swiss assistance for training Indian personnel in the highly sophisticated technology of watch-making to meet the vast domestic demand which is expected to reach ten million pieces a year by 1980.

A Swiss delegation is arriving shortly for follow up discussions on a phased programme for importing components and assembling them in India during the first stage, obtaining machinery for making these components and finally making the machines in India itself for achieving near self-sufficiency both in design and production for keeping pace with the rapid technological advances in the industry.

The HMT, which has already acquired the necessary expertise in watch manufacture with Japanese collaboration will be able to complete this three-phase programme in the next few years if an agreement is reached with the Swiss industry soon. A high-power Indian delegation visited Switzerland for preliminary discussions.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO OCTOBER 2, 1926

The Madras Monegar choultry

The following appeal has been issued by the Board of Directors of the above Choultry:–

The object of this charitable institution founded in the year 1782 to provide for the living of those who had been thrown in distress on account of the disastrous results of the invasions of Hyder Ali from Mysore, and latterly of old and helpless persons who had no other means of subsistence, is well-known to the public.

This laudable object was accomplished without interruption, but owing to the crippled financial condition of this humanitarian institution, the number of paupers who were receiving shelter and support therein have had to be considerably reduced with the result that while there is accommodation for 140 persons, only 80 men and women can at present be supported by it.

From Page One

UAE probes 'terror' link to flight incident

The UAE's chief prosecutor said an investigation had been launched into the incident, including the possibility of "terrorist activity or intent".

Mr. Netanyahu said he expected the UAE to take the lead in the investigation, but that Israel would join.

Israel's far-right National Security Minister, Itamar Ben Gvir, called it a "jihadist" attack, while Defence Minister Israel Katz also described the incident as "an attempted jihadist terror attack".

Mr. Trump was asked by presspersons at the White House whether he had been briefed about any links between the pilot behind the attack and Tehran. He responded, "I would say the answer, based on what I'm hearing, is yes, but we're working on it right now. He did not offer details.

Asked if the U.S. would retaliate against Tehran if it was behind the attack, Mr. Trump said, "Oh they'll be hit, very hard, don't worry."

Airline flydubai has said all the passengers – of whom 166 out of 174 were Israeli – were safe, but that the reasons for the altercation were unknown.

"During the flight, as they approached the country, one of the pilots stabbed the other pilot, and apparently tried to crash the plane with everyone on board," Mr. Netanyahu said in a video message.

He later hailed the wounded pilot, Mr. Machchhar, "for his extraordinary bravery", saying he prevented a "catastrophic mid-air disaster".

Indian embassy in Saudi Arabia said Mr. Machchhar was being treated at a hospital in the country.

Passenger Miryam Shira Ohayon described the plane as being "pretty much out of control" as the incident unfolded over Jordan. "The co-pilot tried to murder the pilot and basically carry out a suicide attack on the plane," she told presspersons by speakerphone at Ben Gurion Airport.

(With inputs from AP)

EC orders probe into Form 7 fraud charge

In at least two instances, in Belagavi and Vijayapura, BJP workers who filed Form 7s in bulk withdrew those after being warned of punitive action if the claims were found to be false. In a written declaration, they said they had made a mistake.

The Karnataka Police registered five FIRs on Thursday over bulk Form 7s invoking the Bharatiya Nyay Sanhita, 2023, and not the Representation of the People Act, 1951, as only EC officials can lodge complaints under the latter. Mr. Shivakumar demanded that the poll body must take *suo motu* action and lodge criminal complaints.

Mr. Anbu Kumar noted that there were instances of bulk filing of Form 7 applications before the EROs and that some of the forms were "alleged to be not genuine" and directed the EROs to take action under Section 31 of the Representation of the People Act, 1950, "against applicants found to have knowingly made false statements or declarations."

"However, such action shall be preceded by an inquiry under Rule 20 of the Registration of Electors Rules, 1960," he said.

The BJP backed its workers for filing Form 7s, saying that it was not a crime to flag voters suspected to be not genuine.

Earlier in the day, Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha, Rahul Gandhi, took to social media citing *The Hindu's* report on how Form-7 applications were being filed against Muslim names in Belagavi and other districts in bulk, and said it was yet another proof of "vote theft".

"Select people are targeted as BJP and EC officials collude to fill out Form 7 in bulk through automated means, and in the blink of an eye, millions vanish from the voter list. And all of this is controlled from the top," he said.

Govt. hikes commercial LPG cylinder rate by ₹65

In July and August, the price was cumulatively slashed by ₹380 per cylinder. The reduction followed a hike of about ₹1,345 in four tranches since March 7.

Among the four metros, Kolkata saw the steepest hike. While a cylinder costs ₹2,810 in Delhi following a ₹62.5 upward revision, in Kolkata, it now costs ₹2,954 after a ₹70 jump.

In Mumbai, a cylinder costs ₹2,764.50 after a hike of ₹63.50, and in Chennai ₹2,983 following an increase of ₹66.50.

Speaking to *The Hindu*, Manpreet Singh, treasurer of the National Restaurants Association of India, said costlier LPG cylinders could prompt restaurateurs to increase the price of food items. "LPG is an important input for restaurateurs. Further, the latest hike coincides with food inflation, and increasing costs of labour, among other things. This puts restaurateurs under pressure," he said.

Prashant Vashisht, senior vice-president and co-group head of corporate sector ratings at ICRA, said the latest hike seeks to factor in the recent increase in the benchmark Saudi Aramco Contract Price (Saudi CP).

"This could be possibly relating to the general increase in price of benchmark Saudi CP prices and not just to have some sort of compensatory mechanism for the larger domestic LPG segment," he said.

President, PM hail pilot for his role in averting flight crisis

Modi says Smit Machchhar fought valiantly and prevented another 9/11-like attack from happening; Murmu lauds his 'incredible presence of mind'

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Smit Machchhar

Prime Minister Narendra Modi and President Droupadi Murmu on Thursday hailed Captain Smit Machchhar, a flydubai pilot, for his role in averting a disaster involving a Dubai-Tel Aviv flight on Wednesday.

An Indian national, Captain Machchhar was stabbed by his co-pilot in an alleged attempt to crash the plane but managed to activate the release to open the cockpit door, allowing passengers to enter and overpower the co-pilot. Two flydubai pilots who were passengers on the aircraft helped the aircraft make a safe landing in Tabuk, Saudi Arabia.

Mr. Modi said that Captain Machchhar had shown the world the highest form of courage. Without fearing for his own life, Captain Machchhar fought valiantly and prevented another 9/11-like attack from happening, he said.

Mr. Modi said that 140 crore Indians saluted Captain Machchhar, who is now recovering at a hospital, and were praying for his well-being. He made the remarks while addressing the centenary celebrations of the Union Public Service Commission.

President Droupadi Murmu also lauded Captain Machchhar's bravery.

"The nation is proud of Captain Smit Machchhar. His heroic courage and incredible presence of mind have deeply touched us all. Even after being seriously injured in a moment of grave peril, he remained determined to protect the lives of others. His bravery and quick response helped prevent a major tragedy and saved many precious lives. I salute his indomitable spirit. I pray for his speedy recovery and good health," she posted on X.

While addressing the UPSC event, Mr. Modi cautioned that future civil servants would have to navigate entirely new battlegrounds such as information warfare, deepfakes, algorithmic bias, and climate justice. He instructed recruitment agencies to adapt to these global shifts by prioritising candidates' foresight and complex problem-solving abilities. "In such a scenario, in the selection process, we will also have to give priority to testing complex problem-solving and foresight," he said.

With pride and prayers, Machchhar's acquaintances await news of his recovery

Yohaan Ashish Varghese
MUMBAI

Artist Manas Kumar Sahoo pays tribute to Smit Machchhar's bravery with a sand painting in Puri on Thursday. ANI

Pride over Captain Smit Machchhar's bravery aboard flydubai flight FZ1073 was tempered by an anxious wait for news of his recovery on Thursday, as childhood friends, neighbours and residents in Mumbai's Tilak Nagar, Chembur West, prayed for his safe return home.

Mr. Machchhar was hailed for his role in helping passengers and crew manage a safe landing.

The pilot was seriously injured during an attack inside the cockpit of the Dubai-Tel Aviv flight on Wednesday. Despite his injuries, he managed to unlock the cockpit door, allowing others on board to intervene.

The aircraft, carrying 174 passengers, was subsequently landed safely at Tabuk in Saudi Arabia. Machchhar underwent surgery before being shifted to Dubai for further treatment.

"It's a proud moment for all of us as Mumbaikars, as people living in the same society, and as fellow Indians," said Yuhan Merchant, Machchhar's neighbour. "At the same time, we are very concerned about his well-being. We just hope that he is fine."

Mr. Merchant, who has known Machchhar and his family, described him as "tremendously dedicated" to aviation. "We just hope that he continues doing what he does best, and that's falling in love with the aviation sector," he said.

For Chintan, a childhood friend of Machchhar, the courage being spoken about across the world was not entirely unfamiliar. "I knew he was a very brave and large-hearted person, and today the whole world knows it," he said.

Neighbour Shifali Parekh said Mr. Machchhar's response showed considerable mental strength.

"Imagine getting stabbed, then thinking about the flight going down, and then opening the door," Ms. Parekh said.

BJP MLA Parag Shah said the connection was particularly personal for him as Machchhar was not only from his constituency but had also attended the same school as him.

According to Mr. Shah, Mr. Machchhar was stable following surgery and his family was receiving assistance from flydubai and Indian, Saudi and UAE authorities.

SC refuses Mamata camp's petition to unfreeze accounts

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Thursday declined a petition by Mamata Banerjee-led Trinamool Congress faction to operate four bank accounts in public sector banks debit-frozen by the West Bengal Police.

Appearing before a Bench headed by Justice M.M. Sundresh, the petitioner faction argued that the first information reports (FIRs) related to the accounts' freeze suffered from glaring procedural infirmities.

However, the Bench refused to entertain the petition under its appellate jurisdiction, and instead requested the Calcutta High Court to expedite the hearing of petitions filed by Ms. Banerjee's faction challenging the FIRs.

The High Court had declined to provide the faction any interim relief on August 27 regarding the frozen bank accounts which hold over ₹800 crore in them.

The High Court had reasoned that any interim order of the kind would pull the rug from under an earlier direction limiting the party's access to its accounts only to meet daily or monthly expenses.

Earlier in August, the top court had declined to intervene in favour of the political party with regard to three other bank accounts frozen by the Directorate of Enforcement (ED) in connection with a money laundering investigation.

Cong. leader flags 'rushed' scrutiny of FCRA Bill in letter to LS Speaker

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

> The JPC's purpose is to hear from every stakeholder — NGOs, charitable institutions, religious bodies, voluntary organisations, legal experts and State governments — and to bring before the House a well-considered and flawless Bill
>
> **K.C. VENUGOPAL**
> Congress general secretary

Accusing the Joint Parliamentary Committee (JPC) examining the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Amendment Bill, 2026 of rushing through the deliberations without adequate consultations with stakeholders, Congress general secretary (organisation) K.C. Venugopal, in a letter to Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla, urged that the Bill should not be brought back to the floor of the House until the committee had completed a "genuine and comprehensive" examination.

The FCRA Amendment Bill, 2026 was introduced in the Lok Sabha on March 25, 2026 and subsequently referred to a 31-member JPC on August 12 following objections from Opposition parties, who contented that several provisions of the legislation were aimed at hampering the functioning of minority-led institutions.

The Opposition had especially pointed out provisions that allowed the transfer of an organisation's funds and assets to a government-designated authority if the FCRA registration was cancelled or not renewed as particularly disturbing and anti-constitutional. Instead, arriving at a compromise, the government agreed to send the Bill to the JPC.

The decision to refer the Bill to a JPC carried a clear expectation that the committee would hear a broad spectrum of stakeholders, including NGOs, charitable and religious institutions, voluntary organisations, legal experts and State governments, before finalising its recommendations, and bringing before the House "a well-considered and flawless Bill", Mr. Venugopal said in the letter.

However, he claimed that "no meaningful consultation" with stakeholders was taking place, and that there was an intention to secure the passage of the Bill during the forthcoming Winter Session of Parliament. In an earlier letter signed by 12 of the Opposition MPs of the panel, the same concern had been flagged.

"If this is so, it would defeat the very purpose for which the House referred the Bill to the committee, and reduce an important parliamentary process to a mere formality," Mr. Venugopal said, calling on the Speaker, as the "custodian of the House and its committees", to ensure that the panel conducted a comprehensive exercise, and be given adequate time before submitting its report.

Committee on simultaneous elections Bill cancels SC visit

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The parliamentary committee examining the Bills on simultaneous elections has dropped its proposed October 6 visit to the Supreme Court for an interaction with judges. Committee chairperson P.P. Chaudhary, however, said on Thursday that the visit had been deferred because of scheduling difficulties.

The decision came after an Opposition MP wrote to Mr. Chaudhary expressing concern that any interaction with the judges on the proposed legislation could blur the separation of powers and raise questions about the institutional independence of Parliament and the judiciary.

Seeking the views of sitting judges on legislation that could later come before the Supreme Court, the MP said, could create an avoidable institutional overlap.

Bengal govt. obstructing her work as MP, says Mahua; SC seeks reply from Centre, State

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

Mahua Moitra

The Supreme Court on Thursday sought responses from the Union government and the State of West Bengal to a petition filed by Krishnanagar MP Mahua Moitra alleging a concerted effort by the State authorities and the police, using goons and mobs, to impede her from freely accessing her constituency.

A Bench of Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V. Mohana asked Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, appearing on behalf of both the Union and the State governments, to file counter-affidavits to the petition.

Ms. Moitra, represented by senior advocate Gopal Sankaranarayanan and advocate Yashwant Singh, said since the shift in the State's ruling dispensation in May 2026 which saw the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) come into power for the first time in West Bengal, the distinction between 'party' and the 'government' had been "obliterated" in the State. Civil and police authorities had been covertly encouraged to "shun" a duly-elected Opposition MP, and "drive her out of her constituency only because of her political affiliation".

'Registration of FIRs'

"The new State government has made it impossible for the petitioner to function as an MP by seeking to evict her from her local accommodation at the Circuit House and drive her into the hands of a politically charged mob; by holding up development works under the Member of Parliament Local Area Development (MPLAD) scheme; by not allowing her to hold any outdoor party or public meetings; tacitly allowing goons and mobs from the ruling party to physically attack her; and registration of multiple FIRs against her," the petition said.

Any attempt by a State government to impede the functioning of a parliamentarian was a grave attack on the federal principle, Ms. Moitra said.

Civil and police authorities in Krishnanagar had, at the behest of their political bosses, refused to extend any support to her in the discharge of her duties as an MP since May 2026, she said.

Top court stays death penalty of convict in Gujarat blasts case

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Thursday stayed the execution of the death sentence awarded to an Indian Mujahideen operative in the 2008 Ahmedabad serial bomb blasts case, in which 56 people were killed.

A Bench of Justices Vikram Nath, A.G. Masih and Sandeep Mehta passed the interim order while hearing an appeal filed by Ahmed Bawa, alias Abbu Abubakar Barelvi, challenging the Gujarat High Court verdict affirming the death sentence imposed on him by the trial court.

The Bench issued notice to Gujarat government and called for the trial court records, while directing that the death sentence not be executed in the meantime.

Appearing for Barelvi, his counsel contended that his conviction rested entirely on the allegation that he was part of the conspiracy behind the blasts.

APPEAL

Master Yuraj Chandwani, Fortis Memorial Research Institute UHID No.13667414, 6 years is a known case of Thalassemia major. He has a Potential Matched Unrelated Donor & requires Stem Cell Transplant as Curative Therapy. The estimated cost of the transplant is Approximately Rs.32,00,000/-.

Please send donation however small by Cheque/D.D/M.O Fav. **Save Poor Lives** A/c Yuraj Chandwani, **Our A/c Details:** S/B A/c No. 20000913487. S.B.I. R.A.Puram, IFSC CODE:SBIN0001855. Please Donate by G-pay No.9884607377, UPI Id: savepoorlives@oksbi. Donations are exempted under 80G of I.T.ACT.

SAVE POOR LIVES, Flat No. A1, Ceebros Garden, Door No.14/76, Kamarajar Salai, Raja Annamalaipuram, Chennai-600028. Ph. No. 044 42044165 / 9884607377. Email: savepoorlives@gmail.com. Our website: www.savepoorlives.com

HC says draft roll can't be basis for deleting names without hearing

The object of Representation of the People Act and EC is to ensure that votes are cast by citizens, the court says, adding poll body's endeavour is to have as many eligible voters on the roll as possible; expresses concern over automated deletions

Press Trust of India
PANAJI

The Bombay High Court on Thursday said that the primary mandate of the Election Commission (EC) is to ensure that citizens cast their votes, and asserted that while the poll body questions voter conduct, citizens are equally within their rights to ask why exercises such as the special intensive revision (SIR) are ordered after decades.

Hearing a petition filed by six family members whose names were deleted from the voter list, the High Court's Goa Bench, comprising Justices Valmiki Menezes and Amit S. Jamsandekar, said the EC's action was not in consonance with its mandate.

As per the plea filed by Paresh Salgaonkar and his family, they had moved to a new house in the same Santa Cruz Assembly constituency and were instructed by the booth-level officer (BLO) to submit Form 8 for a change of address.

At the time of processing these forms, they said, errors showed up since no record of their elector photo identity cards (EPIC) was found, and as such, the only option available in the ERONET software was "reject". Their Form 8 was rejected, following which they approached the High Court.

> Show us from the Act... what empowers you to delete without a hearing? Your officers were helpless and just decided to throw it on the system. We are very perturbed by this... we are just wondering how many more who have not come to court
>
> **GOA BENCH OF BOMBAY HC**

The EC's advocate Gaurish Agni questioned why the petitioners had not notified authorities of their relocation earlier, to which the Bench remarked "the petitioner will also ask why this SIR after 24 years because he is a citizen of India, why not in between, because the number could have been controllable".

The court added that such discrepancies would never arise if updating electoral rolls was a continuous process.

"It is not about the blame game," the judges noted, pointing out that authorities have access to birth and death records and should automatically update rolls, enrolling people as soon as they turn 18.

The object of the Representation of the People Act and the EC is to ensure that votes are cast by citizens, the court said, adding the election body's endeavour is to have as many eligible voters on the roll as possible. "For that purpose, they can adopt any measures. Whatever measures that you adopt, the object has to be achieved. In that object, here and there, there may be aberrations. But the object cannot be overridden," the Bench asserted.

It noted that instead of rejecting the Form 8, the authorities could have kept it in abeyance and taken it up after the SIR was completed.

"Because what happens is that if you don't keep it pending, the person escapes from the roll... You finish your roll and deal with all the Form 8s. Because that is the best information for you to understand that people have shifted," the court observed.

'Automated deletions'

Expressing deep concern over the automated deletions, the Bench questioned the EC's authority to drop names without giving electors a hearing.

"Show us from the Act... what empowers you to delete without a hearing? Your officers were helpless and just decided to throw it on the system. We are very perturbed by this... we are just wondering how many more who have not come to court," it said and pointed out that such rejections risk taking lakhs of legitimate voters off the rolls.

The Bench had, during the earlier hearing on Wednesday, said the draft roll under the SIR cannot be the basis for deletion of names from the voter list and held that administrative software cannot supersede statutory laws to disenfranchise voters.

The court ruled that the draft roll cannot be the basis for deletion of voters' names. "Otherwise, Form 6, 7 or 8 have no meaning. Form 6, 7 and 8 are specifically for either a person who is a new voter, a person who has lost the right to vote, or a person who is shifting," the court said on Wednesday.

The court told the EC that the "software system did not allow" it to accept Form 8. "He was never a new voter. He was an existing voter. He became new for your system," it said.

The Bench questioned the EC on the provisions empowering it to delete names without a hearing.

The Bench said that once a Form 8 is received, the authority must "apply its mind and see whether this person has really moved (to a new address)".

The court will hear the plea further on October 5.

Who ordered changes to Form 6, asks Rahul Gandhi

Sreeparna Chakrabarty
NEW DELHI

Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi on Thursday alleged that the online Form 6, which is used for fresh voter registration, was changed "illegally" and asked who at the Election Commission ordered Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) to make that change.

Congress general secretary (communications) Jairam Ramesh claimed that the change in Form 6 was orchestrated by "the PM-HM duo" to remove Gen Z voters from the voter list. Quoting an interview given to *The Hindu* by former Chief Election Commissioner O.P. Rawat, Mr. Ramesh said the chorus of voices against the capture of the electoral system is getting louder.

Rahul Gandhi

ERONet application

According to the 2024-25 annual report of the Tata Consultancy Services (TCS), the EC collaborated with technology firm and developed flagship web-based application "ERONet 2.0".

Earlier, ERONet was managed by the Centre for Development of Advanced Computing (C-DAC), which comes under the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology.

"ERONet 2.0 application has a centralised database that serves as the single source of truth for the election body. A standout feature is the executive dashboard, which is updated daily and offers a 360-degree view of the lifecycle of electors," the company said in its customer stories section.

"The ERO Net 2.0 suite of applications includes BLO mobile application which plays a critical role for all elections in the country. As the primary technology partner, TCS helped the election body give a digital makeover to electoral roll management. The application that TCS developed was rolled out nationwide within seven months of launch, with complete functionalities and data migration. It allows over 1.05 million nationwide officials to handle elector registrations, updates, and deletions efficiently," it further said.

In January 2026, the Election Commission (EC) integrated ERONet (Electoral Registration Officers Network) into a comprehensive umbrella platform, known as ECINet.

Mr. Gandhi, in a post on X, alleged: "The online Form 6 was changed illegally – as the EC's own Commissioners have recorded. Who at the ECI ordered Tata Consultancy Services to make that change? He also questioned whether TCS was 'pressured' into doing it?"

According to contribution reports of various electoral trusts for 2024-25, which are available on the Election Commission's website, the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) received ₹959 crore as political donations from various electoral trusts in 2024-25, out of which nearly ₹757 crore, which is 83% of the total donations to the party, came from Tata Group-controlled Progressive Electoral Trust (PET).

Tagging an interview by Mr. Rawat, Mr. Ramesh said: "Citizens will no longer tolerate vote *chori* (theft) in any form."

People will not forgive those who snatch their voting rights: Mamata

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The people of India will not forgive those responsible for snatching away their voting rights, former West Bengal Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee said on Thursday, even as she predicted an early demise of the Narendra Modi government before it completes its third term in 2029.

Addressing a press conference in the national capital, Ms. Banerjee – flanked by MPs from her faction of the Trinamool Congress from both Houses of Parliament, including her nephew Abhishek Banerjee – also questioned the immunity provision for the Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) and Election Commissioners under a 2023 law.

Former West Bengal CM Mamata Banerjee at a press conference in New Delhi on Thursday. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

"We believe that this time, the BJP will go and we do not have to wait up to 2029. See what happens. The game has begun," Ms. Banerjee said.

Her remarks came a day after the INDIA bloc meeting. Responding to a question on the alliance's prospects and her endorsement of Leader of the Opposition Rahul Gandhi as the bloc's Prime Ministerial face, she said the Opposition should first focus on immediate political issues, including the functioning of the Election Commission of India (EC).

"See how long it will go on. Two months, three months, six months. I am not an astrologer. But I think, very soon, you will get the good news," she said.

'Hijacked election'

Alleging that the West Bengal Assembly election was "hijacked", Ms. Banerjee claimed the Election Commission had centralised the special intensive revision (SIR) of the State's electoral rolls, the State police functioned as a BJP wing, Opposition counting agents were forced out of polling booths, and 4,000 electronic voting machines (EVMs) were burnt without anyone being apprehended.

Plea in SC questions judge's failure to disclose his son's role as EC's counsel

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

A petitioner in a case challenging the Election Commissioners' appointment law, which culminated in a split verdict, orally mentioned on Thursday his application questioning why one of the judges on the Bench, Justice Satish Chandra Sharma, did not reveal during multiple court proceedings that his son was a standing counsel for the Election Commission.

The application was mentioned before Justice Dipankar Datta, the lead judge on the Bench that delivered the split verdict on September 23. Justice Datta asked the petitioner-applicant to mention his plea before the Chief Justice of India. The CJI is not holding court on Friday. The next working day for the court is October 5.

The application was filed by Naman Sherstra, represented by senior advocate Gopal Sankaranarayanan and advocate Pawan Reley. Mr. Sherstra has sought a recall of the opinion given by Justice Sharma, who was the puisne judge on the Division Bench headed by Justice Datta, on September 23, on the question of referring the challenge to the constitutional validity of the Chief Election Commissioner and Other Election Commissioners (Appointment, Conditions of Service and Term of Office) Act, 2023 to a five-judge Bench.

While Justice Datta, in his opinion, had declined the reference to a Constitution Bench, Justice Sharma took an opposing view in favour of the reference. Eventually, both judges on the Bench had passed a common order for the Chief Justice of India to allocate the case to a Constitution Bench.

The application has objected to this common order but did not challenge, specifically, the separate opinion given by Justice Datta.

Seek recall

Subsequent to the September 23 verdict, media reports had alleged that Justice Sharma's son was a standing counsel for the EC.

Another petitioner, Jaya Thakur, has already filed a curative petition on September 29 to recall the split verdict, alleging "reasonable apprehension of bias and propriety".

Mr. Sherstra, though similarly seeking a recall, did not impute "actual bias, motive or want of good faith" on the part of Justice Sharma.

"The petitioners state that had the engagement of Mr. Siddharth Sharma as standing counsel for the EC been disclosed during the hearings, they would have requested that Justice Satish Chandra Sharma recuse from the present batch. The absence of disclosure deprived the petitioners of an opportunity to raise that request before the opinions and order dated September 23 were pronounced," the application submitted.

U.P. has 'one district, one mafia' model: Congress

The Congress on Thursday attacked the BJP government in Uttar Pradesh over the law and order situation, alleging that Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath had created a "one district, one mafia" model, with criminals enjoying political protection. The party alleged that Dalits, victims and the vulnerable were bearing the brunt of this.

KANNUR INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT LIMITED
KANNUR International Airport

E - Tender - EV Charging Station

E-Tenders are invited by Managing Director, KIAL for Selection of an Agency for Design, Develop, Operate, Maintain and Manage an EV Fast Charging Station at Kannur International Airport.

For more details, please visit - www.etenders.kerala.gov.in

Bid Submission Last Date: 15 October 2026, 1400 Hrs

E-Tender ID: 2026_KIAL_874981_1

Indian Overseas Bank
Information Technology Department
Central Office: 763, ANNA SALAI, CHENNAI-600002
www.iob.bank.in

Indian Overseas bank (IOB) invites bids for the following:

GOVERNMENT E-MARKET PORTAL - PROCUREMENT OF CISCO CORE NETWORK INFRASTRUCTURE AND FIREWALL ANALYZER FOR THE PROPOSED NEW DISASTER RECOVERY SITE (DRS)

BID NO: GEM/2026/B/8095833 DATED 29.09.2026

Kindly note that the earlier tender floated vide bid ref no: GEM/2026/B/ 8084659 dated 27.09.2026 is cancelled

The Above GEM Tender document is also available and can be downloaded from the following websites **www.iob.bank.in** & **www.gem.gov.in** For Tender details and future amendments, if any, keep referring to the following website **www.gem.gov.in**

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
DEPARTMENT OF WATER RESOURCES
OFFICE OF THE ADDITIONAL CHIEF ENGINEER, EASTERN CIRCLE-I, CANTONMENT ROAD, KATAKA.
Email id :- seeccuttack@gmail.com

"e" Procurement Notice No.ACE, EC-I/10 of 2026-27

1.	Nature of work	: Road work, Canal Lining work, Stone work.
2.	Total no. of works	: 3 Nos.
3.	Tender Amount	: Varies from Rs.251.16 lakh to Rs.422.91 lakh (Approx.)
4.	Tender paper cost	: Rs.10,000/- per each tender (Non refundable)
5.	EMD required	: As mentioned in Section No.1 of DTCN (Clause No.6)
6.	Class of contractor	: As mentioned in Section No.1 of DTCN (Clause No.1)
7.	Period of completion	: As mentioned in Section No.1 of DTCN (Clause No.8)
8.	Online for bidding	: 07.10.2026 at 10.00 hrs. to 22.10.2026 up to 17.30 hrs.
9.	Date & time of opening of Tender (Technical bid)	: 23.10.2026 at 11.30 hrs.

Other terms and conditions can be seen from the Govt. website "**www.tendersodisha.gov.in**".
All corrigendum / cancellation of tender if any, will only be uploaded in the above web site.

Additional Chief Engineer, Eastern Circle-I, Kataka.
32001/961/2627 OIPR-32001/32370/1/26-27/0009

THE ODISHA STATE POLICE HOUSING & WELFARE CORPORATION LTD.
(A Government of Odisha Undertaking)
JANAPATH, BHOINAGAR, BHUBANESWAR-22.
Ph: 0674-2541545, 2542921, E-mail: ophwc.od@od.gov.in, Website: www.ophwc.com

e-procurement notice No.- 14/OPHWC/2026-27

INVITATION FOR BIDS (IFB)

The **Chief Engineer (OSPH&WC)**, Odisha, Bhubaneswar invites Percentage rate bid in Double Cover system in **ONLINE MODE** only, for the works as detailed below:

1	Nature of work	Building works
2	No. of Works	07 Nos.
3	Value of Tender	Rs.2.12 Cr. to Rs.94.86 Cr.
4	Class of Contractor	'B' Class to 'Super' Class
5	Cost of Bid document (To be paid online)	₹ 11,800.00
6	Availability of Bid Documents in the website	Dt. 03/10/2026 to Dt. 26/10/2026 up to 5.00 P.M
7	Last date /time of Receipt of Bids in the Portal	Dt. 26/10/2026 up to 5.00 P.M
8	Date of Opening Bid	Dt. 27/10/2026 at 10.30 A.M.
9	Date of Technical Presentation (among qualified bidders only)	Date & Time will be notified after opening of the Technical Bid.
10	*The Bidders have to participate in ONLINE bidding only. Further details can also be seen from the website: https://tendersodisha.gov.in. Any addendum/corrigendum/cancellation of tender shall not be published in Newspaper and can only be seen in the said website. *The Authority reserves the right to reject any or all bids and terminate the tender process without assigning any reason thereof.	

Sd/- **Chief Engineer (OSPH&WC)**

N.B.-The quoted rate should be in all inclusive but excluding G.S.T. as applicable Under works contract.

12001/159/2627 OIPR-12001/12025/1/26-27/0017

KERALA STATE COUNCIL FOR SCIENCE, TECHNOLOGY AND ENVIRONMENT (KSCSTE)
Sasthrabhavan, Pattom, Thiruvananthapuram - 695004,
Phone : 0471 - 2548316, Website: www.kscste.kerala.gov.in

NOTIFICATION

The KSCSTE is seeking qualified candidates for the post of Executive Director, KSCSTE-CWRDM
For details log on to **www.kscste.kerala.gov.in.**
Last date for the receipt of application is **17.10.2026, 5.00 p.m**

D3/577/2026/I&PRD EXECUTIVE VICE PRESIDENT

कार्यालय जोधपुर विकास प्राधिकरण, जोधपुर

क्रमांक :- अ.अ./पीएचई/2026-27/राजकाज 24826774 दिनांक :- 01/10/2026

ई-बिड सूचना संख्या:- जोन (पीएचई)/14/26-27 दिनांक 01.10.2026

जोधपुर विकास प्राधिकरण, जोधपुर की ओर से सीवरेज के कार्य हेतु संवेदकों से निर्धारित प्रपत्र में ई–प्रोक्युरमेन्ट प्रक्रिया से ऑनलाईन निविदाए आमंत्रित की जाती है। इन उक्त कार्य की अनुमानित लागत, निविदा बेचे जाने तथा प्राप्त करने की दिनांक, निविदा शर्तें आदि का सम्पूर्ण विवरण वेबसाईट **http://www.eproc.rajasthan.gov.in, www.jodhpurjda.org, www.sppp.raj.nic.in** पर देखा जा सकता है।

NIB Code :- JOD2627A0199
UBN No. :- JOD2627WLOB00371

राज.संवाद/सी/26/11115 अधिशाषी अभियंता (पीएचई)

राजस्थान स्कूल शिक्षा परिषद्
मु- तल, ब्लॉक-6, जे.एल.एन. दयाकृष्णन शिक्षा संकुल, गवाड़ी नाल मेहरू मार्ग, जयपुर,
फोन नं: 0141-2700459, E-Mail:- RAJSMSA.CIVIL@RAJASTHAN.GOV.IN

क्रमांक :- F-5(1)(325)RCSCE/Civil/NIT 2026-27 /2026/D-3982 दिनांक :- 25/09/2026

अल्पकालीन ई-निविदा सूचना संख्या 13 (सिविल)/2026-27

(राजकीय विद्यालय/केजीबीवी में मरम्मत कार्यो हेतु)

राज्य एवं केन्द्र सरकार के राजकीय/अर्द्धशासकीय/स्वायत्तशासी निकायों में सक्षम श्रेणी मरम्मत कार्यो हेतु पंजीकृत संवेदकों से समग्र शिक्षा योजनान्तर्गत राजकीय विद्यालय/केजीबीवी में मरम्मत कार्यों के लिए वार्षिक दर संविदा हेतु 139 ब्लॉकों में राशि रू. 15060.98 लाख (प्रति ब्लॉक की राशि रूपये 100.00 लाख से 251.68 लाख के मध्य) बाबत् कार्यवार ई–टेण्डरिंग के माध्यम से अल्पकालिन ई–निविदाऐं 29/09/2026 प्रातः 10.00 बजे से 08/10/2026 को सायं 6.00 बजे तक आमंत्रित की जाती है।

UBN No. : RSE2627WSOB011391

निविदा से सम्बधित समस्त विस्तृत विवरण वेबसाईट **http://rajsmsa.nic.in, http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in** एवं **http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in** पर देखा जा सकता है। निविदा से सम्बन्धित प्रक्रिया जिला परियोजना समन्वयक, समग्र शिक्षा कार्यालय सम्बन्धित जिला के स्तर से की जावेगी।

राज्य.संवाद/सी/26/11025 राज्य परियोजना निदेशक समग्र शिक्षा

APPOINTMENT

भारतीय प्रौद्योगिकी संस्थान गुवाहाटी
INDIAN INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY GUWAHATI
गुवाहाटी – 781039, Guwahati - 781 039

Vacancy of Manager - Strategic Partnerships & Philanthropy and Assistant Project Engineer

IIT Guwahati invites applications from eligible individuals for temporary positions of Manager - Strategic Partnerships & Philanthropy and Assistant Project Engineer. Details of the posts are available at IIT Guwahati website: **https://iitg.ac.in/iitg_reqr_details?p=4473/advertisement-for-positions-of-manager**.

Last Date of application: **20-10-2026, 5:00 PM.**

Head of the Section (ACIR)

RAJASTHAN RAJYA VIDYUT UTPADAN NIGAM LIMITED
CIN:- U40102RJ2000SGC016484 (A Govt. of Rajasthan Undertaking)
O/o CE (fuel), 6th Floor, LIC Jeevandeep Building, Lalkothi, Jaipur

E-TENDER NOTICE: TN-09(RVU2627SLOB01367)

Online Tenders are invited for Rate contract for taking delivery of raw coal from WCL collieries on behalf of RVUN, through transportation and loading of the same into Railway wagons for dispatch to RVUNs TPSs and completing all documentation as required by Coal Company, Railways and RVUN for year 2026-27. Tender details are available on http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in (for e-tender), www.energy.rajasthan.gov.in/rvunl & www.sppp.rajasthan.gov.in.

Raj.Samwad/C/26/11169 RVUN/PR-4482 Superintending Engineer (Fuel)

कार्यालय अधिशाषी अभियन्ता,सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग,खण्ड–चित्तौडगढ
क्रमांक /टी.एस./2026–27/डी :–2399 दिनांक :–25.09.2026

NOTICE INVITING BID – 24/2026-27

Bids for Various CONSTRUCTION OF INDOOR STADIUM WORK AT KAPASAN DIST-CHITTORGARH. DLP Mention in Tender Documents in Division Chittorgarh Procurement are invited from interested Bidders up to 6.00 PM of 21.10.2026 Other particulars of the Bid may be visited on the Procurement Portal (http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in, http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in,) of the state website. The approximate value of the Procurement in **Rs.** ***23742618.00***

NIB CODE **PWD2627A2989** **(Naveen Kumar Agrawal)**
UBN NO. 1 PWD2627WSOB13450 **Executive Engineer**
DIPR/C/16781/2026 **PWD Dn. Chittorgarh**

INBRIEF

Govt. sets sugar stock limit to 1,000 quintals for dealers

The government on Thursday tightened the stock-holding limit for sugar dealers to 1,000 quintals, effective from October 15 to November 30, in a bid to ensure adequate supplies at reasonable prices during the festival season. Dealers will be allowed to hold stock for only 15 days. The amended norms will not apply to Kolkata and its extended metropolitan areas, and Assam, where the limit is 2,000 quintals, the Food Ministry said in a statement. The Ministry said that the objective of the amended rules was to "ensure that there is no unnecessary accumulation of sugar in the distribution chain."

Govt. revises FASTag norms for people with disabilities

The government on Thursday revised guidelines for vehicles registered under the Divyangjan category. The beneficiaries will receive an exempted FASTag based on the disability percentage shown on their disability certificate. The Ministry of Road Transport and Highways revised the guidelines for issuing and renewing exempted FASTags for eligible beneficiaries to simplify toll-related procedures for Divyangjan and persons with disabilities (PwD). FASTags issued to persons with 70% to 100% disability will be valid for five years, while those issued to persons with 40% to less than 70% disability will be valid for three years, the Ministry said.

In a first, NCERT textbook has chapter on new tax regime

In a first at school level, students as young as those in Class 9 will be taught how to calculate income tax liability under the new tax regime. The newly released social science textbook of the National Council for Educational Research and Training (NCERT) – *Understanding Society: India and Beyond Part Two* – has been included in the chapter, titled "Managing Your Personal Finances". Students can now work through the actual slab-wise tax calculation which is a first for this age group, stated NCERT director Dinesh Prasad Saklani. The chapter details the steps to calculate tax liability based on the listed slabs.

CBI files second chargesheet against 11 in RHFL case

The Central Bureau of Investigation on Thursday said it had filed the second chargesheet in Reliance Home Finance Ltd. (RHFL) case against 11 accused, including three executives of Anil Ambani-led Reliance ADA Group, namely Amit Bapna, Director and Chief Financial Officer (CFO), RHFL, Amitabh Jhunjhunwala, Group Managing Director and Vice Chairman, RCL, and Suresh Nagarajan, CFO, Reliance Power Ltd. The others include seven Reliance ADA Group companies. "The accused have been chargesheeted for offences of criminal conspiracy and cheating under the IPC," the CBI said in a press release. The investigation in these cases is being monitored by the Supreme Court.

SC bars licence renewal for motorists with unpaid fines

Top court directs that vehicles with unpaid e-challans be blacklisted, preventing their sale or transfer until the dues are cleared; it also calls for greater use of technology in traffic enforcement

Aaratrika Bhaumik
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court has directed the States and Union Territories to block a range of online and vehicle-related services for motorists with outstanding traffic fines, including registration renewals, fitness and pollution-under-control certificates, ownership transfers, and driving licence renewals.

The court was informed that e-challans worth about ₹49,194.05 crore remained outstanding across the country, while ₹26,175.05 crore had been recovered so far.

A Bench of Justices J.B. Pardiwala and K.V. Viswanathan directed that vehicles with unpaid e-challans be blacklisted on the Central Parivahan portal, effectively preventing their sale or transfer until dues are cleared. In cases involving multiple traffic violations, the authorities have also been directed to withhold renewal of driving licences and take steps to suspend existing licences.

"What we want to convey in simple words is that the authorities need to work at the ground level, having regard to the ground realities... We also direct that let there be random checking of the vehicles, and if it is found that the e-challan issued has not been abided or honoured, necessary steps shall be taken to impound the vehicle itself," the Bench said, in its September 28 order made public on Thursday.

The court has asked the States and Union Territories to block vehicle-related services for motorists with pending fines. FILE PHOTO

Road safety case

The directions were issued in a road safety case dating back to 2012, in which the top court has been monitoring the implementation of the Motor Vehicles Act, 1988, and the Central Motor Vehicles Rules, 1989, for nearly 14 years.

The Bench called for greater use of technology in traffic enforcement, directing the States and Union Territories to immediately implement the Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) framed by the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways on October 28, 2025. The SOP seeks to give effect to Section 136A of the Motor Vehicles Act, 1988, read with Rule 167A of the Central Motor Vehicles Rules, 1989.

Under the framework, traffic violations are to be detected electronically through devices such as CCTV cameras, speed cameras, and speed guns. The State governments have been directed to identify and notify locations for electronic enforcement and complete the procurement, deployment, and calibration of equipment.

The court directed the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways to set up a public dashboard showing how electronic traffic enforcement is being implemented.

The Bench sought details of the steps taken by the Delhi government to comply with its September 15 directions on pedestrian safety along Mathura Road near the Delhi High Court and the National Zoological Park.

Amicus curiae and senior advocate Gaurav Agrawal informed the court that he wrote to the Delhi Chief Secretary on September 19 regarding compliance with the directions but had received no response. The earlier directions called for measures, including synchronised traffic lights, along the stretch.

Eight students on picnic drown in sea in Maharashtra

The Hindu Bureau
MUMBAI

The students were part of a group from Winners Academy, a coaching class in Pune district

Eight students from Pune district of Maharashtra drowned in the Arabian Sea while on a picnic at the Diveagar beach in Raigad district on Thursday.

According to the Raigad police, the students drowned after being caught in strong sea currents. They were part of a 48-member group from Winners Academy, a coaching class in Alandi in Pune district, located around 170 km from Diveagar. The group comprised 25 boys, 17 girls, and six teachers. The students are in Class 11 and 12.

"The group arrived at the beach around 5.30 p.m. Eight of them entered the sea and were swept away by the current," said a Raigad police official, adding that the bodies were retrieved by evening.

Condolence

According to the police, all eight students were rushed to the primary health centre at Borli, where doctors declared them dead. The deceased have been identified as Tanmay Vahile, Sumit Ahire, Pranav Bansode, Kaivalya Wasankar, Rajveer Vahile, Yash Wankhede, Soham Bhandwalkar, and Kaustubh Daund.

Calling the incident "heart-wrenching", Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis said, "The local administration is coordinating to bring their bodies to Alandi, their hometown."

NCP(SP) leader Supriya Sule expressed her condolences, saying, "Tourists visiting the seashore for leisure are requested to exercise caution when entering the sea."

Probe ordered

Disaster Management Minister Girish Mahajan ordered an investigation into whether necessary safety precautions were taken for the trip. "As per the information, only two teachers were present with the 48 students. It is necessary to investigate how permission was granted for students who could not swim to enter the sea," Mr. Mahajan said.

U.P. roadside delivery case: four doctors face action

Press Trust of India
BHADOHI

Four doctors and a nurse have been found guilty of serious negligence in connection with a pregnant woman allegedly being denied admission to a district hospital in Uttar Pradesh, forcing her to deliver on the roadside, officials said on Thursday.

The woman's family had alleged that the doctors and the staff nurse refused to touch the woman after identifying her as belonging to the Musahar tribal community, and did not admit her. The Chief Medical Officer said action had been recommended against Chief Medical Superintendent Ajay Kumar Tiwari and gynaecologist Neelima Dhawan. Contractual doctor Pankaj Kumar has been removed from service. Staff nurse Neelam Maurya has been transferred

Govt. absent here, says Rahul in Balaghat; flags lack of healthcare

Mehul Malpani
BHOPAL

Congress leader Rahul Gandhi on Thursday accused the Union and Madhya Pradesh governments of abandoning the tribal community without basic facilities, speaking in Balaghat where more than 30 tribal children have died in the past three months due to monsoon-related illnesses, poor immunity, and lack of access to healthcare.

Terming such tragedies a failure of the State's Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) government, Mr. Gandhi, the Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha, said that he would raise the issues of Madhya Pradesh's tribal community in Parliament.

'Govt. disappeared'

"The facilities like health, education, and employment that the government should have provided, have been shut here. It feels as if these people have been left in the middle of India and the Government of India and the Government of Madhya Pradesh are not present here," he told pressperson after visiting the affected families.

Rahul Gandhi meets tribal families who have lost more than 30 children amid severe illnesses in Balaghat. ANI

Mr. Gandhi said that the government was not providing any support to the people in the area, with regard to land registration, forest rights, or MGNREGA, the rural jobs scheme, now replaced by the Viksit Bharat-Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission – Gramin (VB-G RAM G).

The Congress leader, who was on his second visit to the State in two weeks, alleged that half the families who lost their children were yet to receive compensation.

A local woman nodded as he spoke, saying, "[We] haven't received it."

Though the authorities have blamed the local peoples' belief in practices such as faith healing, the affected families have alleged lack of access to hospitals, saying healthcare professionals do not come to their remote villages.

'Complete failure'

Mr. Gandhi alleged that the women are facing cuts in their allowance under the State's Ladli Behna Scheme if they are given money in some other scheme. "If you are running two schemes, then they should get the benefits of both," he said.

Asked about other tragedies, such as the deaths of children in neighbouring Chhindwara due to adulterated cough syrup last year and Indore's water contamination-related deaths earlier this year, Mr. Gandhi said, "There is complete government failure in Madhya Pradesh."

The Hindu's documentary on Gandhi to be out today

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

On the occasion of Gandhi Jayanthi, *The Hindu* is releasing a documentary, *Gandhi for GenZ: The Mahatma is suddenly cool again,* that highlights the relevance of the Father of the Nation to the struggles of the youth of India today.

With interviews of Gandhi historians, Gen-Z activists and archival footage, the 30-minute documentary is both a tribute to and an assessment of the Mahatma.

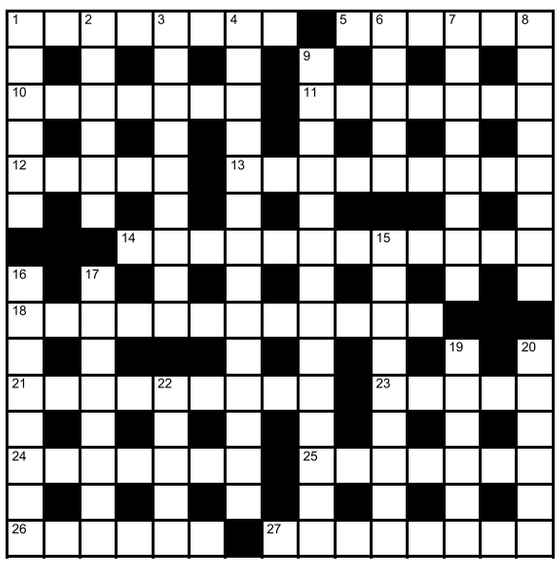
It will be published on *The Hindu*'s website and on YouTube.

TH CROSSWORD + 14913

(set by Hypatia)

Solve this puzzle online and access more puzzles at *https://thehindu.com/crosswords*

SCAN TO PLAY



Across

1 Fine dialect mixed with English (8)
5 Abridged creator's introduction to song composer (6)
10 A criminal had occasionally seen crime as unrighteousness (7)
11 Completely obsolete or modernised (7)
12 Technical expressions representing many subjects, basically (5)
13 Heated and dry cooked to remove water (9)
14 Proposed healthy topic's abandoned (12)
18 Spooner's restrained like a hawk in perfect condition (5,2,1,4)
21 State of guy trapped in Iran — America conflicts (9)
23 Fruit sources of original liquor in Venice especially (5)
24 Divine journey meeting daughter's wish (7)
25 Tests gold handles (7)
26 Tie and dye art's frequently red (6)
27 Long duration of meal regularly converting to energy in motherhood (8)

Down

1 Want samples of handmade art hangings (6)
2 Folktale about a husband's city (6)
3 Short saint regarded and showed deference (9)
4 Dark web expert, reversing role, orders iPod models (8,6)
6 Auditor's scanned passport prepared again (5)
7 Cause for condiment that's spicy (3,5)
8 Crafty about vacating unused study without warning (8)
9 First thing to do in a regatta — spare no expenses (4,3,4,3)
15 Reject all or derail some tough challenge (4,5)
16 Snail won second place in running race before (8)
17 Kipling character united with gang making noise (5,3)
19 Bahraini confused about this desi name (6)
20 Spirited celebration welcoming onset of Indian year(6)
22 Simple mother lacking time (5)

SUDOKU

8					7			2
5	6		4			7		
						8		
9				4			2	
			6		8			
	7			1				4
		4						
		7			2		8	9
6			3					5

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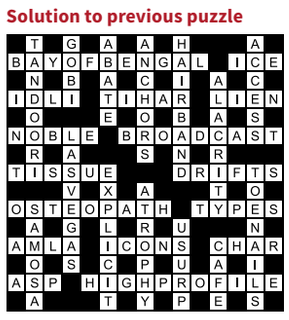
DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★★★☆

Solution to previous puzzle



Solution to yesterday's Sudoku

8	3	9	7	1	6	5	2	4
4	7	2	3	8	5	1	9	6
5	6	1	9	2	4	8	7	3
6	8	4	2	5	9	3	1	7
2	1	5	4	7	3	6	8	9
3	9	7	8	6	1	4	5	2
7	2	3	1	4	8	9	6	5
9	5	8	6	3	2	7	4	1
1	4	6	5	9	7	2	3	8

FAITH

Aparadha Kshamapanam

Aparadha Kshamapanam involves praying to Bhagavan to forgive the mistakes and offences we have committed.

Swami Desikan sets out this idea in his work Nyasa Dasakam. He asks the Lord who will remove the sufferings of those who surrender to Him, to grant forgiveness for all the sins and offences we have committed, said Navalpakkam Sri Vasudevachariar in a discourse.

In the same way, Swami Ramanuja sets out the idea of *Aparadha Kshamapanam* in his work Saranagati Gadyam. The main point of the Saranagati Gadyam is closely linked to the meaning of Dvaya Mantra. In order for the jivatma to achieve union with the paramatma, all of its defects, sins, and karmic obstacles must be eliminated by the Lord's grace; it is for this reason that in Saranagati Gadyam, Swami Ramanuja repeatedly asks for forgiveness from Bhagavan for the various offences which the soul has committed.

There are various types of *aparadhas* or offences. These include: *Akrtya karanam, Krtya akaranam, Bhagavad apacharam,* and *Bhagavata apacharam.*

The Varaha Purana likewise describes the kinds of offences and sinful acts one should avoid; similarly, Swami Desikan sets out various forms of offences, including a traditional list of 32 *apacharas* one should not commit when visiting a temple. *Aparadha Kshamapanam* is a significant element of Saranagati; the devotee becomes aware of his faults, genuinely asks for the Lord's forgiveness, and places his total trust in Bhagavan's compassion and grace so that his sins and karmic obstacles may be removed and he may, in the end, attain Him.

GST revenue rises to ₹2.03 lakh cr. in Sept.

An analysis of historical Goods and Services Tax data shows that an increasing share of GST revenues have been coming from tax paid on imports rather than GST collected on domestic transactions; share of revenue from domestic transactions has correspondingly fallen to its lowest-ever level

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

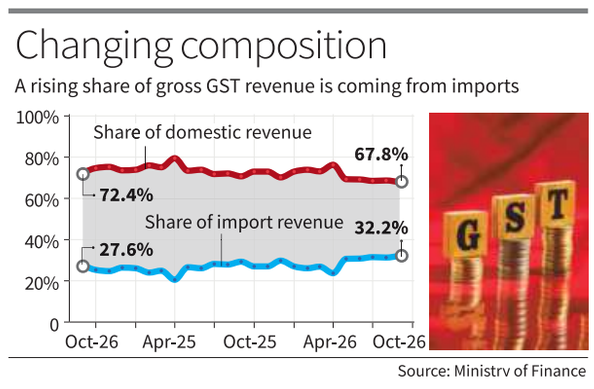
The Centre's gross Goods and Services Tax (GST) revenue rose to ₹2.03 lakh crore in September 2026, a growth of 14.7% over the last year. However, the data also points to a changing trend of where India is earning its GST revenue from.

An analysis of historical GST data shows the share of revenues from imports has risen to its highest-ever level, while the share of revenue from domestic transactions has correspondingly fallen to its lowest-ever level.

Over the first half of the financial year, spanning the April-September 2026 period, gross GST revenue grew at 11.6%.

"The increased focus on reducing complications and the increasing number of GST audits undertaken this year appear to be yielding results in the form of the gross monthly GST collection once again crossing the Rs 2 lakh crore mark," M.S. Mani, partner at Deloitte India said.

"It is especially remarkable to see the gross GST collections growing by 14.7% and the net GST collections growing by 18.1% compared to the same month last year despite last year being on higher GST rates compared to the current year," he added.



However, within the gross collections, the data shows that revenue from imports grew by 25.9% in September 2026 while revenue from domestic transactions grew by a relatively slower 10.1%.

While the growth in domestic revenue is among the fastest seen since August 2025, the faster pace of import revenue growth through this period has meant that the composition of the Centre's GST revenues has been changing. That is, revenue from imports in September 2026 saw its share increase to 32.2% of total gross GST revenue, the highest-ever. Correspondingly, the share of domestic revenues fell to a lowest-ever 67.8%.

"The sharp 25.9% growth in import-linked GST in September, compared with around 10% growth in domestic GST, reflects a combination of currency, commodity prices and import dynamics," Manoj Mishra, Partner and Tax Controversy Management Leader at Grant Thornton Bharat said.

The data also shows that total refunds contracted 3% in September 2026, driven by a contraction in domestic refunds.

INBRIEF

Govt. warns private fuel retailers over sales cap

Imposing caps on retail fuel sales is not acceptable and the government will take up the matter with private oil-marketing companies, Petroleum Ministry Secretary Neeraj Mittal told reporters in response to queries over diesel purchase limits imposed by private retailers Jio-bp and Nayara Energy. "Nobody is allowed to put a cap on sales. We will take it up with them and tell them it is not acceptable," Mr. Mittal said.

ICICI Prudential Life's Bagchi named HDFC Bank MD, CEO

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI), has approved appointment of Anup Bagchi as the Managing Director & Chief Executive Officer (MD & CEO) of HDFC Bank for a period three years with effect from October 27, 2026. Mr. Bagchi, a seasoned financial services leader with over three decades of experience across banking, capital markets, wealth management and insurance, will replace Sashidhar Jagdishan.

Coal India's production jumps 9.2% in September

Coal India's production rose 9.2% year-on-year to 53.5 million tonnes (MT) in September, while supplies grew 12.5% to 61.2 MT. Supplies to the power sector, its largest consumer, increased 10.6% to 48.9 MT. Supplies to the non-regulated sector rose 19.4%. The state-owned miner said sustained operational momentum has strengthened its confidence in meeting its FY27 production target of 815 MT and supply target of 850 MT.

Goyal, Greer deliberate 'early conclusion' of trade treaty

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal on Thursday said that he had held a meeting with U.S. Trade Representative Jamieson Greer on the sidelines of the G20 Trade Ministers' Meeting in the U.S. Mr. Goyal said that the two leaders discussed the "early conclusion" of an interim agreement under the India-U.S. Bilateral Trade Agreement.

While Mr. Goyal did not mention discussing the proposed 100% tariffs that the U.S. is looking to levy on India, Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agrawal had earlier said that "all trade issues" would be discussed by the Minister during his visit to the U.S.

Commerce Piyush Goyal with U.S. Trade Representative Jamieson Greer.

"Met USTR Jamieson Greer on the sidelines of the G20 Trade Ministers' Meeting in Milwaukee," Mr. Goyal posted on X on Thursday morning. "Had a productive discussion with USTR Greer towards early conclusion of a mutually beneficial interim agreement under the India-U.S. Bilateral Trade Agreement."

The two also exchanged views on G20 deliberations under the ongoing U.S. Chairship, he added.

Mr. Goyal also held a meeting with Maroš Šefčovič, the European Commissioner for Trade and Economic Security.

"Reviewed progress towards the signing and entry into force of the India-EU FTA," Mr. Goyal said.

Manufacturing PMI touches 7-month high of 55.1 in Sept.

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Stronger demand for electronic, food, pharma products drove a sharper rise in new business

Manufacturing activity rose to a seven-month high of 55.1 in September, according to a private sector survey. However, activity in the second quarter was the weakest since the COVID-19-impacted Q2 of 2021-22.

That said, September's performance marked a significant recovery as the HSBC India Manufacturing Purchasing Managers' Index rose by 2.3 index points from its 52.8 reading in August 2026.

A reading above 50 denotes expansion in activity while one below 50 implies a contraction. "September data showed a recovery in growth momentum across India's manufacturing industry, with faster increases in new orders and output supporting job creation and inventory accumulation," the report said.

"Moreover, business confidence strengthened to a four-month high."

"That said, the average for the second fiscal quarter stood at 53.8, its lowest since the same period in 2021," it added.

Respondents said that stronger demand for electronic, food, pharmaceutical, and textile products drove a sharper increase in new business, with the upturn in total sales the fastest since February 2026.

"New export orders also expanded at a quicker pace, with panel members particularly noting greater demand from clients in Brazil, Europe, the UAE and the U.S," the report said. "This pick-up in demand momentum spurred the sharpest expansion in Indian factory production for four months."

Anti-multilateral trade deals may hit growth, exports: govt. economists

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

Economists in the Ministry of Finance have warned that bilateral and regional trade deals that seek to replace the current multilateral trade system could lead to "greater trade diversion, higher trade costs, and greater uncertainty".

However, while India was pursuing a diversified trade strategy, it was doing so within multilateral trading system and still sought to have the World Trade Organization (WTO) at the core of such a system, say the economists.

The Monthly Economic Review for September, prepared by economists in the Department of Economic Affairs, cited the WTO's recent report that sought to predict what would happen to the world economy by 2050 under three different trade-related scenarios.

'Network of FTAs' system can cut global GDP, exports.

"According to the WTO's World Trade Report 2026, in a 'geo-fragmented world' scenario, in which trade is organised around geopolitical blocks, global GDP is projected to decline by 5.1%, and global exports by 18.6% relative to the baseline in 2050," they said.

Worst of scenarios

The worst of the scenarios would be a 'Free Trade Agreement (FTA) world' in which the multilateral trading system is replaced by a network of FTAs with tariffs on non-FTA partners in a non-cooperative way. If this comes about, cuts in global GDP and exports were estimated by WTO at 6.9% and 26.9% each.

"In an 'enhanced cooperation world' scenario, wherein multilateral cooperation is reinforced, global GDP and global exports are projected to rise 2.9% and 17.9%, respectively."

Therefore, the report concluded regional and bilateral trade pacts can provide additional market access and complement the multilateral system when they operate within the WTO framework. However, the costs of such trade deals turn higher when they take place outside the multilateral framework and used to substitute it.

"In such a situation, market access turns more dependent on the terms negotiated between partners while trade outside the arrangements faces less favourable conditions. This results in greater trade diversion, higher trade costs, and greater uncertainty."

PNG Drive 3.0 to add 50 lakh connections

Saptaparno Ghosh
NEW DELHI

Union Petroleum Minister Hardeep Singh Puri, along with the Petroleum and Natural Gas Regulatory Board (PNGRB) and city-gas distributors, unveiled National PNG Drive 3.0 to boost shift to piped natural gas (PNG) for households.

The latest phase, which will run until the end of FY27, targets 50 lakh new domestic PNG connections, conversion of 40 lakh existing connections into active consumers and onboarding 50 lakh domestic PNG registrations.

The initiative builds on the second phase, which ran from January 1 to June 30, 2026 and added about 13.4 lakh billed connections, while generating more than 15.3 lakh domestic PNG registrations.

Hardeep Singh Puri

PNGRB data showed a sharp acceleration in adoption during phase 2. Average daily additions of domestic PNG connections rose 43% to 6,690 from 4,702, while those of billed consumers rose over 2.5 times to 7,392 from 2,781.

Sept. PV wholesales grew in double digits

Lalatendu Mishra
MUMBAI

Passenger vehicle (PV) wholesales continued to grow in double digits in September led by market leader Maruti Suzuki India on strong demand.

Maruti Suzuki India Ltd. (MSIL) sold 2,36,013 units in September, a 24.43% year-on-year (YoY) growth. Partho Banerjee, senior executive officer, marketing & sales, MSIL said, "The new plant is helping us to increase our supplies resulting in, increasing the number of wholesales."

Hyundai Motor India Ltd. wholesales stood at 77,916 units a 10.8% growth. Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles wholesales climbed 15% to 70,210 units. Mahindra & Mahindra's automotive division logged wholesales of 64,092 SUVs, a 14% increase.

EV milestone

"Adding to this, we are proud to have crossed the milestone of one lakh billing of our electric origin SUVs since launch," said Velusamy R., president, automotive business, Mahindra & Mahindra Ltd.

JSW MG Motor India reported 8,018 units in wholesales in September, registering 19% growth.

"The strong performance reflects sustained consumer interest in the firm's product portfolio, including the recently-launched MG Hector Tomahawk EV and PHEV," the company said.

कार्यालय अतिरिक्त मुख्य अभियन्ता सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग संभाग–प्रथम, उदयपुर
क्रमांक :–ACE/NIT/2026-27/D- 480 दिनांक : 25/09/2026

निविदा संख्या –12/ 2026-27

राजस्थान के राज्यपाल महोदय की ओर से सड़क/पुल निर्माण कार्य हेतु उपयुक्त श्रेणी में सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग राजस्थान में पंजीकृत संवेदकों एवं राज्य सरकार/केन्द्र सरकार के अधिकृत संगठनों/केन्द्रीय लोक निर्माण विभाग/डाक एवम् दूर संचार विभाग/रेल्वे इत्यादि में पंजीकृत संवेदकों, जो कि राजस्थान सरकार के ए, एए श्रेणी के संवेदकों के समकक्ष हो, से निर्धारित प्रपत्र में सड़क निर्माण कार्य के लिए ई– प्रोक्यूरमेन्ट प्रक्रिया से ऑन लाईन निविदायें आमंत्रित की जाती हैं।

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ऑनलाईन निविदा आवेदन डाउनलोड एवं अपलोड करने की तारीख	30.09.2026 प्रातः 9:30 बजे से 21.10.2026 सांय 6.00 बजे तक
ऑनलाईन निविदा खोलने की तारीख	23.10.2026 सांय 4.00 बजे से

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NIB Code:- PWD2627A2950 UBN:PWD2627WLOB13283, PWD2627WSOB13284

अतिरिक्त मुख्य अभियन्ता
सा.नि.वि. सम्भाग–प्रथम उदयपुर

DIPR/C/16644/2026

कार्यालय अधीक्षण अभियन्ता जन. स्वा. अभि. विभाग वृत पाली
E-mail: sephed123@yahoo.com, Ph. No.: 02932-222678
क्रमांकः अअ/वृत पाली/त.स./2026-27/2463-2484 दिनांकः 17/9/2026

CORRIGENDUM NO. 01 OF NIT NO. 05/2026-27

इस कार्यालय के पत्र क्रमांक 2336-2357 दिनांक 02.09.2026 द्वारा जारी निविदा संख्या 05/2026-27 (UBNNo. PHE2627WSOB4967, PHE2627WSOB4968, PHE2627WSOB4969, PHE2627WSOB4970, PHE2627WSOB4971, PHE2627WSOB4972,) के कार्य अपरिहार्य कारणों से निविदा में निम्नानुसार संशोधन किया जाता है।

पूर्व निर्धारित दिनांक		संशोधित दिनांक	
फार्म मिलने की दिनांक	04.09.2026 से 17.09.2026 सायं 6.00 बजे तक	फार्म मिलने की दिनांक	04.09.2026 से 05.10.2026 सायं 6.00 बजे तक
फार्म जमा कराने की दिनांक	17.09.2026 सायं 6.00 बजे तक	फार्म जमा कराने की दिनांक	05.10.2026 सायं 6.00 बजे तक
निविदा खोलने की दिनांक	18.09.2026 दोपहर 3.00 बजे तक	निविदा खोलने की दिनांक	06.10.2026 दोपहर 3.00 बजे तक

Remaining points/terms/conditions/specification of tender form will remain unchanged. The corrigendum can be seen and downloaded from website http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in and http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in

(मनीष माथुर)
अधीक्षण अभियन्ता
जन स्वा.अभि. विभाग, वृत पाली

DIPR/C/16841/2026

JAIPUR DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY
Indira Circle, Jawahar Lal Nehru Marg, Jaipur-302004
No. JDA/EE-(Elect.-IV)/Job No. 391/2023-24/D-1156 Date : 28-09-2026

NOTICE INVITING BID
NIB No.: 09/2026-27
UBN No.: JDA2627WSOB00353

Online Bids are invited up-to 06:00 PM of 21.10.2026 for **"Electrification of remaining Block (B-2 & B-3) and 33 KV Charging feeder for transport nagar Scheme, Sikar road, Zone-13, JDA, Jaipur".** The last date for Applying Bid and making online payment on JDA portal is up-to 6.00 PM of 21.10.2026. The estimated cost of NIB is Rs. 244.53 Lacs. Details may be seen in the Bidding Document at our office or the State Public Procurement Portal website www.sppp.rajasthan.gov.in, www.eproc.rajasthan.gov.in and www.jda.rajasthan.gov.in/jda

To participate in the bid, bidder must:

A. Participate in Tender & Deposit Payment on 'Online Tender Participation' Portal of JDA at https://jda.rajasthan.gov.in/jda or by Single-Sign-On at http://service.jaipurjda.org.

B. Submit e-Bid on e-Procurement portal of GOR at www.eproc.rajasthan.gov.in

Executive Engineer (Elect.-IV)

Raj.Samwad/C/26/11061

TRANSMISSION CORPORATION OF TELANGANA LIMITED
e-Procurement Tender Notice
The TGTRANSCO invites bids online for the following work: **Spec.No**.e-TGTLI-19/26-27, **Name of work**: Supply of Material/ Equipment including Transportation & Insurance, Delivery, Erection, Testing & Commissioning and Civil & Construction works on Turnkey basis in Narayanpet District under Makthal - Narayanpet - Kodangal Lift Irrigation Scheme - (Package-3) (i) 220/11kV LISS at Jayamma Cheruvu, Perapalla (V), Narayanpet (M). (ii) 220KV TMDC Line from existing 220/132kV Kosigi SS to proposed 220/132kV SS at Jayamma Cheruvu SS (27.298KM). (iii) 2Nos. 220kV Bays at 220/132kV SS Kosigi. (iv) 1No.132/11kV Transformer bay at existing 132/11kV Panchadevpahad SS. **Tender Availability on website from**: 01.10.2026. **Note**: Further details can be seen in website: http//tender.telangana.gov.in Fax No.040-23323565, Phone No.040-23396000 Extn.3552/3424/3687/3627.
Sd/-
CHIEF ENGINEER/LIS
DIPR R.O.No.600-PP/CL-AGENCY/ADVT/2026-27 Dt:01.10.2026

RAJASTHAN RAJYA VIDYUT PRASARAN NIGAM LIMITED
Notice Inviting Bid
Bid for Erection, testing and commissioning work of 132 KV 3 Phase S/C Transmission Line at Deedwana Traction Substation to Proposed 132 KV GSS Sanwasa line on Labour Contract Basis (Under Railway Deposit work) (Approx. 18Km) against Specification No. CONTRACT- I/2026-27/BN-9018002615 (UBN: VPN2627WSOB01536) are invited from interested bidders up to 05:00 PM on 22.10.2026.
Other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal **(http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in, http://sppp.raj.nic.in)** of the state; and **http://energy.rajasthan.gov.in/rvpnl** departmental website.
Superintending Engineer
(Contracts-I), Jaipur
Raj.Samwad/C/26/11076 R.R.V.P.N./TR-7823/2026

IndianOil
CIN-L23201MH1959GOI011388
NOTICE FOR HIRING OF CONTRACTOR FOR CGD PROJECT
Indian Oil Corporation Limited (A Maharatna Company under Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas) is seeking applications from competent contractors for various jobs related to Laying of PE Pipeline Network, Last Mile Connectivity (LMC) and Direct Marketing Agency (DMA) works for PNG connections in the geographical area of Coimbatore District of Tamil Nadu (Coimbatore GA)

Eligibility and Selection Method:

Walk-in method: Work orders will be issued on a first-come-first-serve basis, subject to fulfillment of requirements and at the sole discretion of IOCL.

Eligibility: Bidders worked in IOCL CGD or its JVs (having experience in PE / LMC works) / Any party having experience in CGD or Non-CGD related project experience.

Tenders to be submitted at any of the following:

1. IOCL Coimbatore CGD Office: Indian Oil Corporation Limited, City Gas Distribution Office, No. 965, 2nd floor, Harita Center, Lakshmi Mills, Avinashi Road, Coimbatore - 641037, Tamil Nadu

2. IOCL Chennai cluster Office: Indian Oil Corporation Limited, CGD Chennai Cluster, House of four frames, 6/13, Wheat Croft Road, Nungambakkam, Chennai - 600034

3. IOCL Delhi Office: Indian Oil Corporation Limited, Business Development (Corporate Office), 10th Floor, NBCC Commercial Complex, Block -2, East Kidwai Nagar (EKN), New Delhi – 110023.

4. Through email: pbdtenders@indianoil.in
Date: Starting Thursday, 01st October 2026
Time: 11:00 AM to 5:00 PM (Working days)
Cut-off date: 15th October 2026 or till requirement completion whichever is earlier

The Detailed Tender Document mentioning method of selection, selection criteria, Scope of work and other terms and conditions are available on IOCL website (https://iocl.com/suppliers-notices) and CPP Portal https://eprocure.gov.in/epublish/app.

IOCL reserves the right to discontinue the process at any point of time without assigning any reasons. Further, IOCL has the sole discretion to qualify or accept/reject the applications for award of job without assigning any reason whatsoever. Any corrigendum, amendments, or detailed terms & conditions shall be published only on the official IOCL website (https://iocl.com/suppliers-notices) and CPP Portal (https://eprocure.gov.in/epublish/app) and will not be published in newspapers.

Contact for any further Information:
Phone: 011-20815711/011-20817436/044-28243168/0422-2569291
Email: pbdtenders@indianoil.in

Indian Oil Corporation Limited, Business Development (Corporate Office), 10th Floor, NBCC Commercial Complex, Block -2, East Kidwai Nagar (EKN), New Delhi-110023

GENEVA

UN urges more U.S. action on Marshall Islands' nuclear legacy

AFP

The United States needs to take additional steps to remedy the nuclear legacy in the Marshall Islands by providing healthcare and releasing secret archives, according to a UN report presented to its human rights body on Thursday. The U.S. conducted 67 nuclear weapons tests in the Marshall Islands in 1954. REUTERS

MOSCOW

Russia's Putin says world is living through a dangerous moment

AP

Russian President Vladimir Putin said on Thursday the world was living through a dangerous moment and warned the West not to escalate a standoff over Ukraine by threatening the Russian exclave of Kaliningrad, which Moscow has made clear it would defend with nuclear weapons if necessary. REUTERS

LONDON

Dual U.K.-Iranian national arrested over airbase incident in England

REUTERS

The police on Thursday arrested a dual U.K.-Iranian national on suspicion of plotting a terror attack following a security incident at RAF Fairford airbase in England that British authorities have linked to Tehran. Five men, all British nationals in their 20s and from London, were arrested in the early hours of Sunday. AP

ADEN

Saudi-led coalition says Houthis attacked power station in Medina

AFP

The Saudi-led coalition fighting Yemen's Houthis said the militant group had attacked a power distribution station in Medina this week, putting one transformer out of service but without affecting the electricity network. It said the station supplies electricity to the Prophet's Mosque, one of Islam's holiest sites. REUTERS

Pakistan says it killed 22 militants in 'precise' strikes in Afghanistan

Information Ministry says forces carried out 'well-planned and calibrated aerial strikes' targeting Tehreek-e-Taliban Pakistan hideouts, destroying large quantities of weapons and ammunition; Taliban regime says the strikes killed 9 Afghan civilians

Press Trust of India
ISLAMABAD

Pakistan on Thursday said it killed at least 22 militants in air strikes in Afghanistan as part of a campaign to eliminate their hideouts across the border.

Afghanistan's Taliban regime, meanwhile, said that Pakistani strikes killed nine Afghan civilians, including women and children, and injured 11 others.

This comes amid a sharp escalation in already strained relations between Pakistan and Afghanistan, with the two sides trading allegations over militant sanctuaries, cross-border attacks, air strikes and border incursions.

Afghan men inspect the wreckage of a car at the site of an air strike in Helmand province in southwestern Afghanistan on Thursday. AP

Pakistan's Information Ministry, in a statement, said that the country's security forces conducted "well-planned and calibrated aerial strikes" against the hideouts and safe havens of the banned Tehreek-e-Taliban Pakistan (TTP), killing multiple militants.

It said that "selective targeting" of terrorist camps and hideouts at two locations in Afghanistan was carried out based on credible intelligence with "precision and accuracy".

"Targets were destroyed with precision and initial reports suggest killing of twenty-two terrorists," it said. The statement added that large quantities of weapons and ammunition stored at these hideouts were also destroyed.

The Ministry said Pakistan has always strived for the maintenance of peace and stability in the region. However, "the safety and security of our citizens remains our foremost priority".

Meanwhile, Taliban spokesperson Zabihullah Mujahid condemned the attack, calling it an act of "aggression and crime in violation of all accepted principles".

Separately, Pakistan's Army accused Kandahar's Governor, Mullah Shireen, of hosting senior figures from groups with different ideological objectives for talks on escalating attacks inside Pakistan.

Army spokesperson Lt. Gen. Ahmad Sharif said the meeting took place on August 26 in Kandahar.

Mr. Sharif said those represented included the outlawed Baloch Liberation Army (BLA), al-Qaeda in the Indian Subcontinent (AQIS), and the Hafiz Gul Bahadur group.

Iraq PM Zaidi sets deadline for Shia militias to disarm

Agence France-Presse
BAGHDAD

Iraqi Prime Minister Ali al-Zaidi on Thursday announced June 30 as a new deadline for armed factions to turn over their weapons to the state, following the end of the U.S.-led coalition's mission in the country.

"October 1 is considered a serious beginning to address the issue of weapons outside state control... according to a clear roadmap and agreed timelines extending no later than June 30, 2027," Mr. Zaidi said in a statement, having backed away from an original September 30 deadline.

The Iraqi government believes the withdrawal of coalition forces will deprive the armed factions, many of which are backed by Iran, of the excuse they have used to retain their arsenal.

Ali al-Zaidi

But many fear the pullout might boost the factions instead, and draw the country deeper into the West Asia war.

"Based on the constitutional principle, the decision of war and peace should be left to the constitutional authorities, banning all military action to the contrary," Mr. Zaidi said on Thursday.

Iran's Revolutionary Guards welcomed on Thursday the withdrawal of U.S. forces from Iraq as a "historic victory" and called for American troops to leave West Asia.

The Guards "congratulate the proud nation of Iraq, the united front of the Islamic Resistance, and the revolutionary fighters of the Islamic world on this historic victory," it said.

Mr. Zaidi had originally set September 30 as the deadline for factions to disarm, but later withdrew it as talks to "regulate" weapons continued.

While some factions have already handed over their weapons to the state, others have refused to disarm. Iraqi armed factions backed by Tehran said that they were "not bound by any timeline or agreement" to surrender their weapons to the state.

Russian drones strike Kyiv nuclear research facility grounds, bridge

Agence France-Presse
KYIV

A Russian drone hit the grounds of the Institute for Nuclear Research in Kyiv, causing a fire but leaving the facility's test reactor undamaged, Ukraine's nuclear safety watchdog said on Thursday.

The regulator did not say where the drone landed or provide imagery of the attack, which happened on Wednesday.

The strike comes as Russia escalates its campaign of air strikes on Kyiv, putting the capital on a near-constant state of alert.

Separately, Russian drones hit the Southern Bridge – a transport artery connecting the east and west of Kyiv over the Dnipro river – for the first time since the start of the conflict with Ukraine.

Sergiy Beskrestnov, an adviser to President Volodymyr Zelenskyy, said Russia was now using drones designed to cut electricity pylons and steel bridge structures.

World undergoing profound structural changes: Japan Foreign Minister Motegi

Kallol Bhattacherjee
TOKYO

Shifting 'balance of power' and worsening conflicts are driving "profound structural changes" in the world today, said Japanese Foreign Minister Toshimitsu Motegi here on Thursday. In a video message that was delivered at the beginning of a foreign policy think tank event in Tokyo, Mr. Motegi warned about the worldwide impact of generative AI and said under these circumstances, responding to disinformation and misinformation have become an "urgent challenge" for the international community.

"The world is currently undergoing profound structural changes driven by shifts in the balance of power and the intensification of conflicts. The widespread use of social media and generative AI has enabled enormous amounts of information to spread across borders," said Mr. Motegi in the inaugural speech at the International Journalists' Conference, organised on the occasion of the 50th anniversary of the Foreign Press Center Japan (FPCJ).

Toshimitsu Motegi

Mr. Motegi highlighted the importance of 'free, responsible and trustworthy journalism' that he described as the 'cornerstone of dialogue and trust in the international community".

"Under these circumstances, responding to disinformation and misinformation has become an urgent challenge for the international community," Mr. Motegi said.

Speaking on the occasion, Kazuo Kodama, president of FPCJ and former ambassador of Japan to the EU, emphasised the need to resolve geopolitical conflicts and safeguard democratic practices worldwide.

[The correspondent is visiting Japan as a guest of the Foreign Press Center Japan.]

Hegseth says U.S. cut number of Generals and Admirals by 20%

Agence France-Presse
WASHINGTON

Secretary of War Pete Hegseth announced on Wednesday that the United States has slashed the number of its Generals and Admirals by 20%, in a move he said is aimed at "accountability".

Mr. Hegseth suggested the cuts targeted officers who failed to get on board with his efforts to ensure the military is focused on war-fighting rather than the "woke" policies of previous administrations, describing the reductions as an "accomplishment".

"The number-crunchers say we fired 10% of the Generals and Admirals across the force," Mr. Hegseth told troops at the Quantico military base, saying: "We've also reduced the overall number of general officer slots by an additional 10%."

"So yes, 20% reduction across the board," he said. "The media calls that a purge. I call it accountability, and long overdue."

Sport

Pacers hold sway as 12 wickets fall on the opening day

IRANI CUP

Vivek Krishnan
SRINAGAR

The overhead conditions here on Thursday were pristine. It meant that the Sher-i-Kashmir Stadium was bathed in sunshine for most of the opening day of the Irani Cup fixture between Jammu & Kashmir and Rest of India. But the surface beneath, imperative as it is to how the action unfolds, had a healthy covering of grass.

It put the onus on the pace bowlers to seize the day. J&K's attack, despite the absence of Auqib Nabi due to his involvement in India's ODI series against the West Indies, didn't disappoint.

With Sunil Kumar and Lone Nasir making three inroads each, the host bowled out the Rishabh Pant-led outfit for 237. It could have been a day of utter dominance for Paras Dogra & Co., but RoI's pacers, namely Mukesh Choudhary and Akash Deep, nabbed a wicket apiece as the shadows lengthened in the final hour. J&K was 21 for two at stumps.

Even as wickets tumbled, youngsters Shikhar Mohan and R. Smaran impressed with the willow for the visitors. While Shikhar scored 60 as opener, Smaran racked up an 83-ball 68 at No. 6.

The pick of the J&K bowlers was Sunil. The 29-year-old left-arm pacer from Jammu, who complemented Nabi last season with 31 scalps, got the ball to deviate through the day.

Shikhar was beaten on multiple occasions, but the southpaw from Ranchi dug in. His driving through the covers was elegant as he took RoI to 106 for two at lunch.

Throwing it away

All the hard work came undone after the break, however, when he edged a wide half-volley by Nasir. It triggered a dramatic collapse as RoI lost five wickets for 49 runs in 22.2 overs between lunch and tea.

Pant appeared unsettled and drov

e uppishly to cover point. But much to RoI's relief, Smaran's enterprising alliances with the tail - he put together 39 with Akash and 43 with Choudhary - ensured it wasn't just one-way traffic.

The scores: Rest of India — 1st innings: Shikhar Mohan c Wadhawan b Nasir 60, Sanat Sangwan c Wadhawan b Sunil 1, Sudip Gharami c Samad b Nasir 8, Sarfaraz Khan c Wadhawan b Umar 45, Rishabh Pant c Qamran b Umar 10, R. Smaran c Samad b Nasir 68, Saransh Jain b Lotra 5, Manav Suthar lbw b Sunil 2, Akash Deep c Samad b Mushtaq 22, Mukesh Choudhary b Sunil 2, Mukesh Kumar (not out) 0; Extras (b-1, w-1, nb-12): 14; Total (in 68.1 overs): 237.
Fall of wickets: 1-8, 2-32, 3-108, 4-133, 5-137, 6-150, 7-155, 8-194, 9-237.
J&K bowling: Umar 18-6-65-2, Sunil 20.1-9-36-3, Nasir 13-0-59-3, Mushtaq 6-0-26-1, Lotra 11-0-50-1
Jammu & Kashmir —1st innings: Qamran Iqbal (batting) 12, Shubham Pundir c Pant b Choudhary 1, Umar Nazir c Pant b Akash 4, Shubham Khajuria (batting) 0; Extras (b-4): 4; Total (for two wkts. in seven overs): 21.
Fall of wickets: 1-16, 2-21.
Rest of India bowling: Mukesh 2-0-5-0, Choudhary 3-1-3-1, Akash 2-0-9-1.
Toss: J&K.

Bending his back: Nasir claimed three wickets for the home team.
IMRAN NISSAR

Australia-A on top as host batters falter

AUS-A IN INDIA

Abhishek Saini
PUDUCHERRY

Australia-A asserted control on the third day of the second 'Test' at the Siechem Cricket Stadium here on Thursday, leaving India-A with a predicament ahead of the final day.

At 28 for one at stumps, still 337 away from the target and with the looming threat from Todd Murphy and Corey Rocchiccioli, India-A has little choice except going after the target.

But attacking comes with its perils, as B. Sai Sudharsan found out, chopping on against Murphy on a short, wide delivery. The visitor had tightened the noose in the morning session by bowling out India-A for 167, taking a massive 191-run first-innings lead.

Liam Hatcher generated reverse-swing to send a length delivery tailing in into his off-stump. Tanush Kotian also had his off-stump disturbed, but by Rocchiccioli, who got one to turn square and run through his bat-pad. India-A lost its final five wickets for just 10 runs.

The pitch looked nowhere close to a minefield as Josh Philippe (26, 41b, 3x4) and Sam Konstas (40, 72b, 1x4) put on 50 runs for the opening wicket.

The scores:
Australia-A 358 & 173/4 decl. in 49 overs (Sam Konstas 40, Jason Sangha 44 n.o.) vs. India-A 167 in 68 overs (Shaik Rasheed 42) & 28/1 in 13 overs.

DREAM FINAL

India thrashes Sri Lanka, sets up gold-medal match with Pakistan

PTI

Defending champion India hammered Sri Lanka by 124 runs in the Asian Games men's semifinal in Nisshin on Thursday to set up a gold-medal clash with Pakistan. **The scores:** India 169/7 in 20 overs (Sooryavanshi 38, Kishan 80 n.o., Ratnayake 2/32, Arachchige 2/28) bt Sri Lanka 45 in 9.5 overs (Bumrah 2/7, Axar 2/8, Abhishek 2/2).

FALLING SHORT

Indian squash teams end up with bronze after semifinal defeats

X@INDIASQUASH

Defending champion India lost 1-2 to Malaysia in the Asian Games men's semifinals, the lone win coming from Veer Chotrani, *in pic.* The women met the same fate against Hong Kong despite Tanvi Khanna's stirring comeback. The defeats ended the country's squash campaign in the team event with two bronze medals.

UNBEATEN SO FAR

India makes quadrant semifinals, assured of sepaktakraw medal

X@MEDIA_SAI

India was assured of a sepaktakraw medal in the men's quadrant competition in Nagoya on Thursday after it entered the Asian Games semifinals with a 2-1 win over Myanmar, keeping an unbeaten run intact to top Group A. India had earlier defeated Laos and Vietnam in its first two matches.

BLISTERING SHOW

Second-placed Pranavi's 63 puts India in twin medal hunt

X@LETGOLF

Pranavi Urs fired a blistering seven-under 63 in the second round that catapulted her into sole second place (11-under 129), two shots behind leader Shannon Tan of Singapore, in the women's golf competition at the Asian Games in Nagoya. The women's team is now in the bronze-medal position at seven-under 273.

India holds off Pakistan in a thriller, enters final

The defending champion lets slip a three-goal lead before Abhishek's last-minute strike saves the day for the team; Malaysia ousts South Korea to reach the gold-medal contest

ASIAN GAMES

Uthra Ganesan
GIFU

Man of the moment: Abhishek is the toast of his teammates after his winner. R.V. MOORTHY

Relieved. The predominant feeling in the Indian camp after sneaking past Pakistan 4-3 in the men's hockey semifinal of the Asian Games here on Thursday. A game of two halves and seemingly two different Indian teams turning up for each half.

With the scores tied 3-3 and 49 seconds to go, a shoot-out looming large in the first semifinal at the Gifu Prefectural Green Stadium, Abhishek's feeble push took a deflection off Sufyan's stick and the Pakistan team watched the ball roll past the goal line, crushing their dreams of advancing to the title clash yet again.

For the first 30 minutes, India played like the higher-ranked defending champion it is, despite a distinct lack of fluidity. The fifth saw Harmanpreet Singh slot the ball into the middle of the net and take the lead. By the 23rd minute it was 3-0, despite a goal being disallowed for coming off the back of Dilpreet's stick.

Pakistan, which had pulled one back 35 seconds from half-time through its sixth PC and skipper Abu Mahmood, came out pumped up and took charge. Two goals in four minutes exposed the Indian fragility. Hannan Shahid tapped in in the 45th minute and Rana Waheed Ashraf restored parity, capitalising on a defensive lapse.

A fifth Asian title and a spot in the LA Olympics will be on the line when India takes on Malaysia in the first-ever Asian Games final between the two sides after the latter got past Korea 2-1 in the other semifinal.

The results (semifinals): India 4 (Harmanpreet Singh 5-pc, 13-pc, Sukhjeet Singh 23-pc, Abhishek 60) bt Pakistan 3 (Abu Mahmood 30-pc, Hannan Shahid 45, Rana Waheed Ashraf 49); Malaysia 2 (Abu Kamal Azrai 40-pc, 45-ps) bt Korea 1 (Gangsan Lee 42).

Indian women look to end Chinese reign

Uthra Ganesan
GIFU

Salima, right, will be hoping to lead from the front. AHF

The last time India and China played each other in the Asian Games in 2023, the latter won 4-0, its biggest win on this stage. On Friday, when the two teams face off again in the final here, India will have a chance to not only avenge the defeat but also prove that the gap between the two sides is well and truly closing.

The last time India beat China in a major competition was at the 2024 Asian Champions Trophy back home. That was a largely inexperienced Chinese side, in transition after the high of Paris Olympics silver. Since then, however, the two have faced off five times, China winning four of those and the last being a 2-2 draw in the recent World Cup.

While ranking and recent history make China favourite to retain the title, India's performances in the past six months, including the World Cup, make the result less than obvious. The Indian attack has been finding ways to score even when the penalty corners haven't worked. Sunelita Toppo, Lalremsiami and Sakshi Rana have worked hard with constant support from Navneet Kaur and captain Salima Tete. Goalkeeper Bichu Devi has grown out of Savita Punia's shadows, the two together have been bulwarks of Indian defence.

A win will help the team clinch the Asian Games gold for only the second time since 1982.

Match starts at 3.30 p.m. IST.

Medals table

	Country	G	S	B	T
1	China	154	71	63	288
2	Japan	59	79	79	217
3	South Korea	30	30	53	113
4	Uzbekistan	16	21	19	56
5	Iran	12	17	13	42
8	**India**	**10**	**23**	**32**	**65**

2027 ICC ODI World Cup schedule

SUPER SERIES

DATE	TEAMS	VENUE
Oct. 2	QF1 vs. QF3	Windhoek
Oct. 4	QF1 vs. QF2	Windhoek
Oct. 6	QF2 vs. QF3	Windhoek

The top two (Qualifier A and B) will make it to the group stage

GROUP GAMES		
Oct. 7	**India vs. Australia**	**Cape Town**
Oct. 8	Pakistan vs. Afghanistan	Tshwane
Oct. 8	England vs. Bangladesh	Windhoek
Oct. 9	Zimbabwe vs. Qualifier A	Bulawayo
Oct. 9	South Africa vs. New Zealand	Cape Town
Oct. 10	**India vs. Pakistan**	**Johannesburg**
Oct. 10	Sri Lanka vs. Qualifier B	Windhoek
Oct. 11	Zimbabwe vs. Afghanistan	Bulawayo
Oct. 12	Australia vs. Qualifier A	Paarl
Oct. 12	New Zealand vs. Bangladesh	KuGompo City
Oct. 13	England vs. Sri Lanka	Windhoek
Oct. 13	South Africa vs. Qualifier B	Paarl
Oct. 14	**India vs. Afghanistan**	**Tshwane**
Oct. 15	Pakistan vs. Qualifier A	Bloemfontein
Oct. 15	Zimbabwe vs. Australia	Harare
Oct. 16	Sri Lanka vs. Bangladesh	Durban
Oct. 16	South Africa vs. England	Gqeberha
Oct. 17	**India vs. Qualifier A**	**Bloemfontein**
Oct. 17	New Zealand vs. Qualifier B	Harare
Oct. 18	Australia vs. Afghanistan	KuGompo City
Oct. 19	Zimbabwe vs. Pakistan	Harare
Oct. 19	South Africa vs. Bangladesh	Durban
Oct. 20	New Zealand vs. Sri Lanka	Johannesburg
Oct. 20	England vs. Qualifier B	Harare
Oct. 21	Afghanistan vs. Qualifier A	KuGompo City
Oct. 22	Australia vs. Pakistan	Paarl
Oct. 22	South Africa vs. Sri Lanka	Johannesburg
Oct. 23	England vs. New Zealand	Gqeberha
Oct. 23	Bangladesh vs. Qualifier B	Tshwane
Oct. 24	**Zimbabwe vs. India**	**Victoria Falls**
SUPER SEVEN		
Oct. 25	A2 vs. B3	Johannesburg
Oct. 26	B1 vs. A3	Gqeberha
Oct. 27	B2 vs. AB4*	Tshwane
Oct. 28	**A1 vs. A2**	**Victoria Falls**
Oct. 29	B1 vs. B3	KuGompo City
Oct. 30	A3 vs AB4	Victoria Falls
Oct. 31	**B2 vs. A1**	**Johannesburg**
Nov. 1	A2 vs. B1	Victoria Falls
Nov. 2	B3 vs. AB4	Cape Town
Nov. 3	B2 vs. A3	Durban
Nov. 4	**A1 vs. B1**	**Paarl**
Nov. 5	A2 vs. AB4	Durban
Nov. 6	B2 vs. B3	Bloemfontein
Nov. 7	**A1 vs. A3**	**Cape Town**
Nov. 8	B1 vs. AB4	Durban
Nov. 9	B2 vs. A2	Gqeberha
Nov. 10	A3 vs. B3	Bloemfontein
Nov. 11	**A1 vs. AB4**	**Gqeberha**
Nov. 12	B2 vs. B1	Cape Town
Nov. 13	A2 vs. A3	Bloemfontein
Nov. 14	**A1 vs. B3**	**Durban**

* AB4 - Best fourth-placed side in Group A or B

THE LAST FOUR		
Nov. 17	Semifinal 1	Cape Town
Nov. 18	Semifinal 2	Tshwane
THE SUMMIT CLASH		
Nov. 21	Final	Johannesburg

Nitesh wins silver in 97kg Greco-Roman wrestling

Uthra Ganesan
NAGOYA

History-maker: Nitesh with coach Hargobind Singh after his remarkable display. PTI

Nitesh Siwach went down fighting in the final of the 97kg Greco-Roman wrestling but the 23-year-old had made history much before he stepped on the mat in the title clash. He became the sixth Indian Greco-Roman wrestler to reach the final of the Asian Games and the first in 64 years, the edition when the discipline was first introduced.

Nitesh began in style, winning 7-1 against Turkmenistan's Amanberdi Agamammedov in the quarterfinals. All his points were scored in the first three-minute period.

The semifinal was even more lopsided, Nitesh bulldozing his way past Mongolian Gankhuyag Ganbaatar 9-0.

Two massive four-point moves and then one for pushing his opponent off the mat were enough for the two-time Asian Championships medallist to storm into the final against local favourite Yuri Nakazato, last year's silver medallist at the Asians.

It was a close bout, Nakazato earning two single points in the first period for a narrow lead. Nitesh tried to counter in the second but ended up conceding two more to lose 0-4.

"I still can't believe it. My father told me there was no looking back once I started this journey and today I did it for him. There was a lot of pressure but I trusted my training and gave everything I had to make the country proud," Nitesh said after the bout.

In 77kg, Aman had to fight hard to win 8-6 against Borgil Tuvshinbaatar of Mongolia, courtesy a two-pointer in the last few seconds after trailing for long periods.

However, he went down tamely in the quarterfinals to Qatar's Shahin Badaghimofrad 0-9.

On the women's side, Mansi first went down 0-6 to Japan's two time World champion Nonoka Ozaki in the 62kg semis before losing 2-5 to Mongolia's Altjin Togtokh in the bronze medal match.

Ganesh earns bronze in compound archery

Press Trust of India
NAGOYA

Indian compound archer Ganesh Mani Ratnam Thirumuru defeated Vietnam's Cong Duc Dang 149-144 in the men's bronze-medal playoff after a 144-148 semifinal loss to Kim Jongho of South Korea. Ganesh had defeated Taiwan's Chieh-Lun Chen 148-138 in the quarters. Among women, Chikitha Tiniparthi lost 143-144 to Indonesia's Nurisa Dian Ashrifah in the last-eight stage.

Ganesh. REUTERS

Going strong: Noble and Francis in action. REUTERS

Francis-Noble clinch silver in men's skiff

Press Trust of India
GAMAGORI CITY

The Indian pair of Manu Francis and Prince Kurisinkal Noble bagged the silver medal in the men's skiff opening race 9 of the Asian Games sailing competition here on Thursday.

The 31-year-old Francis and the 30-year-old Noble, who hail from Ernakulam and are first cousins, combined for a total of 23 points after nine races and finished behind China's Wen Zaiding and Liu Tian, who totalled 16 in the competition where the lowest total wins the regatta.

Points in men's skiff sailing are decided by the finish position in each race and a first place brings in one point to the total. The Indians managed to win race three and finish second in race one, five and nine. China emerged on top in four races to end up as the best-placed side.

In the women's competition, Harshita Tomar and Shital Verma ended fourth and last after logging 26 points. Japan took gold with 11. The Indian combination could not win any of the nine races but managed to finish second in race three and four.

INDIANS IN ACTION

A look at some Indian players/teams who will compete on Friday (all times IST):

Archery: Recurve: Women's team semifinal: vs. China (5.55 a.m.); Medal matches (6.25 a.m. onwards).

Mixed team semifinal: vs. Japan (8.20 a.m.); Medal matches (8.50 a.m. onwards); Men's team semifinal: vs. Iran (10.55 a.m.); Medal matches (11.25 a.m. onwards).

Boxing: Finals: Women: 75kg: Lovlina vs. Ziyi (Chn), 10 a.m.; 65kg: Parveen vs. Nien-chin (Tpe), 2.15 p.m.; Men: 80kg: Ankush vs. Minseong (Kor), 2.45 p.m.

Hockey: Women (final): vs. China, 3.30 p.m.

Volleyball: Men (classification match 5th-8th): vs. South Korea, 6.30 a.m.

Wrestling: 1/8 finals: Women's 50kg: Dipanshi vs. Susaki (Jpn), 7.05 a.m.; Men's freestyle 125kg: Rajat vs. Kassimbek (Kaz), 7.25 a.m.; Women: 76kg: Priya vs. Kyzy (Kgz), 7.30 a.m.; Men's freestyle 65kg: Sujeet vs. Zazai (Afg), 8 a.m.

THE INDIA SHOW

A look at some Indian performances on Thursday:

Archery: Compound: Men's individual bronze medal match: Ganesh bt Dang (Vie); Women's individual quarterfinal: Chikitha lost to Ashrifah (Ina).

Cricket: Men (semifinal): bt Sri Lanka by 124 runs.

Golf: Individual (round 2): Men: Saptak (T7), Veer (T16), Yuvraj (T22); Team: Fifth; Women: Pranavi (second), Diksha (T21), Aditi (T25); Team: Third.

Hockey: Men (semifinal): bt Pakistan 4-3.

Sailing: Men's skiff: Manu & Prince (silver).

Sepaktakraw: Men's quadrant (Group A): bt Vietnam 2-0, bt Myanmar 2-1.

Shooting: 25m rapid fire pistol men individual final: Anish (seventh).

Squash: Semifinals: Women's team: lost to Hong Kong 1-2, bagged bronze; Men's team: lost to Malaysia 1-2, clinched bronze.

Tennis: Men (quarterfinal): Nagal lost to Yibing (Chn) 4-6, 4-6.

Volleyball: Men (quarterfinal): lost to Pakistan 0-3.

Wrestling: Men's Greco-Roman: 97kg (final): Nitesh lost to Nakazato (Jpn).

77kg (1/4 final): Aman lost to Badaghimofrad (Qat).

60kg (1/4 final): Sumit lost to Abbaspourragani (Iri).

Women's 62kg bronze medal match: Mansi lost to Togtokh (Mgl).

Captain Gill combines beauty with responsibility in pursuit of greatness

The Indian opener appears to relish the challenge of being the set batter who carries the innings through as he demonstrated in the second ODI

WI IN INDIA

S. Prasanna Venkatesan
GUWAHATI

Treat to watch: Gill was elegance personified en route his second ODI double ton. RITU RAJ KONWAR

The finest batters possess a quality which cannot quite be reduced to technique. Technique may explain the straightness of the drive, the stillness of the head, and the balance at the moment of impact. It does not explain why the whole thing should seem beautiful.

Shubman Gill has that beauty. Yet beauty, by itself, is not enough. Sport is not choreography. The beauty matters because something is at stake. On Wednesday, it was 406.

There is a particular responsibility in a big chase. Someone has to stay long enough for the number to become ordinary. Gill understands that responsibility and seems to want it. Like Virat Kohli, he appears to relish the challenge of being the set batter who carries the innings through.

Last year in England, after India lost the first Test at Leeds despite his first-innings 147, Gill responded in the next Test by batting 549 balls for 430 across the match.

Here, with the series up for grabs, he assumed that responsibility again. He turned the chase of 406 into an exhibition of how compact and expansive can coexist, how violence may be contained within grace.

His wrists worked with extraordinary delicacy. He cut late, flicked behind square, and punched through cover. He drove full-faced and straight.

Short-arm jab

When Alzarri Joseph sent down a short ball at serious pace, Gill answered with his compact short-arm jab. He used his feet repeatedly, stepping out to Roston Chase and Keemo Paul, getting to the pitch of the ball and sending it over square-leg and cow corner.

Gill had no grand strategy, just a succession of modest propositions: 75-80 in the PowerPlay, no wickets; 200-210 by 25 overs; survive the new ball; exploit the older ball; remember the short side. India made 92 without loss in the first 10 overs and then exceeded Gill's next checkpoint, too.

He had already spent 50 overs in the field when he began. He then batted through all 43.3 overs of the chase. There was skill, certainly, but also discipline, appetite, and fitness. The innings had the rare quality of seeming effortless while demanding everything.

The numbers were spectacular: unbeaten 223 from 133 balls, his second ODI double century and India's highest successful chase. But numbers can flatten the texture of an innings.

They cannot quite describe the impression of a batter who seems to have discovered that the shortest distance between himself and greatness is simply to keep batting.

Brazil football team arrives in Kolkata

Gearing up: The Indian football team trains ahead of Saturday's friendly against Brazil. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Amitabha Das Sharma
KOLKATA

Members of the Brazil football team touched down at the Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose International Airport here on Thursday in a chartered flight for the friendly against India.

For a city that shares a deep-rooted love for football, the arrival of one of world football's giants was a moment to cherish. Millions of football aficionados in Bengal finally got the chance to welcome their favourite international side.

The arrival also set the stage for the FIFA international friendly, where the Indian men's national team will take on the might of the Selecao, at the Salt Lake Stadium on Saturday. The creativity, flair and skill of Brazil's 'Jogo Bonito' have long made the Selecao an enduring icon among football-lovers in Bengal and across India. Their presence in Kolkata adds a special emotional dimension to the eagerly-awaited fixture.

The biggest attraction among the visitors is Vinicius Junior. The Real Madrid forward has emerged as one of the leading stars of the modern game, renowned for his pace and dribbling ability.

Vinicius Junior missed his previous chance to visit India when he was ruled out of the 2017 FIFA U-17 World Cup, hosted by India. Flamengo held him back after their Copa do Brasil final defeat, despite the then 17-year-old having already secured a €45 million move to Real Madrid.

It is a full-circle moment for Vinicius, who has finally landed in India and finds himself to be the biggest attraction as Carlo Ancelotti's Brazil prepares to face the Blue Tigers. With Raphinha withdrawing due to injury, the Vinicius factor is only expected to heighten the excitement and galvanise support in Kolkata.

Rathi helps Tamil Nadu bundle RoI out for 179

U-23 CRICKET

Sports Bureau
CHENNAI

Rathi. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Left-arm spinner Sachin Rathi's guile was too hot to handle for the Rest of India u-23 batters as Tamil Nadu u-23 bundled out the visiting team for 179 on the first day at the M.A. Chidambaram Stadium on Thursday.

By stumps, TN had knocked off 45 of those runs, with S.R. Athish pouncing whenever presented with an opportunity in the last hour.

The foundation for the home side's dominance was laid by Rathi, whose prized scalp was Angkrish Raghuvanshi.

The opening batter gave a glimpse of his talent after a cautious start, but he was undone by the tweaker as he danced down the track. Moments after raising his half-century with a boundary over deep midwicket in the 26th over, Raghuvanshi was caught short of his crease after the ball turned away from the right-hander.

Barring a 74-run third-wicket partnership between Raghuvanshi and captain Priyanshu Moliya, RoI hardly posed a threat. Rathi, who kept it tight throughout, cleaned up the middle-order and tail.

"I tried to bowl in the right channels. The pitch was good for batting, so I feel my first spell changed the complexion of the game," said the spinner.

The scores: Rest of India u-23 179 in 71.5 overs (Angkrish Raghuvanshi 51, Priyanshu Moliya 40, Varun Bhuie 41, Sachin Rathi 6/27) vs. Tamil Nadu u-23 45/0 in 11 overs.

ICC nod to use pink ball in day-time Tests on trial basis

Press Trust of India
DUBAI

A Dukes pink ball. FILE PHOTO

The International Cricket Council (ICC) has approved the usage of pink balls in day-time Tests on a trial basis to reduce the effect of fading light in the final session of the day, which often results in the loss of overs.

The new playing conditions will apply to all international series that start from this month.

The ICC said the decision to use pink balls should be mutually made ahead of a Test, and it remains binding for the whole contest.

A series of steps have been adopted to help the sport keep pace with the modern times.

One of those is that now the play will not automatically come to an end at the fall of a wicket in the last over of the day.

New limits have now been introduced, establishing three distinct size and weight specifications for men's, women's and junior cricket.

According to the new playing conditions, batters wasting time will be warned for the first and second instances, while five runs will be awarded to the fielding side if he/she repeats the offence for a third time.

The regulation has also been clarified to remove ambiguity over what constitutes an overthrow.

From now on, an overthrow is an attempt to direct the ball towards the stumps to prevent runs or effect a run-out.

A misfield, whether an attempt to stop the ball or pass it to another fielder, will not be considered as an overthrow.

Have no issues in my body, feeling good again: Raghuvanshi

S. Shrivathsan
CHENNAI

Raghuvanshi. FILE PHOTO: EMMANUAL YOGINI

Angkrish Raghuvanshi is back where he belongs. He is doing what he loves the most - playing cricket. The 22-year-old was deprived of that blissful feeling after being sidelined for three months with a finger injury, sustained while on Kolkata Knight Riders duty in the IPL.

But Raghuvanshi is on a comeback trail and the runs are starting to flow from his willow. After hitting three half-centuries for Mumbai in the Thimmappaiah Memorial tournament in Karnataka, he struck 51 for Rest of India u-23 on the opening day of the encounter against Tamil Nadu u-23 at the M.A. Chidambaram Stadium on Thursday.

"It was a pretty bad injury, and it took me months to return to cricket. But as a cricketer, you just want to be on the field and play. This is what I want to do. I always want to be on the ground rather than on a hospital bed," said Raghuvanshi.

"[During my recovery], I had the hunger to get back on the field. Every day I was thinking about how I could get better. The months did not fly... I was like: 'I should be on the pitch'. I am grateful to be playing cricket again. I have no issues in my body, and I am feeling really good about my batting. I am excited for the season, but I am not looking too far ahead," he added.

Pillar of strength

An interaction with Raghuvanshi may be incomplete without the mention of Abhishek Nayar, his long-time mentor and head coach at KKR in IPL 2026. "He is everything to me. I have learnt a lot about life and cricket from him. Anytime I have a problem, I go to him. He is a pillar [of support] in my life. I speak to him almost every day".

SNAPSHOTS

Australia prevents a S. Africa clean sweep

POTCHEFSTROOM: Australia avoided a 3-0 clean sweep against South Africa after winning the rain-affected third and final ODI by 45 runs via DLS method on Wednesday.

The scores: Australia 322/9 in 50 overs (Mitchell Marsh 56, Oliver Peake 48, Alex Carey 74, Corbin Bosch 4/60) bt South Africa 145/4 in 28 overs (Ryan Rickelton 71 n.o.). Austraia won by 45 runs on DLS method; **Toss:** SA**: PoM:** Carey; **PoS:** Keshav Maharaj.

Prasidh out of third ODI

GUWAHATI: Indian pacer Prasidh Krishna has been ruled out of the third and final ODI against the West Indies after sustaining a niggle during the second match in Guwahati on Wednesday. The final ODI will be played at New Chandigarh on Saturday. Meanwhile, Washington Sundar has been withdrawn from India's squad for the T20I series against the West Indies starting on October 6. Naman Dhir has been named as his replacement. The decision was taken in view of the upcoming Test series against New Zealand. With the Ranji Trophy season commencing on October 11, Washington will get an opportunity to play red-ball cricket for Tamil Nadu and prepare for the Test series.

Niki, Vaishnavi spin India-A to big win in one-off 'Test'

MOHALI: Spinners Niki Prasad and Vaishnavi Sharma helped India-A hammer Australia-A by 281 runs in the one-off 'Test' at Mohali on Thursday. Chasing a mammoth 446, the visiting side was bundled out for 164 on the third day. Niki claimed five for 50 while Vaishnavi scalped three for 58.

The scores: India-A 364 & 257 in 64.2 overs (Priya Puniya 59, Yastika Bhatia 46, Anushka Sharma 46, Lilly Mills 5/88, Frankie Nicklin 4/67) bt Australia-A 176 & 164 in 76 overs (Tess Flintoff 58, Vaishnavi Sharma 3/58, Niki Prasad 5/50). **PoM:** Niki.

Jagadesh triumphs

CHENNAI: B. Jagadesh from Tamil Nadu Postal Sports Board (TNPSB) defeated Prem Prakash (AACSA) 4-3 in the final to bag the men's billiards title for the fifth time in the Tamil Nadu State-ranking tournament.

The result: B. Jagadesh bt Prem Prakash 4-3 [150(51)-126, 150(53)-41, 152(55)-78, 119-150(87), 39-150(61), 70-150(63), 150(65)-65].

Nation's pride: Asian Games medallists from TN — Vithya Ramraj, T.K. Vishal, G. Kamalini, Baranica Elangovan and Abinaya Rajarajan — receive a rousing reception organised by the TNAA and SDAT in Chennai on Thursday. UMESH KUMAR V.

Jagadesh, winner of the State-ranking billiards event.

LIVE TELECAST

Irani Cup: day 2, JioHotstar, 9.30 a.m.

India-A vs Australia-A: Second 'Test' day 4, JioHotstar, 9.30 a.m.

Cricket: Asian Games (Men), Sony Sports Ten 1 & LIV, 5.30 a.m. (Saturday)

Asian Games: Sony Sports Ten 2, 5 & LIV, 5.30 a.m. (Saturday)

ENGAGEMENTS

Cricket: DCAC league, I div., Adambakkam vs. Spring Field (SMK Fomra-A); Vijay vs. SKM (SMK Fomra-B), 9.30 a.m.; II div. A zone: Mani Memorial vs. Chromepet (8 a.m.); B: Prahalad vs. Phoniex (1 p.m.), GE T&D, Pallavaram.

Chennai Open to be moved to Manila next year

Sports Bureau
CHENNAI

The WTA 250 Chennai Open, the country's only top-tier tennis tournament, will be held from November 2 to 8 at the SDAT Stadium in Nungambakkam. However, next year, in the same slot, it will be replaced with a first-ever tour-level event in the Philippines as various stakeholders look to capitalise on the rapidly growing fanbase of the 21-year-old Alexandra Eala, currently ranked 18th in the world.

Along with the return of a WTA 125 event, held for the first time in the Philippines in January this season, a WTA 250 tournament will make its debut in Manila in late 2027 and is scheduled from November 1 to 7.

Chennai played host to a WTA 250 tournament for the first time in 2022. The event was held last year in the city for the second time after being relocated from Mexico.

"That (Eala's rise) is a factor. To have a WTA footprint in the Philippines, that's definitely an important contributing factor," Alastair Garland, managing director of the tennis division of Octagon, the sports agency that holds the license for the event, told *The Hindu*.

New car regulations favouring aggressive drivers, says Albon

S. Dipak Ragav
CHENNAI

Albon. AP

Atlassian Williams driver Alexander Albon feels the new car regulations suit drivers with a more aggressive driving style.

Speaking ahead of the Bahrain GP, to be held in Sepang, Malaysia, this weekend, Albon reckoned it is one reason championship leader Andrea Kimi Antonelli has excelled so far, despite it being just his second year in the sport.

"The cars themselves are a lot smaller. Basically, I think a lot of the drivers push entries, so if you think famously, someone like Lewis (Hamilton) and I think Kimi does a very similar thing. They are being rewarded because the rear tyres are not as strong this year as they were in previous years, relative to the front tyres," explained Albon.

The other main challenge has been battery deployment, and Albon revealed it has taken time for him to adapt.

"A lot of the deployment is down to the drivers, the way the driver downshifts and upshifts, also the way the driver brakes. The biggest factor is how the driver uses the throttle. At first, when it was changed, it was very difficult to understand. It was very against my personal driving style. And so, over time – we are in October now – I have only just started to feel natural driving a car, which is a lot longer than it takes," added the Thai-British driver.

Williams, which finished fifth in 2025, has struggled so far, sitting ninth in the standings, and Albon said the team is focused on next year.

"All the simulator work that we're doing behind the scenes is now focused on next year. And generally, the language which the whole team speaks is more about next year's car. So sometimes you need to take one step back in many ways or hold some of the development back to make sure that you make a bigger step later on," said Albon.

Rohit — letting his bat do the talking

A year is still a long time in international sport and the opener will be nearly 40 and a half when the World Cup gets going. But he is the latest shining example of age being just a number

R. Kaushik

If the West Indian - and Indian - bowling fraternities currently doing battle in the One-Day International series decide to go on strike, they will be greeted with empathy, sympathy and understanding. If one thought Sunday's first game in Thiruvananthapuram was a tall-scoring affair - 595 runs in 91.4 overs, overall run-rate 6.51 - then how do you even begin to describe the massacre in Guwahati on Wednesday?

How often does a team boast three centurions and get beaten out of sight? If you said never, allow yourself a pat on the back. How often does a team rack up 405 and end by licking its wounds? If you said once before, another pat. Though, it must be said, each of these gentle pats will heap untold misery and psychological pain on the Caribbean bowling group.

The thousands at the ground and millions watching on television must have wondered at the wisdom of Shubman Gill's decision to stick the visitors in after West Indies rode on sparkling centuries from John Campbell, skipper Shai Hope and the free-flowing Amir Jangoo to amass 405 for seven. Only once before in the history of the game, more than a decade back, has a higher total been scaled down in ODI history. On that instance, South Africa rode on the incandescence of Herschelle Gibbs (175), and key contributions from Graeme Smith (90), Mark Boucher (50) and Johan van der Wath (35 off 18) to overhaul Australia's 434 for four with one wicket and one delivery to spare. A tantalisingly close contest with the result in doubt till the very final ball.

RITU RAJ KONWAR

A sense of the inevitable

But not so in Guwahati. There was a sense of the inevitable when India began their reply. To have to score at more than eight an over from the off was a massive ask, on the face of it. Never mind how flat the track, how small the boundaries and how inexperienced the bowling attack, to reel in 405? Not easy, you'd think. Not by a long way. Well, think again.

Gill, perhaps determined to prove that his call to chase was the right one, no matter the mountain ahead of him, raced away with a Formula One beast, engines screaming, rubber burning. At the other end, his predecessor as India's captain purred along effortlessly, matching his partner for impact without resorting to the rambunctiousness that the man 12 years his junior was showcasing.

The artificial clouds of uncertainty that had been thrust above Rohit Sharma's head disappeared in a flurry of boundaries at Lord's some two and a half months back, when the right-hander produced his 34th ODI hundred. His subliminal 138 wasn't enough to help India overhaul England's 387 in the deciding game of the three-match series, but coming as it did just a day and a bit after BCCI secretary Devajit Saikia moved to quell speculations that Lord's would be his swansong, it was a statement of great intent and import.

Rohit would be less than human if he hadn't felt the heat going into Lord's. Not because his bat had gone cold, but because the expectations were extraordinarily unfair and demanding, the scrutiny unforgiving, the dissection brutal if without basis. He knew he still had it; he had worked hard to become the fittest version of himself (possibly ever) and it must have rankled that, for all his staggering accomplishments, he was still being put on trial.

Not used to outlandish statements or prickly gestures, Rohit took everything in his stride, silencing wagging tongues and the motley band of critics with the Lord's masterpiece. Only he can say if that effort freed him up mentally, but on Wednesday, Rohit was at it again, content to sail in Gill's wake, happy to keep up his end of the bargain and using all his experience, wisdom and intelligence to not try to compete with the fireworks emanating from the other end.

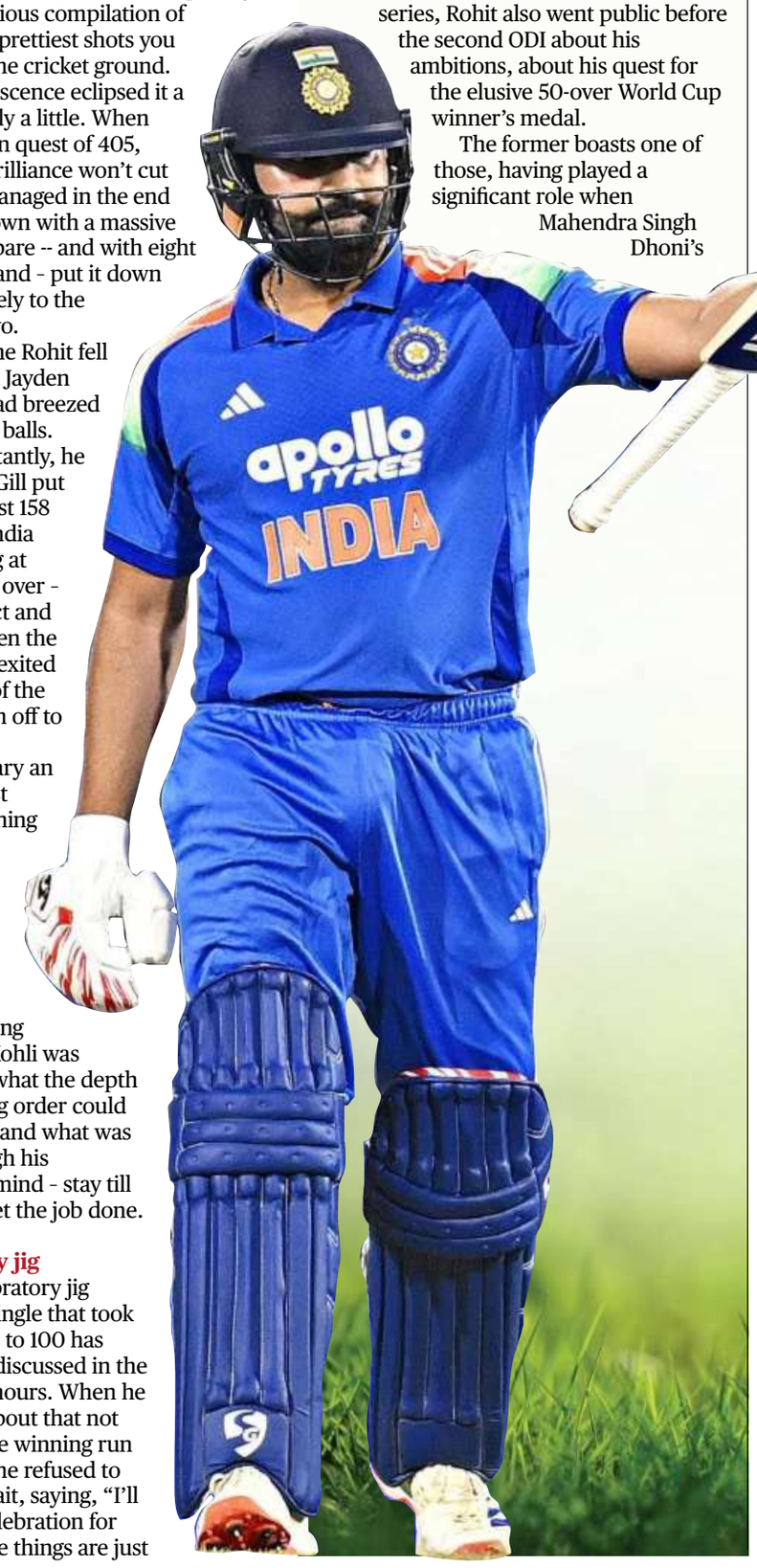
One of the great virtues of having played internationally for 19 years and represented the country in more than 500 matches is that you know your game inside out. You quickly sum up the conditions, you figure out rapidly what works and what may not. You decide which bowlers to target, which areas to score freely in.

Having spent 50 overs in the field chasing leather, Rohit knew that to hop on to the backfoot and play from there was a fruitful, productive, paying option. And that's exactly what he did, hanging just that touch back and letting loose without ever trying to overhit or muscle the ball as he kept his tryst with three-figures.

Gill's century was a spectacle, spanning just 62 deliveries and containing 10 fours and five sixes. It was as if he was batting on a different, stratospheric plane because that's how effortlessly easy on the eye he is. But what about Rohit? When has he not been easy on the eye himself? Ever?

Rohit's hundred came off 72 deliveries - stately it certainly wasn't. Of those 72 balls, 10 disappeared to the boundary, six over it. On its own, it was a compelling effort, a glorious compilation of some of the prettiest shots you will see on the cricket ground. Gill's luminescence eclipsed it a little, but only a little. When you set out in quest of 405, individual brilliance won't cut it. If India managed in the end to scale it down with a massive 39 balls to spare -- and with eight wickets in hand - put it down almost entirely to the opening salvo.

By the time Rohit fell leg before to Jayden Seales, he had breezed to 101, off 75 balls. More importantly, he had helped Gill put on 255, in just 158 deliveries. India were scoring at nearly 10 an over - pause, reflect and marvel - when the Mumbaikar exited the middle of the ACA Stadium off to rapturous applause. Nary an emotion, just another evening in the office, and not a feeling of a job half-done because Rohit knew what incoming No. 3 Virat Kohli was capable of, what the depth in the batting order could translate to, and what was going through his successor's mind - stay till the finish, get the job done.



Celebratory jig

Rohit's celebratory jig during the single that took him from 99 to 100 has been much discussed in the last several hours. When he was asked about that not long after the winning run was struck, he refused to rise to the bait, saying, "I'll keep that celebration for myself. Some things are just meant to be with you and it's not to be shared. So that was for me." And why not? Why, when he had chosen silence to stave off sniping teeth and malicious gossip, did he owe anyone any explanation about his celebration? Why indeed? Like Kohli had at the start of the series, Rohit also went public before the second ODI about his ambitions, about his quest for the elusive 50-over World Cup winner's medal.

The former boasts one of those, having played a significant role when Mahendra Singh Dhoni's men created history a decade and a half back by becoming the first host nation to go all the way. Kohli had smashed a century on his World Cup debut in Mirpur against Bangladesh and weighed in with a crucial hand in the final in Mumbai against Sri Lanka. Walking in at a wobbly 31 for the loss of Virender Sehwag and Sachin Tendulkar as India chased 275 for the title and history, he helped current coach Gautam Gambhir put on 83 for the third wicket before perishing for 35.

Kohli was also the Player of the Final when Rohit hoisted the T20 World Cup trophy in Bridgetown two and a quarter years back, so he has the full set of white-ball winners' medals, so to say. Rohit holds two T20 World Cup champion medals - on debut in 2007 and on his swansong in 2024 - but having heartbreakingly missed out on selection in 2011, slammed five centuries in 2019 and stumbled at the final hurdle, as skipper, in 2023, he is determined, if not desperate, to make his final chance a telling, successful one.

Raging inner fire

A year is still a long time in international sport and Rohit will be nearly 40 and a half when the World Cup gets going. But he is the latest shining example of age being just a number. Driven by a raging inner fire and happily immune to the goings-on around him, his goal is palpable, his focus narrow, his vision understandably blinkered. In New Zealand in November, when the final preparatory exercise will get underway, he will get five opportunities to refamiliarise himself with the conditions that can be expected to be on offer in Africa.

By his own admission, because he only plays one format internationally, he has the time to revisit his game and deep-dive into analysis, something that constant travel and the hectic hustle and bustle of non-stop cricket can sometimes preclude.

Headspace has never been a problem with Rohit. He might have spent much of his career in Kohli's shadow and was eclipsed by Gill on Wednesday, but Rohit isn't the sort to dwell on these little things. He has the remarkable ability to always keep the larger picture in mind which, coupled with his experience, his nous and his hunger, make him a cherished teammate and a doubly dangerous opponent.

THE GIST

- The artificial clouds of uncertainty that had been thrust above Rohit's head disappeared in a flurry of boundaries at Lord's some two and a half months back, when the right-hander produced his 34th ODI hundred
- Like Kohli had at the start of the series, Rohit also went public before the second ODI about his ambitions, about his quest for the elusive 50-over World Cup winner's medal
- In New Zealand in November, when the final preparatory exercise will get underway, he will get five opportunities to refamiliarise himself with the conditions that can be expected to be on offer in Africa

What human brain tissue transplanted into mice showed us

A Stanford University experiment called 'xenocortication' lets human brain tissue develop inside a living mouse, offering a new way to study the developing human brain and, potentially, how disease develops; it also raises new ethical questions about how far such experiments should go

C. Aravinda
Veera Rajagopal

A study published in September in *Nature* by neuroscientist Sergiu Pașca's group at Stanford University reports an experiment that sounds almost like science fiction. Human brain tissue grown from stem cells was transplanted into mice in which much of the cerebral cortex had been genetically prevented from forming. The transplanted tissue grew into this vacant space, produced several types of human brain cells, became electrically active, connected with the mouse nervous system and was associated with measurable differences in behaviour.

Yet, there was an important limitation. The researchers did not create a human brain inside a mouse. The transplanted tissue remained immature, lacked the ordered structure of a normal human cortex, and the study cannot establish that human neurons directly caused any particular behaviour. What the experiment offers is a narrow glimpse of human brain development as it unfolds inside a non-human living nervous system. Understanding how the human brain develops matters both for evolutionary biology and for medicine. The cerebral cortex expanded greatly during human evolution, developing specialised cells and connections involved in language, planning and complex social behaviour. Studying how these features emerge may help explain what makes the human brain distinctive.

It is also medically important because many neurological and psychiatric disorders may begin during development, long before symptoms appear. The main challenge is access. Scientists cannot experimentally manipulate a developing human brain as they can in laboratory animals.

Stem cell technology opened up another avenue to study the developing human brain. Scientists can take ordinary human cells, re-programme them into an earlier, flexible state called induced pluripotent stem cells, and guide them to become nerve cells. When these cells are grown together in three dimensions, they can organise into structures called organoids.

A brain organoid is a small piece of laboratory-grown neural tissue that reproduces some features of early brain development. Organoids allow researchers to observe how human neurons develop, introduce disease-related genetic changes and test responses to drugs.

However, tissue grown in a lab dish lacks key features of a living brain, including normal blood circulation, sensory inputs and long-distance connections with other parts of the nervous system. Researchers, including the Stanford group, have therefore transplanted human brain organoids into rodents. Yet this creates another constraint: the rodent already has its own cortex, so the transplanted human tissue must compete for limited space and neural connections, and has never amounted to more than a fragment of the host's brain.

New findings: What the experiment offers is a narrow glimpse of human brain development as it unfolds inside a non-human living nervous system. Understanding how the human brain develops matters both for evolutionary biology and for medicine. GETTY IMAGES

A third window

The Stanford researchers opened up a third possibility. Instead of engineering a better graft, they re-engineered the host. Using genetic techniques, they produced mice in which much of the neocortex and hippocampus never formed. Because the mice were also bred to lack a functioning immune system, the human tissue would not be rejected. Human cortical organoids were then transplanted into the vacant space soon after birth. The researchers call the approach xenocortication. 'Xeno' refers to something originating from another species, while the cortex is the outer region of the brain involved in many higher functions.

In the Stanford experiment, freed from much of the competition from mouse cortical tissue, the human grafts expanded substantially, and by three months, they made up about 92% of the animal's cortical tissue. They produced several types of developing cortical neurons, along with progenitor cells and astrocytes, at a stage of maturity roughly equivalent to that of the human cortex late in the second trimester of pregnancy. The grafts generated deep-layer neurons carrying the molecular signature of von Economo neurons, large, distinctively shaped cells found in humans and a few other large-brained mammals, but absent in rodents.

The grafts also became electrically active, producing slow waves that swept across the tissue every few minutes, a pattern characteristic of developing, rather than mature, cortical networks. They formed connections with surviving parts of the mouse nervous system, and human nerve fibres reached as far as the cervical spinal cord, something not seen in mice with an intact cortex. This is the conceptual leap of the study: human neural tissue was no longer a fragment lodged inside a rodent's brain, but tissue occupying almost all of the space where that animal's cortex would have been.

The next question was whether this integration had any functional effect. The starting point was itself surprising. Mice lacking most of their neocortex and hippocampus (roughly half the brain by volume) remained active and mobile.

To detect subtler differences, the researchers combined conventional behavioural tests with a machine-learning system called Motion Sequencing (MoSeq). By this measure, mice lacking much of their cortex behaved differently from normal animals. Xenocortical mice showed an intermediate pattern, suggesting that transplantation altered behaviour without fully restoring it.

Why this matters

To show what the platform can do, the researchers exposed the mice to five hours of severe oxygen deprivation. The response was confined to the human tissue: a molecular marker of oxygen stress appeared in the graft but not in the adjacent mouse brain, and not at all in animals without a graft. Two days later, the xenocortical mice walked differently, shifting to a more stable stance without any change in their speed. Imaging 10 days on showed changes in the graft's blood vessels. Under the microscope, the graft's supporting cells had multiplied and become more complex.

This creates a potentially powerful experimental pathway. Scientists could introduce a disease-related mutation into human cells, allow the resulting neural tissue to develop within a living nervous system, observe changes in cells and circuits, assess whether behaviour is affected, and then test possible treatments. Such models could help study developmental brain disorders, the oxygen deprivation around birth that can lead to cerebral palsy, human-specific neuronal diseases and evolutionary differences between human and animal brains. They may also provide a platform for drug testing and, eventually, for evaluating regenerative or cell-based treatments for severe early brain injury.

Limits and ethics

The model is still far from reproducing a developing human brain. Although anatomical connections were observed, this does not prove that they directly controlled behaviour. Any behavioural changes, therefore, arise from a hybrid system in which human tissue interacts with the remaining mouse brain.

These scientific limits also shape the ethical questions. There is no evidence the animals developed a human-like mind, but future grafts may be larger, more mature and better integrated. At what point might this alter an animal's cognition, perception or capacity for experience in ethically significant ways? The researchers anticipated this question and consulted bioethicists at Stanford before beginning. The paper argues that going further towards grafts with mature cortical layering, or transplantation into embryos or into non-human primates, will require a greater degree of scrutiny before such experiments begin.

Ultimately, xenocortication is important not because it creates a human brain in another species, but because it may provide a third window to study human brain development.

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THE GIST

Human brain tissue grown from stem cells was transplanted into mice in which much of the cerebral cortex had been genetically prevented from forming

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Temperament, adversity may offer clues to psychiatric vulnerability: study

Afshan Yasmeen

Temperamental traits and adverse experiences during childhood may together offer clues to vulnerability to major psychiatric disorders, a transdiagnostic study by researchers at NIMHANS, Bengaluru has found.

The study, published recently in the *Journal of Affective Disorders*, examined 1,162 adults, including 532 people with psychiatric disorders, 457 unaffected first-degree relatives (FDRs) and 173 healthy controls. The participants were drawn from 393 multiplex families – families in which multiple members had been diagnosed with psychiatric disorders – involving schizophrenia, bipolar disorder, obsessive-compulsive disorder (OCD) and alcohol use disorder (AUD).

The researchers examined four broad dimensions of adult temperament – negative affectivity, extraversion/surgency, effortful control and orienting sensitivity – along with adverse childhood experiences (ACEs).

"Our findings suggest that temperament does not map onto psychiatric disorders in a simple, one-to-one manner. Rather, different combinations of temperamental characteristics are associated with different disorders, and some of these characteristics are also seen among unaffected family members," said Srinivas Balachander, corresponding author and one of the lead researchers of the study.

Using data from the erstwhile Accelerator programme for Discovery in Brain disorders using Stem cells (ADBS) project, (funded by the Department of Biotechnology and Pratiksha Trust), now known as the Rohini Nilekani Centre for Brain and Mind, at NIMHANS, the researchers found evidence of familial sharing across all four temperamental domains.

This was observed despite considerable variation in the psychiatric diagnoses within the same families. The finding is of interest because temperament is known to have a substantial heritable component, although the study did not directly establish that the temperamental characteristics observed were caused by specific genetic variants. "In our study, considering the significant within-family heterogeneity in terms of different diagnoses, there was still a significant degree of shared temperament," Dr. Balachander said.

Finding a link: The researchers also examined whether adverse childhood experiences altered the relationship between temperament and psychiatric disorders. GETTY IMAGES

Among affected participants, schizophrenia and bipolar disorder were associated with lower extraversion/surgency and orienting sensitivity. OCD was associated with higher negative affectivity and orienting sensitivity, along with lower effortful control and extraversion/surgency. Participants with AUD showed higher negative affectivity and orienting sensitivity and lower effortful control.

The researchers also examined whether adverse childhood experiences altered the relationship between temperament and psychiatric disorders.

The clearest evidence for an interaction between temperament and childhood adversity emerged in alcohol use disorder. The overall ACE score was significantly associated with AUD, and interactions between childhood adversity and two temperamental domains – extraversion/surgency and effortful control – were also observed. "Childhood adversity appears to add another layer to the relationship between temperament and psychiatric vulnerability. In our study, the evidence for this interaction was particularly apparent in alcohol use disorder, rather than uniformly across all four disorders," Dr. Balachander said.

The researchers, however, cautioned against interpreting the findings as evidence that a particular temperament or childhood experience causes a psychiatric disorder.

The study was cross-sectional, meaning that the assessments were made at one point in time. Reports of childhood adversity may also be affected by recall and measurement biases.

Testing the findings

To examine whether the findings extended beyond the genetically enriched family sample, the researchers tested their statistical model using an independent community-based cohort from the Consortium for Vulnerability to Externalizing Disorders and Addiction (c-VEDA).

The analysis included 2,485 adults aged 18 to 23 years for whom the relevant temperament, ACE and psychiatric assessments were available.

The model showed an area under the curve (AUC) of 0.822 for alcohol use disorder, 0.742 for bipolar disorder and 0.752 for OCD. Its performance for schizophrenia was close to chance level, with an AUC of 0.526.

"The external validation gives us some indication that the associations identified in the family-based sample may extend to community populations for some disorders," Dr. Balachander said.

The researchers said the findings point to the need for prospective studies that follow unaffected family members over time. Such studies could help determine whether particular temperamental characteristics precede the onset of psychiatric illness or are partly consequences of illness and its treatment.

The researchers stressed that the present findings do not establish that these measures can predict who will develop a psychiatric disorder.

(yasmeen.afshan@thehindu.co.in)

Text&Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Decline in Apple production so far this year in Himachal

48 in per cent. Apple production in Himachal Pradesh has dropped 48% so far this year as climate change, unseasonal rains, hailstorms, and snowfall have caused severe damage to the crop. So far, 1.15 crore apple boxes have reached the market compared to 2.18 crore boxes last year, State Horticulture Director Satish Kumar said on Thursday. PTI

Amount released to implement anti-atrocities laws

1,423 in ₹ crore. The Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment on Thursday said the Centre has released ₹1,423.30 crore to States and Union Territories over the last three financial years for implementation of the Protection of Civil Rights Act, 1955 and the SC/ST (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989. PTI

Average price of diesel at the pump across the EU

2.24 € per litre. The average price of diesel at the pump across the EU has hit a record of €2.24 per litre — equivalent to $9.60 per U.S. gallon — compared with €1.59 before war erupted in West Asia, according to EU Commission data. The data reflect prices at filling stations, either at the start of the week or at the end of the previous week. AFP

Officials to be probed for betting by Turkish football federation

450 Turkish Football Federation (TFF) says it has referred some 450 club officials to the disciplinary board as part of a probe into betting. The announcement came a day after the Justice Minister announced the arrest of the head of Turkiye's football refereeing body and six other people as part of a graft probe. AFP

Rise in coal supply by CIL to power sector in July-September

11 in per cent. Coal India Limited said the supply of dry fuel to the power sector users has increased by 11.01% to 148.20 million tonnes (MT) in the second quarter of the current financial year. The supply has firmed up ahead of the festive season and is likely to help ensure adequate availability of coal at thermal power plants, CIL said. PTI

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Sri Lanka: chasing system change

The NPP govt. restored macroeconomic stability and introduced a different political culture, but key promises of structural reform remain unfulfilled; two years after Dissanayake's election, the govt. faces the challenge of turning the *Aragalaya*'s demand for 'system change' into lasting political transformation

WORLD INSIGHT

Meera Srinivasan

The mass uprising in Sri Lanka in the summer of 2022 had one unifying chant – "Gota go home", reflecting the protesting citizens' chief demand that then President Gotabaya Rajapaksa resign.

It was one of many diverse chants, their tone ranging from witty irreverence to daring dissent, that captured the spirit of the *Janata Aragalaya,* or people's struggle. The protesters were emphatic in their rejection of Mr. Gotabaya, whom they held responsible for the country's bankruptcy and their endless wait in queues amid acute shortages. They were unafraid to voice their anger with the Rajapaksa clan and their frustration with the entire political class.

But in that watershed moment, they were thirsty for something else, something new – "system change", their posters screamed.

Once the Rajapaksas grudgingly quit office and Ranil Wickremesinghe took charge, with the Rajapaksas' party backing him in an urgent parliamentary vote, the protests fizzled out. The many fragments of the movement had varied reactions to Mr. Wickremesinghe's rule. To some, he was an experienced leader capable of facing the challenge of fixing the country's battered economy. Others, however, saw him as embodying a continuation of the Rajapaksa rule, except in a suit. It was far from the political and systemic overhaul they had sought. That is why Anura Kumara Dissanayake's campaign in 2024, promising to change the "corrupt political system," found resonance with voters. It was the first election held since the economic crisis. Although led by the leftist Janatha Vimukthi Peramuna (JVP), a party tainted by its history of brutal violence, the broader National People's Power (NPP) coalition Mr. Dissanayake founded (in 2019) and built up in the subsequent years emerged as a new force offering rare promise. Voters who had until then switched between one of two legacy political formations alternating at the country's helm felt they had a real choice.

GETTY IMAGES

THE GIST

The NPP government has largely stayed the course with the IMF programme, maintained fiscal discipline, and met or surpassed several key economic targets despite major external shocks

Its record includes high-profile corruption and narcotics-related arrests, but proposed legislative and constitutional reforms, including Provincial Council polls and a new constitution, have seen limited progress

Political scientist Pradeep Peiris sees the NPP as a government of good governance rather than transformation, arguing that it needs a broader conversation with citizens on a new social contract

Two years on

Short of a clear majority in the three-cornered presidential race – he secured 42.31 % of the votes – Mr. Dissanayake made it with his tally of preferential votes. His impressive win propelled the NPP to a historic supermajority in the general elections that soon followed. Citizens who seemed torn or tentative in the September presidential polls were certain in November 2024. They were going to give "AKD" and his government a real chance.

"I am not a magician; I am not a miracle-worker. There are things I know and don't know," Mr. Dissanayake said soon after being sworn in on September 23, 2024. "But I will commit to always doing the right thing, and to lead a collective effort to rebuild our nation," the new President said in his first address to the country.

Last week, President Dissanayake completed two years in office. He has been addressing rallies across the country as part of a series titled 'People's Rule – Two Years Strong. Progress for All'.

Leading a country struggling to recover from a financial crash was never going to be easy. A year into forming government, the Dissanayake administration faced the deadliest natural disaster the country had witnessed since the Indian Ocean tsunami in 2004. Cyclone Ditwah claimed nearly 700 lives and displaced several thousand people, even as nearly 1,200 landslides swallowed villages in the island's hilly regions in late 2025. Within months, the West Asian crisis began, resulting in volatile fuel prices in the global market.

Wasting no time after it came to power, the NPP government prioritised economic stability and recovery.

The government opted to go ahead with the International Monetary Fund programme finalised by its predecessors, staunchly pursued fiscal discipline and macroeconomic stability as the IMF spelled them out, and achieved or even surpassed crucial targets set by the Fund. While the ruling administration initially referred to the IMF programme as a compulsion in the economic and social circumstances in the country, it gradually began following through with conviction. Meanwhile, studies have found that poor families are eating less, as they struggle to cope with crushing austerity.

"We surpassed the target revenue last year and cut down on unnecessary state expenses. It was because of this discipline that we were able to respond to Cyclone Ditwah and the West Asian crisis without passing on the burden to the public," says Nihal Abeysinghe, General Secretary of the NPP and Member of Parliament.

Speaking to *The Hindu* at the JVP party headquarters on the NPP administration's performance, Dr. Abeysinghe said it has "changed the political culture". The Dissanayake government has made a series of high-profile arrests, especially of notorious suspects in the narcotics underworld and prominent politicians and bureaucrats accused of grand corruption. The arrest of a former intelligence chief in connection with the ongoing probe into the 2019 Easter terror bombings raised eyebrows. "Law enforcement is the same for all, whether it is a former president or anyone else," Dr. Abeysinghe says.

Pending promises

According to him, the government will focus on the Provincial Council elections and drafting a new constitution in the three years that remain of its term. Both were among the key promises the NPP made to Tamil voters. While the conduct of the provincial polls remains stuck with a parliamentary committee, there has been no movement yet on the promised new constitution.

The government's efforts to bring about legislative changes remain in sharp focus for both its eagerness in some respects and its lethargy in others. Its recent move to introduce a constitutional amendment extending judges' retirement age drew flak from the political opposition and legal community, which accused the government of using the judiciary to serve its political interests. The NPP's pledge to repeal Sri Lanka's draconian anti-terror legislation and abolish the executive presidency, too, remains only in the manifesto. Rights defenders have slammed draft legislation replacing – and not only repealing – the Prevention of Terrorism Act for falling short of international human rights standards.

'Mixed' report card

Offering a "mixed" report card for the NPP rule over the last two years, Pradeep Peiris, a political scientist at the University of Colombo, says he is "100% pleased" that the country "finally has a civilised, dignified polity". All the same, he is "frustrated that an important turning point increasingly looks like another lost opportunity to address structural issues in our democracy."

The NPP government, in his view, looks more like a "government of good governance", rather than one of transformation. "We must remember that 2024 was not just any other election, with its outcome bringing about a regime change. After 1948 [Independence], it was the first time citizens felt they could negotiate a new political structure". Observing that the *Aragalaya* popularised a democratic imagination, Mr. Peiris adds: "While voters rejected the old political class in the 2024 election, it was not really a baptism of a new political class." The electorate's verdict, he cautions, was more a rejection of old politics than affirmation of the NPP's programme. "While the country was very clear about what it did not want, it is not as clear about what it wants, and even less clear about how to get there. The NPP government needs to initiate a robust, inclusive conversation on renegotiating a new social contract with citizens."

Contending that a cultural project is necessary for real political transformation, he notes that such a project is yet to take off. "In that sense, I feel instead of utilising this historic moment for system change, the NPP has simply become better rulers in the same system they inherited. In such a situation, the risk of the old political order returning always lingers," he notes.

There is every indication that the NPP is hoping for a second term in office. "The opposition is weak, divided, and has no clear work plan. We don't have a real political challenge yet, and we won't until a new force better than us emerges," Dr. Abeysinghe says with confidence.

Meanwhile, the NPP knows that it has its task cut out for it to ensure that its supporters across the country hold on to the hope they felt in 2024. Weeks before he was elected President, Mr. Dissanayake seemed fully aware of the challenge that awaited him if he won. "The people have very high expectations now," he told *The Hindu* at the time.

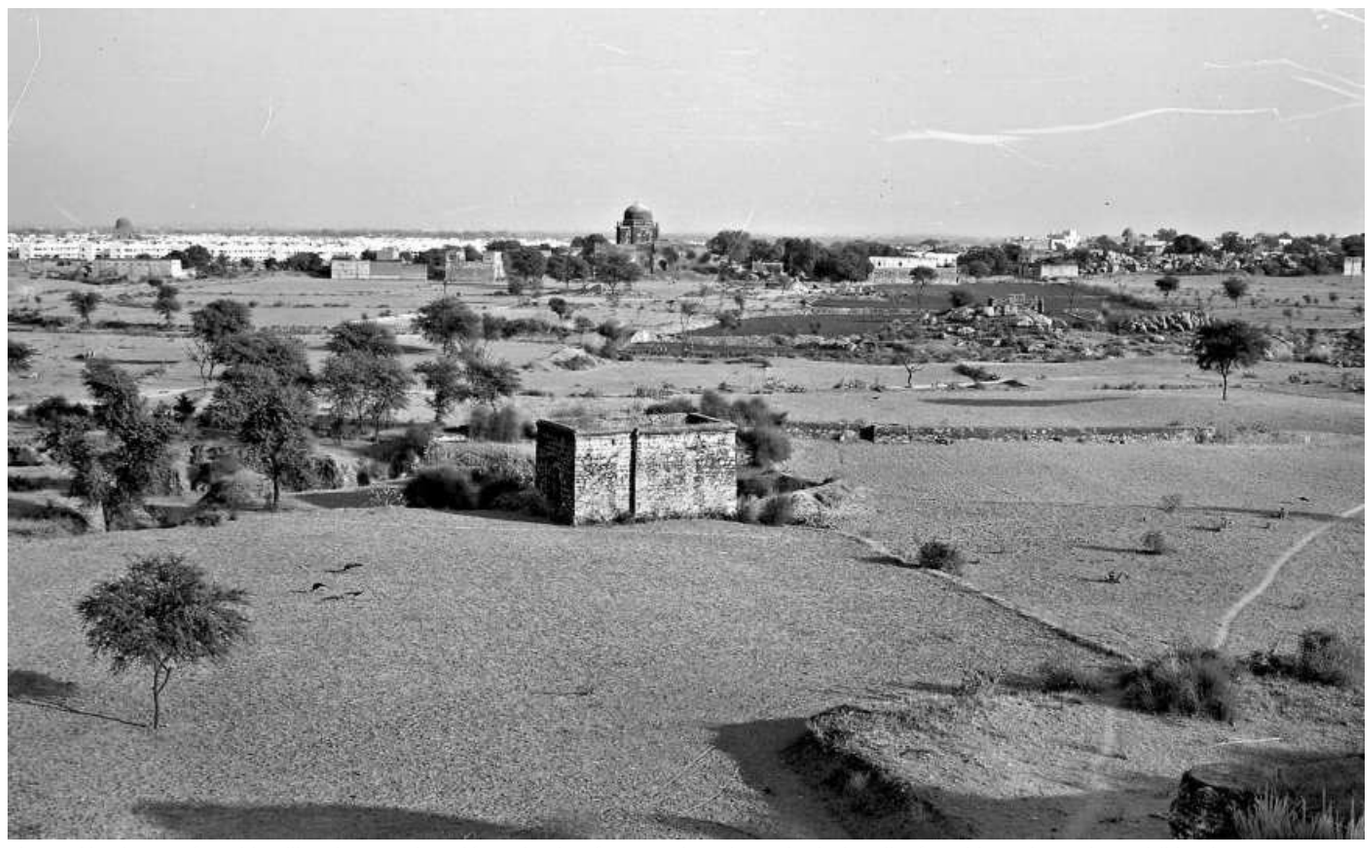
FULL CONTEXT

The forgotten villages at the heart of Delhi's urban history

Delhi's villages were integral to the city's history, but colonial surveys, land acquisition and urbanisation transformed their land and communities; as Delhi expands, preserving the heritage and living traditions of Delhi *Dehat* remains a challenge

Shekhar Tokas

On September 11, 1803, on the banks of the Yamuna at present-day Patparganj in East Delhi, the British East India Company forces defeated the Maratha army and gained control of Delhi. It was a decisive turning point in the city's history. The battle marked not only a shift in political power but also the beginning of a new phase of surveying, mapping and appropriation of Delhi's rural landscape.



The rural landscape of Munirka village in 1959, viewed from the site of present-day Priya Park. The havelis of Munirka and a tomb are visible. The R.K. Puram Sectors 4 and 5 can also be seen, marking the early stages of urbanisation in the area. MISSION FOR INDIAN HISTORY AND ARCHAEOLOGY, UNIVERSITY OF TOKYO, IN 1959-60

The rural landscape before the Raj

At the beginning of the 19th century, Delhi was dotted with distinct ecological zones. The fertile *khadar* stretched along the Yamuna, while the *pahari* tract occupied the natural triangle formed by the Aravalli hills to the north, south and south-east, with the river defining its eastern boundary. To the south-west lay the low-lying *dabar* around the Sahibi river, while the fertile agricultural plains of the *bangar* marked the north-west. These zones were home to village communities whose livelihoods centred on cultivation and animal husbandry, with cattle, camels and goats forming part of everyday rural life.

For centuries, these agrarian settlements supplied food, labour, water, military recruits, artisans and cultural traditions to successive urban centres. These settlements were not peripheral to Delhi's history. They were part of what made the city possible. The *Ain-i-Akbari* records the region's crops, revenues and land conditions, including Palam, which contributed 5,726,787 dams in revenue. Govil's study of Siraspur (1803-1880) similarly shows the village's close links with Delhi through land, revenue and property relations. Siraspur, now in North Delhi near Samaypur Badli and Rohini, survives as a reminder of this once-extensive rural hinterland.

From village land to colonial property

With the British consolidation of Delhi after 1803, the countryside entered a new phase. From 1837, revenue surveys began to map, classify and regulate village lands – including fields and commons (*shamilat deh*) – with a degree of systematic documentation that transformed customary rights into colonial administrative categories.

But Delhi's villagers were never simply anonymous cultivators. They had their own systems of landholding, cultivation, kinship, lineage and customary rights, supported by institutions of village life. *Bhats* preserved these histories through genealogies that recorded ancestry, settlement and links between families and land. Gradually, however, colonial records – *shajra naksh, khasra* and settlement registers – became the state's official records of land and rights.

The 1880 settlement of Kanjhawala shows what was at stake. Around a quarter of the recorded land was held as common land, supporting grazing and other collective needs. As these commons were later classified, divided and transferred, the change was not merely administrative. It reshaped the relationship between Delhi's village communities, their land and the collective resources on which rural life depended.

Every map broadly divided village land into three types: *abadi deh*, the village settlement; *zarī/pahāī arāzī*, agricultural or hilly land; and *shamilat deh*, village commons. The *shajra naksh* showed the village and its different parcels of land, while each parcel was identified by a number, known as a *khasra* number.

These were more than administrative maps. Read alongside the *shajra nasab*, *jamabandi* and *khatauni*, which documented lineage, land rights, ownership and cultivation accounts, these records revealed patterns of settlement, landholding and kinship. Together, these records made village land easier for the colonial state to identify, assess and regulate. Four land-revenue settlements followed, culminating in 1880. The British systematically surveyed and mapped individual fields, assigning numbers that linked land to revenue and ownership records. For village families, land held through generations was increasingly documented not through *bhats*, customary knowledge and community relationships, but through official field numbers and assessed revenue. Ancestral rights were thus drawn into a formal colonial system of property and fiscal control. In 1880, *Zaildari* and *Nambardari* further extended this system of revenue collection. Delhi District was organised into three tehsils, 44 zails and hundreds of villages, including 375 villages across 18 *zails* in the area broadly corresponding to present-day Delhi.

The 1908 Lal Dora system further formalised village boundaries by separating *abadi* from agricultural land. After Delhi became the imperial capital in 1911, land acquisition transformed this system of control into large-scale displacement. Around 30 villages lost land for New Delhi, including Raisina for the Viceroy's House, Khairpur for what became Lodhi Garden, and Pilanji and Malcha for parts of Chanakyapuri. Raisina remains a striking example: its agricultural land was acquired in 1911-12, and more than a century later, descendants continue to seek compensation in the Delhi High Court.

After independence, another transformation followed. The state increasingly acquired agricultural land while leaving village *abadi deh* intact. As fields gave way to roads, institutions and neighbourhoods, the rural landscape gradually disappeared from official maps and from the historical consciousness of the expanding city. The settlements remained, producing the paradox of the "urban village" - rural settlements engulfed by urbanisation. The supposedly "unplanned" urban village, therefore, is not outside Delhi's planning history; it is one of its products.

Whose history is remembered?

But the story of Delhi's villages is not only a story of land. It is also a story about what gets remembered as history. Why do we remember Delhi through its kings, empires, monuments and imperial buildings more readily than through the villages and communities that surrounded them? History is not simply the past; it is the way the past is remembered, interpreted and represented. Historians reconstruct the past from fragments of surviving evidence, and the past is always larger than the evidence that survives.

Collingwood's *The Idea of History*, Bloch's *The Historian's Craft*, and Carr's *What Is History* remind us that history is not simply found in archives; it is reconstructed through questions, evidence and interpretation. This has an important implication for Delhi *Dehat*. Its history lies not only in official records but also in village maps, land documents, landscapes, material remains and oral memories.

The history of Munirka, as reconstructed in *Mhara Munirka: Story of an Urban Village*, illustrates this process. The book brings together oral histories, accounts preserved by *bhats*, old British-period maps, land acquisition documents and surviving structures such as *havelis*, ponds, wells, *chaupals* and temples to recover the history of the village.

The *bhats*, who preserved genealogies and memories of families and their ancestry, provide an important source for recovering histories that may not appear in official records. Recovering these sources allows us to see Delhi not merely as a planned metropolis, but as a city shaped by villages whose histories have often remained outside its dominant narrative. The absence of Delhi's villages from dominant histories does not mean they have no history. It raises a deeper question: whose experiences and sources have shaped the historical record?

The future of Delhi Dehat

Delhi's villages were never leftover spaces waiting to be urbanised. They helped make the city. As Delhi plans for 2047, the question is not simply how these villages will be absorbed, but what happens to their communities, heritage, livelihoods and remaining commons. Will future planning protect their *abadi*, historic structures and local institutions, or displace them once again? Delhi's future will depend not only on what it builds, but on what it chooses to retain.

Even the term *Dehat* deserves reconsideration. The distinction between *shahar* and *dehat* obscures the continuities between rural and urban Delhi. Katwaria Sarai village, surrounded by IIT Delhi, the Indian Statistical Institute and the Qutub Institutional Area, still retains its *jhod* (pond), *akhada* (traditional wrestling pit), Guru Gorakhnath *Mandir*, *Valmiki Mandir* and *Daulat ki Haveli*. Across Delhi, villages continue to preserve rurality through their built heritage, festivals, rituals, language, food and everyday practices. Delhi *Dehat* is therefore not a space outside the city, but a living part of it.

(Shekhar Tokas is an Assistant Professor of Urban Studies at Dr. B. R. Ambedkar University Delhi)

FROM THE ARCHIVES

Know your English

S. Upendran

What is the meaning of "It isn't worth a hill of beans"? (J. V. Subba Rao, Hyderabad)

When you say something "isn't worth a hill of beans", what you are implying is that it is insignificant; it is worthless. This is an expression which is normally used in informal contexts.

What is the difference between "homicide" and "murder"? (R. Ganesan, Madurai)

"Homicide" is a word frequently used in American English. It refers to the killing of one human being by another. The killing may be accidental or intentional. If you shoot a man accidentally or in self-defense, it would be considered "homicide"; similarly, if you run over an individual intentionally, it would be considered "homicide". It is a neutral term. According to Black's Law Dictionary, the word homicide merely "describes the act; it pronounces no judgment on the moral or legal quality".

Murder, on the other hand, is an illegal act; it is usually a premeditated crime. When an individual "murders" someone, he/she kills another human being after having planned what he/she is going to do. The word "murder" has a negative connotation associated with it. The police force in the United States has a Homicide Department, but not a Murder Department. The "o" in the first syllable of "homicide" is like the "o" in "hot", "pot", and "not", while the "i" in the second syllable is like the "a" in "china". The final syllable is pronounced like the word "side". The main stress is on the first syllable.

Is it ok to say "I am running forty"? (K. Chandrasekaran, Sivaganga)

We Indians are always in a hurry. When we are on the road, we are in a rush to get somewhere; sometimes totally ignoring all traffic rules. So it is not surprising that we are always "running" some particular age. It is very common to hear an Indian say that he is "running 40". I suppose when one is 39, one can run to 40. But when one is 79, does one run/jog/canter/limp/crawl to 80? I have no idea. The expression "running 40" is common within the Indian context. Native speakers tend to use "going on". Remember the famous song from "The Sound of Music"? "I am sixteen going on seventeen". Is it wrong to say "running 40"? Within the Indian context, it is acceptable.

What is the meaning of "the straw that broke the camel's back"? (A Vara Prasad, Tuni, A.P.)

When you say that something is the straw that broke the camel's back, what you are implying is that you have reached the limit of your patience; that you are not willing to put up with any more nonsense.

Sriram is always late for office. On Friday, he failed to meet an important client. That was the straw that broke the camel's back. The boss fired him.

It is also possible to say "the last straw". For example,

When he broke the window for the third time, it was the last straw.

There is a limit as to the amount of straw that any animal can carry. A camel, for example, can carry a certain amount on its back. If you keep adding to the amount, then the animal will become overloaded. That final straw is the straw that breaks the camel's back. The idiom has been in use since the mid 1800s.

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THE DAILY QUIZ

A quiz on the Father of the Nation on his 157th birth anniversary

Please send in your answers to dailyquiz@thehindu.co.in

V.V. Ramanan

QUESTION 1
Mohandas Karamchand Gandhi had three siblings. If Raliyatbehn was the sister, who were the two brothers?

QUESTION 2
It is said that when he embarked for England, Gandhiji carried a letter of introduction to a cricketer who was a schoolmate. Name this sporting legend.

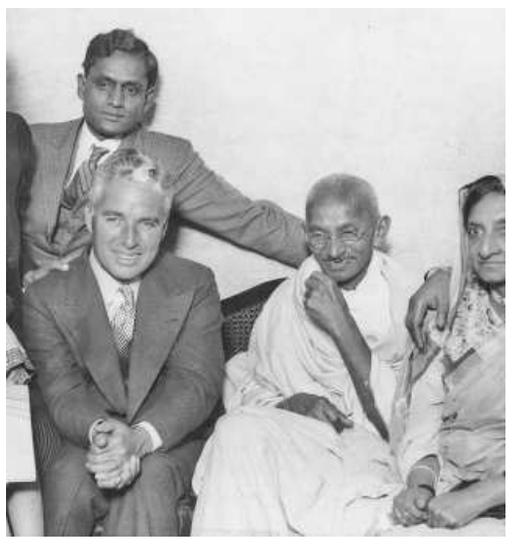
QUESTION 3
An incident that took place on the night of June 7, 1893, acted as a catalyst for Gandhiji to fight against race and colour prejudices. What and where?

QUESTION 4
Name the two main 'ashrams' set up by Gandhiji in South Africa.

QUESTION 5
After many campaigns, activities and arrests in South Africa, Gandhiji returned to India for good on January 9, 1915. How is the date commemorated now?

QUESTION 6
Who was responsible for giving Mohandas Gandhi the title 'Mahatma ', and who first referred to him as 'Rashtriyapitha' (Father of the Nation)?

QUESTION 7
Which genius paid this wonderful tribute to Gandhiji: "Generations to come will scarce believe that such a one as this ever in flesh and blood walked upon this earth"?



Visual Question:
Name the famous gentleman seated alongside Gandhi. THE HINDU ARCHIVES

Questions and Answers to the previous day's daily quiz: 1. Name the place from where Baba Budan is said to have brought coffee beans to India, and how has the place's name become part of coffee lore? **Ans: Mocha in Yemen, and a chocolate-flavoured coffee is called mocha**
2. What is the biggest contribution of Melitta Bentz and Achille Gaggia to the modern world of coffee brewing? **Ans: Paper coffee-filter system and espresso machine**
3. After which event did drinking coffee acquire a particularly patriotic significance among some American colonists as an alternative to tea? **Ans: Boston Tea Party of 1773**
4. What is the common name for the coffee species called 'Coffea canephora'? **Ans: Robusta**
5. Which famous brand was officially launched in 1938 to help surplus Brazilian coffee crops? **Ans: Nescafé instant coffee**
6. Which famous composer wrote a comic opera called 'Coffee Cantata'? **Ans: Johann Sebastian Bach**
7. What is the name given to a trained professional who prepares espresso-based and other coffee drinks? **Ans: Barista**
Visual: This expensive coffee consists of partially digested coffee cherries that have been eaten and defecated by which animal? **Ans: Asian Palm Civet**
Early Birds: K.N. Viswanathan | Tariqa Bali | Tito Shiladitya | Sunil Madhavan | Tamal Biswas

Word of the day

Subterfuge:
something intended to misrepresent the true nature of an activity

Synonyms: deception, trickery, deceptiveness, secrecy

Usage: *His excuse was just subterfuge to hide what he had really done.*

Pronunciation: newsth.live/subterfuge

International Phonetic Alphabet: /sʌbtəfjuːʒ/

For feedback and suggestions for Text & Context, please write to **letters@thehindu.co.in** with the subject 'Text & Context'